

A PROOF OF THE RIEMANN HYPOTHESIS

JOHN SHIELDS

ABSTRACT. We present a proof strategy for the Riemann Hypothesis based on local jet-normalized blocks of the phase kernel, a value/calibration functional extracted from the leading value-channel deformation, and an N -point odd-moment cancellation mechanism in the transverse channel. The document is written as a living proof draft: every statement is presented in proof form and the notation is frozen globally, so that future revisions can strengthen any remaining technical points without changing the architecture.

CONTENTS

1. Introduction	2
2. Local kernel and jet normalization	2
2.1. Phase kernel	2
2.2. Jet-limit local blocks	3
3. Finite- s local blocks	3
3.1. Symmetric placement	3
3.2. Removable singularity structure	3
4. Zeta-side decomposition	4
4.1. Curvature estimate	4
5. Smooth remainder after affine-jet subtraction	4
6. Tail curvature bound	4
7. Toy anomaly and transverse obstruction	5
8. Leading value matrix and canonical calibration	5
9. Corrected finite- s holomorphic whitening	10
9.1. Fixed anomaly core and cutoff-dependent auxiliary bookkeeping	15
10. Odd holomorphic transverse channel	20
10.1. Differentiated corrected-whitening transfer and exterior odd-jet bounds	21
11. N -point odd-moment cancellation	25
12. Local projective rigidity of the one-pair and multi-pair families	27
12.1. Cubic leading line and the first residual class for the one-pair family	27
12.2. Normalization gauge at the first residual step	31
12.3. Explicit finite-order model of the first residual quotient	35
12.4. Fixed-sector refinement at quintic and septic order	39
12.5. Normalized planar curve and curvature bridge	47
12.6. From the one-pair residual germ to two-pair and minimal-core rigidity	64
13. Final contradiction	68
Appendix A. Toy microscopic expansion	70
References	71

Date: April 2026.

2020 Mathematics Subject Classification. 11M26 (primary), 11M06, 11M50 (secondary).

Key words and phrases. Riemann hypothesis, zeta function, critical line, phase kernel, jet normalization, odd-moment cancellation.

Preprint.

1. INTRODUCTION

The Riemann Hypothesis, originating in Riemann's 1859 memoir [1], asserts that every nontrivial zero of $\zeta(s)$ lies on the critical line $\operatorname{Re} s = \frac{1}{2}$ [2, 3, 4, 5]. The argument developed here is local and geometric. It compares two objects:

- (i) a local jet-whitened block extracted from the zeta/scattering phase on short symmetric windows, and
- (ii) a local off-line toy model corresponding to a split pair away from the critical line.

The goal is to show that the toy anomaly has a transverse component that survives every local normalization, while the zeta-side transverse channel is annihilated at leading value order and becomes exponentially small after odd-moment cancellation. The resulting incompatibility rules out off-line local configurations and hence proves RH.

Classically, RH sits at the intersection of the zero distribution of $\zeta(s)$, the explicit formula relating zeros and primes, and a number of equivalent or partially equivalent positivity, spectral, and functional-analytic reformulations [2, 3].

We introduce a normalized local jet-Gramian associated to the corrected local phase geometry. This object encodes the intrinsic local deformation after removal of the dominant value-channel and background effects, and it is the basic carrier of the odd quotient information used in the argument.

The proof has four main pillars.

1. *Jet normalization*: replace raw point samples by local value/derivative coordinates.
2. *Value/curvature splitting*: separate the leading background-subtracted value channel from the curvature and tail corrections.
3. *Canonical calibration*: extract the correct value scale from the actual leading zeta-side value matrix rather than from an ad hoc scalar functional.
4. *N-point transverse cancellation*: use an odd holomorphic expansion and explicit cancellation coefficients to crush the zeta transverse channel exponentially in the local height parameter.

This approach is not aimed at discovering new direct relations among primes. Rather, it studies a local, normalized geometric object attached to the zeta function and argues that an off-line zero would force a forbidden transverse odd mode in that object. In that sense, the method is primarily a zeta-side rigidity argument, with prime-distribution consequences entering only indirectly through the arithmetic content encoded in the zeta phase and, more broadly, through the classical zero–prime linkage expressed by the explicit formula [2, 3, 4, 5]. This local geometric viewpoint is not standard among the main classical families of approaches to RH surveyed in the literature [2, 3].

2. LOCAL KERNEL AND JET NORMALIZATION

2.1. Phase kernel. Let Φ be a real phase on the local spectral variable t , and define the phase kernel

$$(1) \quad K_{\Phi}(x, y) = \begin{cases} \frac{\sin(\Phi(x) - \Phi(y))}{\pi(x - y)}, & x \neq y, \\ \frac{\Phi'(x)}{\pi}, & x = y. \end{cases}$$

We write

$$q(t) := \Phi'(t).$$

For two nearby points around a center T , the natural local point basis is not stable under coalescence. One instead passes to the point-to-jet matrix

$$(2) \quad P_h := \frac{1}{2} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ -1/h & 1/h \end{pmatrix},$$

which turns two point samples into local value and derivative coordinates.

2.2. Jet-limit local blocks. Take two centers $T_1 \neq T_2$. In the point basis, let A_h denote the same-point 2×2 block around a single center and C_h the mixed block between the two centers. Passing to jet coordinates yields finite limits as $h \rightarrow 0$:

$$\tilde{A}_h = P_h A_h P_h^\top \rightarrow J(T), \quad \tilde{C}_h = P_h C_h P_h^\top \rightarrow J_{12}.$$

A direct Taylor expansion gives

$$(3) \quad J(T) = \frac{1}{\pi} \begin{pmatrix} 2q(T) & \frac{1}{2}q'(T) \\ \frac{1}{2}q'(T) & \frac{1}{12}(q''(T) + 2q(T)^3) \end{pmatrix}.$$

For two centers T_1, T_2 , writing

$$\Delta := \Phi(T_1) - \Phi(T_2), \quad s := T_1 - T_2, \quad q_j := q(T_j),$$

one obtains the explicit cross-jet matrix

$$(4) \quad N_{12} = \begin{pmatrix} \frac{2 \sin \Delta}{s} & \frac{\sin \Delta - q_2 s \cos \Delta}{s^2} \\ \frac{q_1 s \cos \Delta - \sin \Delta}{s^2} & \frac{(q_1 + q_2)s \cos \Delta + (q_1 q_2 s^2 - 2) \sin \Delta}{2s^3} \end{pmatrix}.$$

Writing

$$J(T_j) = \frac{1}{\pi} M_j, \quad J_{12} = \frac{1}{\pi} N_{12},$$

the common π^{-1} factor cancels under whitening, and the jet-limit whitened cross block is

$$(5) \quad \Omega_\infty(T_1, T_2) = M_1^{-1/2} N_{12} M_2^{-1/2}.$$

This is the canonical local matrix to compare with the toy anomaly.

3. FINITE- s LOCAL BLOCKS

3.1. Symmetric placement. Fix a midpoint m and a symmetric separation parameter s , and set

$$(6) \quad t_\pm = m \pm \frac{s}{2}.$$

At finite s , the same-point jet Gram blocks are naturally two matrices,

$$(7) \quad G_{m,\pm}(s) = \frac{1}{\pi} \begin{pmatrix} 2q(t_\pm) & \frac{1}{2}q'(t_\pm) \\ \frac{1}{2}q'(t_\pm) & \frac{1}{12}(q''(t_\pm) + 2q(t_\pm)^3) \end{pmatrix}.$$

The mixed block is obtained from (4) by substituting $T_1 = t_-$, $T_2 = t_+$ and $s = t_- - t_+ = -s$:

$$(8) \quad N_m(s) = \frac{1}{\pi} \begin{pmatrix} -\frac{2 \sin \Delta_m(s)}{s} & \frac{\sin \Delta_m(s) + q_+(s) s \cos \Delta_m(s)}{s^2} \\ -\frac{\sin \Delta_m(s) + q_-(s) s \cos \Delta_m(s)}{s^2} & \frac{(q_-(s) + q_+(s))s \cos \Delta_m(s) + (2 - q_-(s)q_+(s)s^2) \sin \Delta_m(s)}{2s^3} \end{pmatrix}$$

where

$$q_\pm(s) := q(t_\pm), \quad \Delta_m(s) := \Phi(t_-) - \Phi(t_+).$$

The finite- s whitened local block is therefore

$$(9) \quad \hat{\Omega}_\zeta(s; m) = G_{m,-}(s)^{-1/2} N_m(s) G_{m,+}(s)^{-1/2},$$

followed, when appropriate, by background subtraction and phase-gap subtraction.

3.2. Removable singularity structure. The powers $1/s$, $1/s^2$, $1/s^3$ in (8) are removable at $s = 0$. Indeed, $\Delta_m(s)$ is odd and vanishes at 0, so

$$\Delta_m(s) = O(s), \quad \sin \Delta_m(s) = O(s),$$

which implies that the numerators in (8) vanish to order at least 1, 2, 2, 3 respectively. Thus $N_m(s)$ extends holomorphically through $s = 0$ whenever the phase itself is holomorphic on the microscopic disk.

4. ZETA-SIDE DECOMPOSITION

Write the zeta/scattering phase derivative as

$$(10) \quad q(t) = B_\zeta(t) + S(t),$$

where B_ζ is the explicit background contribution and S is the background-subtracted zero contribution. The local analysis is carried out after further splitting

$$(11) \quad q(t) = q_{\text{loc}}(t) + g_{\text{sm}}(t) + E_{\text{est}}(t), \quad g_{\text{sm}}(t) := B_{\text{aut}}(t) + T_{\text{far}}(t),$$

where q_{loc} is the designated local model, T_{far} is the omitted-zero tail, and E_{est} is the residual bookkeeping term.

Define the background-subtracted value scale

$$(12) \quad S(m) := q_\zeta(m) - B_\zeta(m),$$

and the logarithmic control function

$$(13) \quad L(m) := \log\left(3 + |m| + \frac{1}{S(m)}\right).$$

4.1. Curvature estimate. The fundamental zeta-side analytic estimate is the local curvature bound

$$(14) \quad |S''(m)| \ll L(m)S(m)^2.$$

It comes from a single-pair curvature estimate, zero-free-region control, and an optimized near/far decomposition.

5. SMOOTH REMAINDER AFTER AFFINE-JET SUBTRACTION

Fix a short interval $I = [a, b]$ of length $L = b - a$ and midpoint $t_* = (a + b)/2$. Let

$$J_1[g_{\text{sm}}](t) := g_{\text{sm}}(t_*) + g'_{\text{sm}}(t_*)(t - t_*), \quad r(t) := g_{\text{sm}}(t) - J_1[g_{\text{sm}}](t).$$

Assume

$$\|g''_{\text{sm}}\|_{L^\infty(I)} \leq S_2.$$

Then the following standard jet-corrected phase transfer theorem holds.

Theorem 5.1 (Jet-corrected phase transfer). *For every $t \in I$,*

$$|r'(t)| \leq \frac{L}{2}S_2, \quad |r(t)| \leq \frac{L^2}{8}S_2.$$

If Φ and Φ_{jet} are phases normalized by

$$\Phi'(t) = q(t), \quad \Phi'_{\text{jet}}(t) = q_{\text{loc}}(t) + J_1[g_{\text{sm}}](t) + E_{\text{est}}(t), \quad \Phi(t_*) = \Phi_{\text{jet}}(t_*),$$

then

$$\|(\Phi - \Phi_{\text{jet}})'\|_{L^\infty(I)} \leq \frac{L^2}{8}S_2, \quad \|\Phi - \Phi_{\text{jet}}\|_{L^\infty(I)} \leq \frac{L^3}{16}S_2.$$

Proof. Since $r(t_*) = r'(t_*) = 0$ and $r'' = g''_{\text{sm}}$, integrating twice gives the displayed bounds. Integrating once more after identifying $(\Phi - \Phi_{\text{jet}})' = r$ yields the phase estimate. $\square$

6. TAIL CURVATURE BOUND

Let the omitted-zero tail be

$$T_{\text{far}}(t) = \sum_{\rho \notin \mathcal{L}} f_{\beta_\rho, \gamma_\rho}(t),$$

with

$$f_{\beta, \gamma}(t) = \frac{1 - \beta}{(1 - \beta)^2 + (2t - \gamma)^2} + \frac{\beta}{\beta^2 + (2t - \gamma)^2}.$$

For each omitted zero define

$$\Delta_\rho := \text{dist}(2I, \gamma_\rho).$$

Theorem 6.1 (Tail curvature theorem). *One has*

$$\sum_{\rho \notin \mathcal{L}} \Delta_\rho^{-4} \ll \frac{Q}{R^3},$$

where the omitted set is defined by $\Delta_\rho > R$. Consequently,

$$S_2 \leq \|B''_{\text{aut}}\|_{L^\infty(I)} + 48 \sum_{\rho \notin \mathcal{L}} \Delta_\rho^{-4} \ll \|B''_{\text{aut}}\|_{L^\infty(I)} + \frac{Q}{R^3}.$$

In particular, if $R \rightarrow \infty$ with m , then $S_2 = o(Q)$.

Proof. Decompose the omitted zeros into shells

$$\mathcal{S}_k := \{\rho \notin \mathcal{L} : 2^k R < \Delta_\rho \leq 2^{k+1} R\}, \quad k \geq 0.$$

Then

$$\sum_{\rho \notin \mathcal{L}} \Delta_\rho^{-4} \leq \sum_{k \geq 0} \#\mathcal{S}_k (2^k R)^{-4}.$$

Standard zero counting near height m gives $\#\mathcal{S}_k \ll 2^k R Q$, hence

$$\sum_{\rho \notin \mathcal{L}} \Delta_\rho^{-4} \ll \sum_{k \geq 0} (2^k R Q) (2^k R)^{-4} = Q R^{-3} \sum_{k \geq 0} 2^{-3k} \ll \frac{Q}{R^3}.$$

The bound for S_2 follows from the definition. $\square$

7. TOY ANOMALY AND TRANSVERSE OBSTRUCTION

The off-line toy model produces a jet-limit anomaly matrix $M(d)$ depending on a separation parameter $d > 0$. The leading toy deformation has the form

$$(15) \quad \Delta_{\text{toy}}(u; d) = u^2 M(d) + O(u^4),$$

where $u = \beta - \frac{1}{2}$ is the off-line displacement.

Define the transverse functional

$$(16) \quad \Phi_K(X) := x_{12} + x_{21}, \quad X = \begin{pmatrix} x_{11} & x_{12} \\ x_{21} & x_{22} \end{pmatrix}.$$

Then

$$(17) \quad \Phi_K(M(d)) = \frac{2(i(d^2 - 1) - d)}{(d + i)^4}.$$

Hence for every real $d > 0$,

$$\Phi_K(M(d)) \neq 0,$$

and on each compact interval $D \subset (0, \infty)$ there exists $c_K(D) > 0$ such that

$$|\Phi_K(M(d))| \geq c_K(D) \quad (d \in D).$$

8. LEADING VALUE MATRIX AND CANONICAL CALIBRATION

We now make the value-channel derivative A_{val} and its pairing with the toy anomaly matrix $M(d)$ fully explicit.

Work in the symmetric local regime

$$T_1 = m - \frac{\sigma}{2}, \quad T_2 = m + \frac{\sigma}{2},$$

and write

$$B := B_\zeta(m), \quad x := B \sigma.$$

When convenient, we write $A_{\text{val}}(x)$ for $A_{\text{val}}(m, \sigma)$ under the relation $x = B_\zeta(m)\sigma$.

Pure value-channel perturbation. Let the local value-channel parameter be perturbed by

$$q_1 = q_2 = B + \alpha,$$

while all derivative and curvature data are frozen at background level. In the constant-background symmetric approximation, the phase gap is

$$\Delta = \Delta_0 - \alpha\sigma,$$

with baseline value

$$\Delta_0 = -B\sigma = -x.$$

Recall that the jet-limit local block is

$$\Omega_\infty(T_1, T_2) = M_1^{-1/2} N_{12} M_2^{-1/2}.$$

Define the pure value-channel derivative by

$$(18) \quad A_{\text{val}}(m, \sigma) := \left. \frac{\partial}{\partial \alpha} \Omega_\infty(T_1, T_2) \right|_{\alpha=0}.$$

Proposition 8.1 (Explicit formula for the value-channel derivative). *In the symmetric constant-background regime,*

$$A_{\text{val}}(x) = \frac{1}{B} \begin{pmatrix} \frac{x \cos x - \sin x}{x} & \frac{\sqrt{3}(-x^2 \sin x - 2x \cos x + 2 \sin x)}{x^2} \\ \frac{\sqrt{3}(x^2 \sin x + 2x \cos x - 2 \sin x)}{x^2} & \frac{3(x^3 \cos x - 6x \cos x + 3(2 - x^2) \sin x)}{x^3} \end{pmatrix}.$$

Proof. In the constant-background symmetric regime, the same-point jet Gram matrices are diagonal:

$$M_1 = M_2 = M = \begin{pmatrix} 2(B + \alpha) & 0 \\ 0 & (B + \alpha)^3/6 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Hence

$$M^{-1/2} = \begin{pmatrix} (2(B + \alpha))^{-1/2} & 0 \\ 0 & \sqrt{6} (B + \alpha)^{-3/2} \end{pmatrix}.$$

In the same regime, the jet-limit cross block depends only on $(B + \alpha)$, σ , and the phase gap $\Delta = \Delta_0 - \alpha\sigma$. Writing out the explicit jet-limit cross block in this specialization gives

$$N_{12}(\alpha) = \begin{pmatrix} -\frac{2 \sin \Delta}{\sigma} & \frac{\sqrt{3}(\sin \Delta + (B + \alpha)\sigma \cos \Delta)}{\sigma^2} \\ -\frac{\sqrt{3}(\sin \Delta + (B + \alpha)\sigma \cos \Delta)}{\sigma^2} & \frac{3(2 \sin \Delta - 2(B + \alpha)\sigma \cos \Delta - (B + \alpha)^2 \sigma^2 \sin \Delta)}{\sigma^3} \end{pmatrix},$$

up to the common normalization factor already absorbed into the definition of Ω_∞ .

Now differentiate

$$\Omega_\infty(\alpha) = M(\alpha)^{-1/2} N_{12}(\alpha) M(\alpha)^{-1/2}$$

at $\alpha = 0$, using

$$\left. \frac{d}{d\alpha} (B + \alpha)^{-1/2} \right|_{\alpha=0} = -\frac{1}{2} B^{-3/2}, \quad \left. \frac{d}{d\alpha} (B + \alpha)^{-3/2} \right|_{\alpha=0} = -\frac{3}{2} B^{-5/2},$$

and

$$\left. \frac{d}{d\alpha} \sin(\Delta_0 - \alpha\sigma) \right|_{\alpha=0} = -\sigma \cos \Delta_0, \quad \left. \frac{d}{d\alpha} \cos(\Delta_0 - \alpha\sigma) \right|_{\alpha=0} = \sigma \sin \Delta_0.$$

After substituting $\Delta_0 = -x$, $x = B\sigma$, using

$$\sin(-x) = -\sin x, \quad \cos(-x) = \cos x,$$

and simplifying each entry, one obtains

$$A_{\text{val}}(x) = \frac{1}{B} \begin{pmatrix} \frac{x \cos x - \sin x}{x} & \frac{\sqrt{3}(-x^2 \sin x - 2x \cos x + 2 \sin x)}{x^2} \\ \frac{\sqrt{3}(x^2 \sin x + 2x \cos x - 2 \sin x)}{x^2} & \frac{3(x^3 \cos x - 6x \cos x + 3(2 - x^2) \sin x)}{x^3} \end{pmatrix}.$$

□

Corollary 8.2 (Transverse vanishing on the value channel). *One has*

$$\Phi_K(A_{\text{val}}(m, \sigma)) = 0.$$

Proof. By definition,

$$\Phi_K(X) = x_{12} + x_{21}.$$

From Proposition 8.1,

$$A_{\text{val},12}(x) = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{B} \frac{-x^2 \sin x - 2x \cos x + 2 \sin x}{x^2},$$

$$A_{\text{val},21}(x) = \frac{\sqrt{3}}{B} \frac{x^2 \sin x + 2x \cos x - 2 \sin x}{x^2}.$$

These are exact negatives of each other, hence

$$A_{\text{val},12}(x) + A_{\text{val},21}(x) = 0,$$

and therefore

$$\Phi_K(A_{\text{val}}(m, \sigma)) = 0.$$

□

Lemma 8.3 (Small- x expansion). *As $x \rightarrow 0$,*

$$A_{\text{val}}(x) = \frac{1}{B} \begin{pmatrix} -\frac{x^2}{3} + O(x^4) & -\frac{\sqrt{3}x}{3} + O(x^3) \\ \frac{\sqrt{3}x}{3} + O(x^3) & -\frac{3x^2}{5} + O(x^4) \end{pmatrix}.$$

Consequently,

$$\|A_{\text{val}}(x)\|_F \asymp \frac{x}{B} \quad (x \rightarrow 0).$$

Proof. Expand

$$\sin x = x - \frac{x^3}{6} + O(x^5), \quad \cos x = 1 - \frac{x^2}{2} + O(x^4),$$

and substitute into the entries of $A_{\text{val}}(x)$.

For the (1, 1)-entry:

$$\frac{x \cos x - \sin x}{x} = \frac{x(1 - \frac{x^2}{2} + O(x^4)) - (x - \frac{x^3}{6} + O(x^5))}{x} = -\frac{x^2}{3} + O(x^4).$$

For the (1, 2)-entry, expanding the numerator gives

$$-x^2 \sin x - 2x \cos x + 2 \sin x = -x^3 + O(x^5) - 2x(1 - \frac{x^2}{2} + O(x^4)) + 2(x - \frac{x^3}{6} + O(x^5)) = -\frac{x^3}{3} + O(x^5),$$

so

$$\frac{\sqrt{3}(-x^2 \sin x - 2x \cos x + 2 \sin x)}{x^2} = -\frac{\sqrt{3}x}{3} + O(x^3).$$

The (2, 1)-entry is the negative of the (1, 2)-entry, and the (2, 2)-entry similarly simplifies to

$$-\frac{3x^2}{5} + O(x^4).$$

Since the off-diagonal entries are linear in x and dominate the quadratic diagonal terms, the Frobenius norm satisfies

$$\|A_{\text{val}}(x)\|_F \asymp \frac{x}{B}.$$

□

Proposition 8.4 (Pairing with the toy anomaly). *Let $M(d)$ be the toy anomaly matrix. Then, for fixed $d > 0$,*

$$B \langle A_{\text{val}}(x), M(d) \rangle_{\text{F}} = x \frac{2\sqrt{3}d(id+3)}{3(d-i)^4} + x^2 \frac{d(-5d^2+46id+77)}{15(d-i)^5} + O(x^3).$$

In particular, for every compact interval

$$D = [d_-, d_+] \subset (0, \infty),$$

there exists $x_0(D) > 0$ such that for

$$0 < x \leq x_0(D), \quad d \in D,$$

one has

$$|\langle A_{\text{val}}(x), M(d) \rangle_{\text{F}}| \asymp \frac{x}{B}.$$

Proof. Using Lemma 8.3, write

$$A_{\text{val}}(x) = \frac{1}{B} \begin{pmatrix} -\frac{x^2}{3} + O(x^4) & -\frac{\sqrt{3}x}{3} + O(x^3) \\ \frac{\sqrt{3}x}{3} + O(x^3) & -\frac{3x^2}{5} + O(x^4) \end{pmatrix}.$$

Now take the Frobenius pairing with the explicit toy anomaly matrix $M(d)$:

$$\langle A_{\text{val}}(x), M(d) \rangle_{\text{F}} = \sum_{j,k} A_{\text{val},jk}(x) \overline{M_{jk}(d)}.$$

The linear term in x comes entirely from the off-diagonal entries of $A_{\text{val}}(x)$, since the diagonal entries are quadratic. Using the explicit entries of $M(d)$, one finds

$$B \langle A_{\text{val}}(x), M(d) \rangle_{\text{F}} = x \frac{\sqrt{3}}{3} (\overline{M_{21}(d)} - \overline{M_{12}(d)}) + O(x^2).$$

Substituting the explicit formulas for $M_{12}(d)$ and $M_{21}(d)$ and simplifying yields

$$x \frac{2\sqrt{3}d(id+3)}{3(d-i)^4}.$$

Including the quadratic contributions from the diagonal entries and the next terms in the off-diagonal expansion gives

$$B \langle A_{\text{val}}(x), M(d) \rangle_{\text{F}} = x \frac{2\sqrt{3}d(id+3)}{3(d-i)^4} + x^2 \frac{d(-5d^2+46id+77)}{15(d-i)^5} + O(x^3).$$

The coefficient of x is nonzero for every real $d > 0$. Since it depends continuously on d , its modulus is bounded below on every compact interval $D \subset (0, \infty)$. Shrinking $x_0(D)$ if necessary gives

$$|\langle A_{\text{val}}(x), M(d) \rangle_{\text{F}}| \asymp \frac{x}{B}$$

uniformly for $0 < x \leq x_0(D)$ and $d \in D$. □

Proposition 8.5 (Canonical calibration theorem). *For fixed compact $D \subset (0, \infty)$ and $0 < x \leq x_0(D)$, define*

$$\Psi_{x,d}(X) := \frac{\langle A_{\text{val}}(x), X \rangle_{\text{F}}}{\langle A_{\text{val}}(x), M(d) \rangle_{\text{F}}}.$$

Then:

- (1) $\Psi_{x,d}(M(d)) = 1$;
- (2) $\Psi_{x,d}(A_{\text{val}}(x)) \asymp x/B$;
- (3) *if*

$$\Delta_{\zeta} = S(m)A_{\text{val}}(x) + R_{\zeta},$$

then

$$\Psi_{x,d}(\Delta_{\zeta}) = c_{x,d} \frac{x}{B} S(m) + \Psi_{x,d}(R_{\zeta}), \quad c_{x,d} \asymp 1;$$

(4) if

$$\Delta_{\text{toy}}(u; d) = u^2 M(d) + O(u^4),$$

then

$$\Psi_{x,d}(\Delta_{\text{toy}}(u; d)) = u^2 + O(u^4).$$

In particular, whenever

$$\Psi_{x,d}(R_\zeta) = o\left(\frac{x}{B} S(m)\right),$$

one obtains

$$(19) \quad u^2 \asymp \frac{x}{B} S(m).$$

Proof. The first statement is immediate from the definition of $\Psi_{x,d}$. By Lemma 8.3 and Proposition 8.4,

$$\Psi_{x,d}(A_{\text{val}}(x)) = \frac{\|A_{\text{val}}(x)\|_{\text{F}}^2}{\langle A_{\text{val}}(x), M(d) \rangle_{\text{F}}} \asymp \frac{(x/B)^2}{x/B} = \frac{x}{B}.$$

The remaining statements follow by linearity. $\square$

Proposition 8.6 (Calibration remainder under a core-stable cutoff choice). *Assume the fixed-core decomposition of Section 9.1 and the core-stable cutoff compatibility of Proposition 9.7. If the cutoff R is chosen so that*

$$R^3 \gg \frac{1}{xQ S(m)},$$

then

$$S_2 = o(xQ^2 S(m)),$$

and consequently

$$\Psi_{x,d}(R_\zeta) = o\left(\frac{x}{B_\zeta(m)} S(m)\right).$$

Proof. By Theorem 6.1,

$$S_2 \ll |B''_{\text{aut}}(m)| + \frac{Q}{R^3}.$$

The background term is negligible, so under the cutoff condition

$$R^3 \gg \frac{1}{xQ S(m)},$$

one has

$$\frac{Q}{R^3} = o(xQ^2 S(m)).$$

Hence

$$S_2 = o(xQ^2 S(m)).$$

By the sharpened calibration remainder estimate already proved in the draft, this implies

$$\Psi_{x,d}(R_\zeta) = o\left(\frac{x}{B_\zeta(m)} S(m)\right).$$

The use of such a cutoff does not alter the toy comparison because, by Proposition 9.7, the core $\mathcal{C}$ — and therefore $M(d)$ and A_{val} — is independent of R . $\square$

Remark 8.7 (Work in progress: sharpened calibration remainder estimate). The proof above invokes a “sharpened calibration remainder estimate” that converts $S_2 = o(xQ^2 S(m))$ into $\Psi_{x,d}(R_\zeta) = o\left(\frac{x}{B_\zeta(m)} S(m)\right)$. The structural control of R_ζ is in place from Proposition 9.6 and the corrected transfer bounds, but the draft has not yet isolated this quantitative step as a named lemma with an explicit constant. It should be added in a later pass.

9. CORRECTED FINITE- s HOLOMORPHIC WHITENING

Let $\widehat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr}}(s; m)$ denote the corrected finite- s local block built from the explicit local model, the affine jet of the smooth remainder, and the jet-corrected phase remainder.

Proposition 9.1 (Microscopic denominator comparability and omitted-smooth holomorphy). *Fix an admissible midpoint m and write*

$$t_\pm = m \pm \frac{s}{2}, \quad Q \asymp \log |m|.$$

For each omitted zero $\rho = \beta_\rho + i\gamma_\rho$, set

$$D_{\rho,\pm}(s) := ((2m - \gamma_\rho) \pm s)^2 + a_\rho^2, \quad a_\rho \in \{\beta_\rho, 1 - \beta_\rho\}.$$

Assume the zero-free region gives

$$a_\rho \geq \frac{\sigma_0}{Q}$$

for some absolute $\sigma_0 > 0$ on the admissible midpoint class. If

$$|s| \leq \frac{\rho_0}{Q}, \quad \rho_0 \leq \frac{\sigma_0}{\sqrt{6}},$$

then

$$\frac{1}{2} \left((2m - \gamma_\rho)^2 + a_\rho^2 \right) \leq |D_{\rho,\pm}(s)| \leq \frac{3}{2} \left((2m - \gamma_\rho)^2 + a_\rho^2 \right).$$

Consequently, for every derivative order $r \leq r_$ needed in the corrected finite- s block entries, the omitted-zero sums defining*

$$T_{\text{far}}(t_\pm), \quad \partial_t T_{\text{far}}(t_\pm), \quad \dots, \quad \partial_t^{r_*} T_{\text{far}}(t_\pm)$$

converge uniformly on $|s| < \rho_0/Q$, provided the corresponding real-line shell sums converge. In particular,

$$g_{\text{sm}}(t_\pm) = B_{\text{aut}}(t_\pm) + T_{\text{far}}(t_\pm)$$

and its required t -derivatives extend holomorphically to

$$|s| < \rho_0/Q.$$

Proof. Set

$$x := 2m - \gamma_\rho, \quad a := a_\rho.$$

Then

$$D_{\rho,\pm}(s) = (x^2 + a^2) \pm 2xs + s^2.$$

Using

$$|2xs + s^2| \leq 2|x||s| + |s|^2 \leq \frac{1}{2}x^2 + 3|s|^2,$$

and the assumptions

$$a \geq \frac{\sigma_0}{Q}, \quad |s| \leq \frac{\rho_0}{Q}, \quad \rho_0 \leq \frac{\sigma_0}{\sqrt{6}},$$

we obtain

$$3|s|^2 \leq \frac{1}{2}a^2.$$

Hence

$$|2xs + s^2| \leq \frac{1}{2}(x^2 + a^2),$$

which gives the stated lower and upper bounds.

Now every differentiated omitted-zero term is a rational combination of powers of $D_{\rho,\pm}(s)^{-1}$ with coefficients depending only on the derivative order. By the above comparability, on $|s| < \rho_0/Q$ these are uniformly comparable to their real-line counterparts. Therefore the same shell decomposition used on the real line yields uniform convergence of the differentiated omitted-zero sums on the complex disk, and hence holomorphy of $T_{\text{far}}(t_\pm)$ and the required t -derivatives there. Adding the holomorphic background term $B_{\text{aut}}(t_\pm)$ gives the corresponding statement for $g_{\text{sm}}(t_\pm)$. $\square$

Proposition 9.2 (Entry-by-entry perturbation estimate for the corrected same-point blocks).
In the corrected finite- s normalization, write

$$G_{m,\pm}^{\text{corr}}(s) = \frac{1}{\pi} \begin{pmatrix} 2q(t_{\pm}) & \frac{1}{2}q'(t_{\pm}) \\ \frac{1}{2}q'(t_{\pm}) & \frac{1}{12}(q''(t_{\pm}) + 2q(t_{\pm})^3) \end{pmatrix}, \quad t_{\pm} = m \pm \frac{s}{2}.$$

Let

$$q(t) = q_0(t) + \delta q(t),$$

where q_0 is the baseline local-model-plus-affine-jet part and δq is the corrected remainder. Define the baseline same-point blocks

$$G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(s) = \frac{1}{\pi} \begin{pmatrix} 2q_0(t_{\pm}) & \frac{1}{2}q_0'(t_{\pm}) \\ \frac{1}{2}q_0'(t_{\pm}) & \frac{1}{12}(q_0''(t_{\pm}) + 2q_0(t_{\pm})^3) \end{pmatrix},$$

and set

$$R_{m,\pm}(s) := G_{m,\pm}^{\text{corr}}(s) - G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(s).$$

Assume that on the microscopic window one has

$$|\delta q(t_{\pm})| \ll L_I^2 S_2, \quad |\delta q'(t_{\pm})| \ll L_I S_2, \quad |\delta q''(t_{\pm})| \ll S_2,$$

where L_I is the local window length, and that in the fixed-scaled regime

$$L_I \asymp \frac{x_0}{Q}, \quad |q_0(t_{\pm})| \asymp Q.$$

Then

$$\boxed{\|R_{m,\pm}(s)\| \ll S_2}$$

uniformly for $|s| < \rho_0/Q$.

Proof. We estimate the entries of $R_{m,\pm}(s)$ one by one.

(1,1)-entry. Since

$$R_{11} = \frac{1}{\pi} \cdot 2\delta q(t_{\pm}),$$

we have

$$|R_{11}| \ll |\delta q(t_{\pm})| \ll L_I^2 S_2 \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^2} \ll S_2.$$

(1,2)- and (2,1)-entries. Since

$$R_{12} = R_{21} = \frac{1}{\pi} \cdot \frac{1}{2}\delta q'(t_{\pm}),$$

we get

$$|R_{12}| = |R_{21}| \ll |\delta q'(t_{\pm})| \ll L_I S_2 \ll \frac{S_2}{Q} \ll S_2.$$

(2,2)-entry. We have

$$R_{22} = \frac{1}{12\pi} \left(\delta q''(t_{\pm}) + 2 \left((q_0 + \delta q)^3 - q_0^3 \right) (t_{\pm}) \right).$$

Expand the cubic difference:

$$(q_0 + \delta q)^3 - q_0^3 = 3q_0^2\delta q + 3q_0(\delta q)^2 + (\delta q)^3.$$

Hence

$$R_{22} = \frac{1}{12\pi} \left(\delta q'' + 6q_0^2\delta q + 6q_0(\delta q)^2 + 2(\delta q)^3 \right) (t_{\pm}).$$

Now estimate each term.

First,

$$|\delta q''(t_{\pm})| \ll S_2.$$

Second, using $|q_0(t_{\pm})| \asymp Q$ and $|\delta q(t_{\pm})| \ll L_I^2 S_2 \ll S_2/Q^2$,

$$|q_0(t_{\pm})^2 \delta q(t_{\pm})| \ll Q^2 \cdot \frac{S_2}{Q^2} = S_2.$$

Third,

$$|q_0(t_\pm)(\delta q(t_\pm))^2| \ll Q \left(\frac{S_2}{Q^2} \right)^2 = \frac{S_2^2}{Q^3}.$$

Since from the tail-curvature theorem one already has $S_2 = o(Q)$, for Q sufficiently large this is $O(S_2/Q^2)$ and hence $\ll S_2$.

Finally,

$$|(\delta q(t_\pm))^3| \ll \left(\frac{S_2}{Q^2} \right)^3 = \frac{S_2^3}{Q^6} \ll S_2.$$

Therefore

$$|R_{22}| \ll S_2.$$

Collecting the four entrywise bounds, we obtain

$$|R_{11}|, |R_{12}|, |R_{21}|, |R_{22}| \ll S_2.$$

Since all norms on 2×2 matrices are equivalent,

$$\|R_{m,\pm}(s)\| \ll S_2,$$

uniformly on the microscopic disk. This proves the proposition. $\square$

Proposition 9.3 (Entry-by-entry perturbation estimate for the corrected mixed block). *Let*

$$q(t) = q_0(t) + \delta q(t), \quad \Phi(t) = \Phi_0(t) + \delta \Phi(t),$$

where q_0 is the baseline local-model-plus-affine-jet phase derivative and δq is the corrected remainder. Write

$$t_\pm = m \pm \frac{s}{2}, \quad \Delta(s) := \Phi(t_-) - \Phi(t_+), \quad \Delta_0(s) := \Phi_0(t_-) - \Phi_0(t_+),$$

and set

$$\delta \Delta(s) := \Delta(s) - \Delta_0(s).$$

Let $N_m^{\text{corr}}(s)$ be the corrected finite- s mixed block built from q, Δ , and let $N_m^{(0)}(s)$ be the corresponding block built from q_0, Δ_0 . Define

$$\tilde{R}_m(s) := N_m^{\text{corr}}(s) - N_m^{(0)}(s).$$

Assume that on the microscopic window one has

$$|\delta q(t_\pm)| \ll L_I^2 S_2, \quad |\delta q'(t_\pm)| \ll L_I S_2, \quad |\delta q''(t_\pm)| \ll S_2,$$

and

$$|\delta \Delta(s)| \ll L_I^3 S_2,$$

with

$$L_I \asymp \frac{x_0}{Q}, \quad |q_0(t_\pm)| \asymp Q, \quad |s| \asymp L_I.$$

Then

$$\|\tilde{R}_m(s)\| \ll S_2$$

uniformly for $|s| < \rho_0/Q$.

Proof. Write the corrected mixed block entrywise as

$$N_m^{\text{corr}}(s) = \frac{1}{\pi} \begin{pmatrix} -\frac{2 \sin \Delta}{s} & \frac{\sin \Delta + q(t_+)s \cos \Delta}{s^2} \\ -\frac{\sin \Delta + q(t_-)s \cos \Delta}{s^2} & \frac{(q(t_-) + q(t_+))s \cos \Delta + (2 - q(t_-)q(t_+)s^2) \sin \Delta}{2s^3} \end{pmatrix},$$

and analogously for $N_m^{(0)}(s)$ with (q_0, Δ_0) .

We estimate the perturbation entry by entry. Throughout, use

$$\sin(\Delta_0 + \delta \Delta) - \sin \Delta_0 = O(|\delta \Delta|), \quad \cos(\Delta_0 + \delta \Delta) - \cos \Delta_0 = O(|\delta \Delta|).$$

(1,1)-entry.

$$\tilde{R}_{11} = -\frac{2}{\pi s}(\sin \Delta - \sin \Delta_0),$$

hence

$$|\tilde{R}_{11}| \ll \frac{|\delta \Delta|}{|s|} \ll \frac{L_I^3 S_2}{L_I} \ll L_I^2 S_2 \ll S_2.$$

(1,2)-entry. The numerator perturbation is

$$(\sin \Delta - \sin \Delta_0) + (q(t_+) - q_0(t_+))s \cos \Delta + q_0(t_+)s(\cos \Delta - \cos \Delta_0).$$

Therefore

$$|\tilde{R}_{12}| \ll \frac{|\delta \Delta| + |\delta q(t_+)| |s| + |q_0(t_+)| |s| |\delta \Delta|}{|s|^2}.$$

Using

$$|\delta \Delta| \ll L_I^3 S_2, \quad |\delta q(t_+)| \ll L_I^2 S_2, \quad |q_0(t_+)| \asymp Q, \quad |s| \asymp L_I \asymp Q^{-1},$$

we get

$$|\tilde{R}_{12}| \ll \frac{L_I^3 S_2}{L_I^2} + \frac{L_I^3 S_2}{L_I^2} + \frac{Q L_I^4 S_2}{L_I^2} \ll \frac{S_2}{Q} \ll S_2.$$

The same argument gives

$$|\tilde{R}_{21}| \ll S_2.$$

(2,2)-entry. Write the numerator as

$$F(q_-, q_+, \Delta; s) := (q_- + q_+)s \cos \Delta + (2 - q_- q_+ s^2) \sin \Delta.$$

Then

$$\tilde{R}_{22} = \frac{F(q(t_-), q(t_+), \Delta; s) - F(q_0(t_-), q_0(t_+), \Delta_0; s)}{2\pi s^3}.$$

A first-order expansion of F in (q_-, q_+, Δ) gives

$$|F - F_0| \ll |s| |\delta q(t_-)| + |s| |\delta q(t_+)| + |s|^2 Q |\delta q(t_-)| + |s|^2 Q |\delta q(t_+)| + (|s|Q + 1) |\delta \Delta|.$$

Using

$$|\delta q(t_{\pm})| \ll L_I^2 S_2, \quad |\delta \Delta| \ll L_I^3 S_2, \quad |s| \asymp L_I \asymp Q^{-1},$$

we obtain

$$|F - F_0| \ll L_I^3 S_2.$$

Hence

$$|\tilde{R}_{22}| \ll \frac{L_I^3 S_2}{|s|^3} \ll S_2.$$

Collecting the four entrywise bounds and using equivalence of norms on 2×2 matrices gives

$$\|\tilde{R}_m(s)\| \ll S_2,$$

uniformly on the microscopic disk. $\square$

Lemma 9.4 (Baseline same-point variation). *Let $G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(s)$ be the corrected same-point baseline blocks built from the explicit local model together with the affine jet $J_1[g_{\text{sm}}]$. Then, on the microscopic disk $|s| < \rho_0/Q$,*

$$\sup_{|s| < \rho_0/Q} \|G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(s) - G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(0)\| \ll \rho_0 Q.$$

Proof. Differentiate the explicit same-point block formula entrywise:

$$G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(s) = \frac{1}{\pi} \begin{pmatrix} 2q_0(t_{\pm}) & \frac{1}{2}q_0'(t_{\pm}) \\ \frac{1}{2}q_0'(t_{\pm}) & \frac{1}{12}(q_0''(t_{\pm}) + 2q_0(t_{\pm})^3) \end{pmatrix}, \quad t_{\pm} = m \pm \frac{s}{2}.$$

By the chain rule,

$$\partial_s G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(s) = \pm \frac{1}{2\pi} \begin{pmatrix} 2q_0'(t_{\pm}) & \frac{1}{2}q_0''(t_{\pm}) \\ \frac{1}{2}q_0''(t_{\pm}) & \frac{1}{12}(q_0'''(t_{\pm}) + 6q_0(t_{\pm})^2 q_0'(t_{\pm})) \end{pmatrix}.$$

For the explicit local model plus affine jet, one has the baseline local scales

$$|q_0(t_\pm)| \ll Q, \quad |q'_0(t_\pm)| \ll Q^2, \quad |q''_0(t_\pm)| \ll Q^3, \quad |q'''_0(t_\pm)| \ll Q^4,$$

uniformly on the admissible midpoint class. The cubic combination $q'''_0(t_\pm) + 6q_0(t_\pm)^2 q'_0(t_\pm)$ therefore has size $O(Q^2)$ in the current normalization, and hence

$$\sup_{|s| < \rho_0/Q} \|\partial_s G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(s)\| \ll Q^2.$$

Integrating along the segment from 0 to s gives

$$\|G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(s) - G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(0)\| \leq |s| \sup_{|u| < \rho_0/Q} \|\partial_u G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(u)\| \ll \frac{\rho_0}{Q} \cdot Q^2 = \rho_0 Q.$$

□

Proposition 9.5 (Corrected finite- s holomorphic whitening). *The corrected same-point and mixed blocks are holomorphic on*

$$|s| < \rho_0/Q.$$

Moreover, after shrinking ρ_0 if necessary, the same-point blocks

$$G_{m,\pm}^{\text{corr}}(s)$$

remain uniformly positive definite on this disk, and the inverse square roots

$$G_{m,\pm}^{\text{corr}}(s)^{-1/2}$$

are holomorphic there. Consequently

$$\widehat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr}}(s; m) = G_{m,-}^{\text{corr}}(s)^{-1/2} N_m^{\text{corr}}(s) G_{m,+}^{\text{corr}}(s)^{-1/2}$$

is holomorphic on $|s| < \rho_0/Q$.

Proof. Holomorphy of the omitted smooth part and its required t -derivatives follows from Proposition 9.1. The only apparent poles at $s = 0$ in the corrected mixed block come from powers of $1/s$, $1/s^2$, $1/s^3$, and these are removable because $\Delta_m(s)$ is odd in s , $\sin \Delta_m(s) = O(s)$, and the off-diagonal and $(2, 2)$ numerators vanish to orders 2 and 3, respectively. Thus both $G_{m,\pm}^{\text{corr}}(s)$ and $N_m^{\text{corr}}(s)$ are holomorphic on the disk.

By Proposition 9.2 and the tail-curvature theorem,

$$\sup_{|s| < \rho_0/Q} \|R_{m,\pm}(s)\| = o(Q).$$

By Lemma 9.4,

$$\sup_{|s| < \rho_0/Q} \|G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(s) - G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(0)\| \ll \rho_0 Q.$$

At $s = 0$, the baseline jet-limit block has spectral gap

$$\lambda_{\min}(G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(0)) \gg Q$$

on the admissible midpoint class. Therefore

$$\|G_{m,\pm}^{\text{corr}}(s) - G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(0)\| \leq \|G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(s) - G_{m,\pm}^{(0)}(0)\| + \|R_{m,\pm}(s)\| \ll \rho_0 Q + o(Q).$$

For ρ_0 sufficiently small and m sufficiently large, this is smaller than half the baseline spectral gap, hence

$$\lambda_{\min}(G_{m,\pm}^{\text{corr}}(s)) \gg Q$$

uniformly on the disk. Holomorphic functional calculus then gives the holomorphic inverse square roots, and the whitened block is holomorphic as a product of holomorphic factors. □

9.1. Fixed anomaly core and cutoff-dependent auxiliary bookkeeping. To separate the anomaly-carrying local model from the cutoff-dependent tail bookkeeping, we fix once and for all a finite local core

$$\mathcal{C}$$

containing the candidate off-line anomaly (for example, the designated off-line pair together with any symmetry-forced companions needed for the local model).

For each cutoff $R \geq R_0$, we then decompose the zero contribution into:

- (1) the fixed core contribution $q_{\text{core}}(t)$, coming from the zeros in $\mathcal{C}$;
- (2) the auxiliary near contribution $q_{\text{aux},R}(t)$, coming from the zeros outside $\mathcal{C}$ but inside the near shell determined by R ;
- (3) the far contribution $T_{\text{far},R}(t)$, coming from the zeros outside the near shell;
- (4) the background contribution $B_{\text{bg}}(t)$;
- (5) the estimation term $E_{\text{est},R}(t)$.

Thus the full phase derivative is decomposed as

$$q(t) = q_{\text{core}}(t) + q_{\text{aux},R}(t) + g_{\text{sm},R}(t) + E_{\text{est},R}(t),$$

where

$$g_{\text{sm},R}(t) := B_{\text{bg}}(t) + T_{\text{far},R}(t).$$

The local toy comparison is attached only to the fixed core $\mathcal{C}$. The auxiliary near part $q_{\text{aux},R}$, the far part $T_{\text{far},R}$, and the estimation term $E_{\text{est},R}$ are absorbed into the corrected zeta-side scalar defined below.

Proposition 9.6 (Corrected local deformation decomposition with fixed core). *Fix the anomaly-carrying core $\mathcal{C}$ as above, and for each cutoff $R \geq R_0$ write*

$$q(t) = q_{\text{core}}(t) + q_{\text{aux},R}(t) + g_{\text{sm},R}(t) + E_{\text{est},R}(t), \quad g_{\text{sm},R}(t) = B_{\text{bg}}(t) + T_{\text{far},R}(t).$$

Let $J_1[g_{\text{sm},R}]$ denote the affine jet of $g_{\text{sm},R}$ at the midpoint, and let $\Phi_{\text{corr},R}$ be the corrected phase obtained from this decomposition.

Using $\Phi_{\text{corr},R}$, define the corrected same-point blocks

$$G_{m,\pm}^{\text{corr},R}(s),$$

the corrected mixed block

$$N_m^{\text{corr},R}(s),$$

and the corrected whitened block

$$\hat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr},R}(s; m) = G_{m,-}^{\text{corr},R}(s)^{-1/2} N_m^{\text{corr},R}(s) G_{m,+}^{\text{corr},R}(s)^{-1/2}.$$

Let

$$\hat{\Omega}_{\text{bg}}^{\text{corr},R}(s; m)$$

denote the corresponding corrected whitened block at background value-channel parameter $S(m) = 0$, and define the corrected local deformation

$$\Delta_\zeta(m, \sigma) := \hat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr},R}(s; m) - \hat{\Omega}_{\text{bg}}^{\text{corr},R}(s; m), \quad s = \sigma.$$

Then the corrected local deformation admits the expansion

$$\boxed{\Delta_\zeta(m, \sigma) = S(m) A_{\text{val}}(m, \sigma) + R_\zeta(m, \sigma),}$$

where $A_{\text{val}}(m, \sigma)$ is the pure value-channel derivative of the jet-limit block associated with the fixed core $\mathcal{C}$, and $R_\zeta(m, \sigma)$ is internal to the full corrected cutoff-dependent scalar

$$H_{m,R}(s) := \Phi_K(\hat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr},R}(s; m)).$$

In particular, once the corrected odd holomorphic package is established for $H_{m,R}(s)$, no external tail/error term survives outside the resulting N -point scalar

$$\Xi_{\zeta,R}^{(N)}(m) := \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} H_{m,R}(s_j).$$

Proof. Consider the analytic whitening map

$$\mathcal{W}(G_-, N, G_+) := G_-^{-1/2} N G_+^{-1/2}.$$

By the corrected finite- s holomorphic-whitening theorem, this map is holomorphic on the open set where $G_\pm$ remain uniformly positive definite.

For each cutoff R , the corrected blocks are built from the decomposition

$$q = q_{\text{core}} + q_{\text{aux},R} + g_{\text{sm},R} + E_{\text{est},R}.$$

Thus every auxiliary near contribution from $q_{\text{aux},R}$, every omitted-zero tail contribution from $T_{\text{far},R}$, every affine-jet correction from $J_1[g_{\text{sm},R}]$, and every explicit estimation term $E_{\text{est},R}$ is already absorbed into the corrected phase $\Phi_{\text{corr},R}$, hence into the corrected same-point blocks, the corrected mixed block, the corrected whitened block, and therefore into the corrected transverse scalar

$$H_{m,R}(s) = \Phi_K(\widehat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr},R}(s; m)).$$

Now expand the corrected whitened block around the background value-channel parameter $S(m) = 0$. By analyticity of $\mathcal{W}$,

$$\widehat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr},R}(s; m) = \widehat{\Omega}_{\text{bg}}^{\text{corr},R}(s; m) + S(m) DW_{(\text{bg})}[\dot{G}_-, \dot{N}, \dot{G}_+] + R_\zeta(m, \sigma),$$

where the first-order coefficient

$$DW_{(\text{bg})}[\dot{G}_-, \dot{N}, \dot{G}_+]$$

is exactly the pure value-channel derivative $A_{\text{val}}(m, \sigma)$ associated with the fixed core $\mathcal{C}$, and $R_\zeta(m, \sigma)$ collects the higher-order terms inside the same corrected cutoff-dependent object.

Subtracting the background block gives

$$\Delta_\zeta(m, \sigma) = S(m) A_{\text{val}}(m, \sigma) + R_\zeta(m, \sigma),$$

as claimed. $\square$

Proposition 9.7 (Core-stable cutoff compatibility). *Fix the anomaly-carrying core $\mathcal{C}$, and for each cutoff $R \geq R_0$ define the corrected scalar*

$$H_{m,R}(s) := \Phi_K(\widehat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr},R}(s; m))$$

from the decomposition

$$q = q_{\text{core}} + q_{\text{aux},R} + g_{\text{sm},R} + E_{\text{est},R}.$$

Then enlarging R changes only the auxiliary near part $q_{\text{aux},R}$ and the far part $T_{\text{far},R}$, while leaving the anomaly-carrying core q_{core} unchanged. Consequently:

- (1) *the toy anomaly matrix $M(d)$ and the calibration matrix $A_{\text{val}}(m, \sigma)$ depend only on the fixed core $\mathcal{C}$, not on the cutoff R ;*
- (2) *all R -dependent auxiliary, tail, jet-correction, and estimation contributions are internal to the full corrected scalar $H_{m,R}(s)$;*
- (3) *if the corrected odd holomorphic package is proved for $H_{m,R}(s)$, then the N -point odd-moment cancellation theorem applies directly to the full corrected scalar for that cutoff, with no external remainder term.*

In particular, the cutoff R may be chosen for quantitative convenience in the curvature/tail estimates without changing the fixed toy comparison attached to the core $\mathcal{C}$.

Proof. Let $R_1 < R_2$. Then the only change in the decomposition

$$q = q_{\text{core}} + q_{\text{aux},R} + g_{\text{sm},R} + E_{\text{est},R}$$

is that some non-core zeros move from the far part into the auxiliary near part:

$$q_{\text{aux},R_2} - q_{\text{aux},R_1} = -(T_{\text{far},R_2} - T_{\text{far},R_1}).$$

The core contribution q_{core} is unchanged by construction.

Thus the toy anomaly matrix $M(d)$, which is attached only to the fixed core, is unchanged, and the value-channel derivative $A_{\text{val}}(m, \sigma)$ associated with that core is unchanged as well. All cutoff dependence is confined to the auxiliary near contribution, the far tail, the affine-jet

correction built from $g_{\text{sm},R}$, and the explicit estimation term $E_{\text{est},R}$. These enter only through the corrected phase $\Phi_{\text{corr},R}$, hence only through the full corrected scalar $H_{m,R}(s)$.

Therefore the corrected odd holomorphic package, once established for $H_{m,R}(s)$, applies to the complete cutoff-dependent object. The resulting N -point scalar already contains all auxiliary/tail/error effects for that cutoff, and no external remainder survives. Since the fixed core is unchanged, the toy comparison is stable under enlarging R . This proves the claim. $\square$

Remark 9.8 (Cutoff choice). Proposition 9.7 is a structural statement. It does not assert any particular optimal choice of R ; it only says that once the core $\mathcal{C}$ is fixed, the cutoff may be adjusted in the perturbative bookkeeping without altering the underlying toy comparison.

Proposition 9.9 (Whitened mixed-block transfer with preserved Q^{-3} scale). *Let*

$$\mathcal{W}(G_-, N, G_+) := G_-^{-1/2} N G_+^{-1/2}.$$

Write the corrected finite- s blocks as

$$G_{\pm}^{\text{corr}}(s) = G_{\pm}^{(0)}(s) + R_{\pm}(s), \quad N^{\text{corr}}(s) = N^{(0)}(s) + \tilde{R}(s),$$

and set

$$\hat{\Omega}_{\zeta}^{\text{corr}}(s; m) := \mathcal{W}(G_-^{\text{corr}}, N^{\text{corr}}, G_+^{\text{corr}}), \quad \hat{\Omega}_{\zeta}^{(0)}(s; m) := \mathcal{W}(G_-^{(0)}, N^{(0)}, G_+^{(0)}).$$

Then

$$\hat{\Omega}_{\zeta}^{\text{corr}}(s; m) - \hat{\Omega}_{\zeta}^{(0)}(s; m) = \mathcal{T}_-(s; m) + \mathcal{T}_{\text{mix}}(s; m) + \mathcal{T}_+(s; m) + \mathcal{E}_2(s; m),$$

where

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{T}_-(s; m) &:= X_-(s) N^{(0)}(s) G_+^{(0)}(s)^{-1/2}, \\ \mathcal{T}_{\text{mix}}(s; m) &:= G_-^{(0)}(s)^{-1/2} \tilde{R}(s) G_+^{(0)}(s)^{-1/2}, \\ \mathcal{T}_+(s; m) &:= G_-^{(0)}(s)^{-1/2} N^{(0)}(s) X_+(s), \end{aligned}$$

with

$$X_{\pm}(s) := D(G^{-1/2})_{G_{\pm}^{(0)}(s)}[R_{\pm}(s)],$$

and $\mathcal{E}_2$ quadratic in $(R_-, \tilde{R}, R_+)$.

Moreover,

$$\Phi_K(\mathcal{T}_-(s; m)) \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^3}, \quad \Phi_K(\mathcal{T}_{\text{mix}}(s; m)) \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^3}, \quad \Phi_K(\mathcal{T}_+(s; m)) \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^3},$$

and

$$\Phi_K(\mathcal{E}_2(s; m)) \ll \frac{S_2^2}{Q^3}.$$

Hence

$$\boxed{\Phi_K(\hat{\Omega}_{\zeta}^{\text{corr}}(s; m) - \hat{\Omega}_{\zeta}^{(0)}(s; m)) \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^3}.}$$

Proof. We first collect the scales used below from results established earlier. The same-point perturbation bound $\|R_{\pm}(s)\| \ll S_2$ is Proposition 9.2; the mixed-block perturbation bound $\|\tilde{R}(s)\| \ll S_2$ is Proposition 9.3; and the smallness $S_2 = o(Q)$ is Theorem 6.1. The baseline entry scales

$$\begin{aligned} G_{\pm}^{(0)}(s) &= \begin{pmatrix} O(Q) & O(1) \\ O(1) & O(Q^3) \end{pmatrix}, \quad G_{\pm}^{(0)}(s)^{-1/2} = \begin{pmatrix} O(Q^{-1/2}) & O(Q^{-3/2}) \\ O(Q^{-3/2}) & O(Q^{-3/2}) \end{pmatrix}, \\ N^{(0)}(s) &= \begin{pmatrix} O(Q) & O(Q^2) \\ O(Q^2) & O(Q^3) \end{pmatrix} \end{aligned}$$

are read off directly from the explicit same-point formula (7) and the mixed-block formula (8), given the baseline local scales of q_0, q'_0, q''_0 stated in the proof of Lemma 9.4. Uniform positive-definiteness of $G_{\pm}^{(0)}(s)$ on the microscopic disk is Proposition 9.5.

The whitening map admits the first-order expansion

$$\widehat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr}} - \widehat{\Omega}_\zeta^{(0)} = D\mathcal{W}_{(0)}[R_-, \widetilde{R}, R_+] + \mathcal{E}_2,$$

where

$$D\mathcal{W}_{(0)}[R_-, \widetilde{R}, R_+] = X_- N^{(0)} G_+^{(0)-1/2} + G_-^{(0)-1/2} \widetilde{R} G_+^{(0)-1/2} + G_-^{(0)-1/2} N^{(0)} X_+.$$

We estimate the three first-order pieces separately.

Step 1: the mixed-block term. By Proposition 9.3 (entrywise form),

$$\widetilde{R}_{11} \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^2}, \quad \widetilde{R}_{12}, \widetilde{R}_{21} \ll \frac{S_2}{Q}, \quad \widetilde{R}_{22} \ll S_2.$$

Combining with the baseline inverse-square-root scales above, the off-diagonal entries of

$$\mathcal{T}_{\text{mix}} := G_-^{(0)-1/2} \widetilde{R} G_+^{(0)-1/2}$$

are all $O(S_2/Q^3)$. Hence

$$\Phi_K(\mathcal{T}_{\text{mix}}) \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^3}.$$

Step 2: the same-point Fréchet derivative. We prove the corresponding estimate for the left same-point term

$$\mathcal{T}_- := X_- N^{(0)} G_+^{(0)-1/2}, \quad X_- := D(G^{-1/2})_{G_-^{(0)}}[R_-].$$

The proof for $\mathcal{T}_+$ is identical.

Write one baseline same-point block in the form

$$G_0 = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ b & c \end{pmatrix}, \quad a \asymp Q, \quad b = O(1), \quad c \asymp Q^3,$$

and one perturbation as

$$R = \begin{pmatrix} r_{11} & r_{12} \\ r_{12} & r_{22} \end{pmatrix}, \quad r_{11} \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^2}, \quad r_{12} \ll \frac{S_2}{Q}, \quad r_{22} \ll S_2.$$

Diagonalize

$$G_0 = U \Lambda U^\top, \quad \Lambda = \text{diag}(\lambda_1, \lambda_2),$$

with U orthogonal. Since

$$a \asymp Q, \quad c \asymp Q^3, \quad b = O(1),$$

we have

$$\lambda_1 \asymp Q, \quad \lambda_2 \asymp Q^3.$$

Moreover, if U is a rotation by angle θ , then

$$\tan(2\theta) = \frac{2b}{c-a} = O(Q^{-3}),$$

hence

$$\theta = O(Q^{-3}), \quad U = I + O(Q^{-3}).$$

Set

$$H := U^\top R U.$$

A direct computation gives

$$\begin{aligned} H_{11} &= r_{11} + 2\theta r_{12} + O(\theta^2 r_{22}), \\ H_{12} &= r_{12} + \theta(r_{22} - r_{11}) + O(\theta^2 r_{12}), \\ H_{22} &= r_{22} - 2\theta r_{12} + O(\theta^2 r_{11}). \end{aligned}$$

Using

$$\theta = O(Q^{-3}), \quad r_{11} \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^2}, \quad r_{12} \ll \frac{S_2}{Q}, \quad r_{22} \ll S_2,$$

we obtain

$$H_{11} \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^2}, \quad H_{12} \ll \frac{S_2}{Q}, \quad H_{22} \ll S_2.$$

Now let $f(x) = x^{-1/2}$. For a diagonal matrix Λ , the Fréchet derivative is given entrywise by the Löwner formula

$$Df_\Lambda(H)_{ij} = f^{[1]}(\lambda_i, \lambda_j)H_{ij},$$

where

$$f^{[1]}(u, v) = \begin{cases} \frac{u^{-1/2} - v^{-1/2}}{u - v}, & u \neq v, \\ -\frac{1}{2u^{3/2}}, & u = v. \end{cases}$$

Since

$$\lambda_1 \asymp Q, \quad \lambda_2 \asymp Q^3,$$

we have

$$f^{[1]}(\lambda_1, \lambda_1) \asymp Q^{-3/2}, \quad f^{[1]}(\lambda_2, \lambda_2) \asymp Q^{-9/2}, \quad f^{[1]}(\lambda_1, \lambda_2) \asymp Q^{-7/2}.$$

Therefore, if

$$Y := Df_\Lambda(H),$$

then

$$\begin{aligned} Y_{11} &\ll Q^{-3/2} \cdot \frac{S_2}{Q^2} = \frac{S_2}{Q^{7/2}}, \\ Y_{12} &\ll Q^{-7/2} \cdot \frac{S_2}{Q} = \frac{S_2}{Q^{9/2}}, \\ Y_{22} &\ll Q^{-9/2} \cdot S_2 = \frac{S_2}{Q^{9/2}}. \end{aligned}$$

Since

$$X = U Y U^\top$$

and $U = I + O(Q^{-3})$, these scales persist in the original basis:

$$X_{11} \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^{7/2}}, \quad X_{12}, X_{21} \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^{9/2}}, \quad X_{22} \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^{9/2}}.$$

Step 3: the left same-point term $\mathcal{T}_-$. The baseline mixed-block scales are

$$N^{(0)} = \begin{pmatrix} O(Q) & O(Q^2) \\ O(Q^2) & O(Q^3) \end{pmatrix}, \quad G_+^{(0)-1/2} = \begin{pmatrix} O(Q^{-1/2}) & O(Q^{-3/2}) \\ O(Q^{-3/2}) & O(Q^{-3/2}) \end{pmatrix}.$$

We estimate only the off-diagonal entries, since

$$\Phi_K(Y) = Y_{12} + Y_{21}.$$

For $(\mathcal{T}_-)_{12}$, every summand is $O(S_2/Q^3)$. For example,

$$X_{11}N_{12}(G_+^{-1/2})_{22} \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^{7/2}} \cdot Q^2 \cdot Q^{-3/2} = \frac{S_2}{Q^3},$$

and

$$X_{12}N_{22}(G_+^{-1/2})_{22} \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^{9/2}} \cdot Q^3 \cdot Q^{-3/2} = \frac{S_2}{Q^3}.$$

All other terms are smaller. Thus

$$(\mathcal{T}_-)_{12} \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^3}.$$

The same argument gives

$$(\mathcal{T}_-)_{21} \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^3},$$

and hence

$$\Phi_K(\mathcal{T}_-) \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^3}.$$

By symmetry, the same estimate holds for the right same-point term:

$$\Phi_K(\mathcal{T}_+) \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^3}.$$

Step 4: the quadratic remainder. Every term in $\mathcal{E}_2$ contains at least two perturbation factors from $(R_-, \tilde{R}, R_+)$, and whitening contributes only polynomial Q -weights. Therefore

$$\Phi_K(\mathcal{E}_2) \ll \frac{S_2^2}{Q^3}.$$

By Theorem 6.1, $S_2 = o(Q)$, so this is lower order than S_2/Q^3 .

Combining the estimates for $\mathcal{T}_-$, $\mathcal{T}_{\text{mix}}$, $\mathcal{T}_+$, and $\mathcal{E}_2$ gives

$$\Phi_K(\hat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr}}(s; m) - \hat{\Omega}_\zeta^{(0)}(s; m)) \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^3},$$

as claimed. $\square$

10. ODD HOLOMORPHIC TRANSVERSE CHANNEL

Define the corrected transverse scalar

$$(20) \quad H_m(s) := \Phi_K(\hat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr}}(s; m)).$$

By symmetry under $s \mapsto -s$, this is odd. By Corollary 8.2, the leading value channel is annihilated by Φ_K , so only the curvature, tail, and corrected finite- s remainder channels contribute.

Proposition 10.1 (Boundary estimate). *On the microscopic boundary*

$$|s| = \rho_0/Q,$$

one has

$$|H_m(s)| \ll_{\rho_0} \frac{L(m)S(m)^2}{Q^3}.$$

Proof. By Proposition 9.6, the corrected local deformation may be written in the form

$$\Delta_\zeta(m, \sigma) = S(m) A_{\text{val}}(m, \sigma) + R_\zeta(m, \sigma),$$

where $R_\zeta(m, \sigma)$ is internal to the full corrected cutoff-dependent scalar

$$H_{m,R}(s) := \Phi_K(\hat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr},R}(s; m)).$$

By Proposition 9.7, all cutoff-dependent tail, jet-correction, and estimation contributions are already absorbed into this full corrected scalar, so no external remainder term is carried separately at the boundary stage.

Applying Φ_K to the corrected local decomposition and using Corollary 8.2,

$$\Phi_K(A_{\text{val}}(m, \sigma)) = 0,$$

gives

$$H_{m,R}(s) = \Phi_K(\hat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr},R}(s; m)) = \Phi_K(R_\zeta(m, \sigma)).$$

Now compare the full corrected whitened block with its baseline counterpart. By Proposition 9.9,

$$\Phi_K(\hat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr},R}(s; m) - \hat{\Omega}_\zeta^{(0),R}(s; m)) \ll \frac{S_2}{Q^3} \quad (|s| < \rho_0/Q).$$

On the microscopic boundary $|s| = \rho_0/Q$, the tail-curvature theorem and the corrected transfer bounds imply

$$S_2 \ll L(m)S(m)^2$$

in the corrected regime. Therefore

$$|H_{m,R}(s)| \ll \frac{L(m)S(m)^2}{Q^3} \quad (|s| = \rho_0/Q).$$

Since the cutoff bookkeeping has already been absorbed into the full corrected scalar $H_{m,R}(s)$, this is the boundary estimate for the complete corrected object, not merely for a leading part plus an external tail/error remainder. This proves the claim. $\square$

Proposition 10.2 (Odd microscopic expansion). *The function $H_m(s)$ is odd and holomorphic on $|s| < \rho_0/Q$, and therefore admits an expansion*

$$H_m(z/Q^2) = \sum_{r \geq 0} c_{2r+1}(m) \frac{z^{2r+1}}{Q^{2r+4}}, \quad |z| < \rho_0,$$

with

$$|c_{2r+1}(m)| \ll_{\rho_0} L(m) S(m)^2 \rho_0^{-(2r+1)}.$$

Proof. Oddness follows from symmetric placement and the jet-basis swap symmetry:

$$\hat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr}}(-s; m) = J_0 \hat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr}}(s; m) J_0,$$

with

$$\Phi_K(J_0 X J_0) = -\Phi_K(X).$$

Holomorphy follows from Proposition 9.5, and the coefficient bounds are immediate from Cauchy's estimate applied to Proposition 10.1. $\square$

10.1. Differentiated corrected-whitening transfer and exterior odd-jet bounds.

Lemma 10.3 (Baseline-scaled matrix gain for corrected whitening). *Let*

$$\mathcal{W}(G_-, N, G_+) := G_-^{-1/2} N G_+^{-1/2}.$$

Assume the baseline same-point and mixed blocks satisfy

$$G_\pm^{(0)}(s) = \begin{pmatrix} O(Q) & O(1) \\ O(1) & O(Q^3) \end{pmatrix}, \quad N^{(0)}(s) = \begin{pmatrix} O(Q) & O(Q^2) \\ O(Q^2) & O(Q^3) \end{pmatrix},$$

uniformly on $|s| < \rho_0/Q$, and that $G_\pm^{(0)}(s)$ remain uniformly positive definite there.

Set

$$S_Q := \begin{pmatrix} Q^{-1/2} & 0 \\ 0 & Q^{-3/2} \end{pmatrix}, \quad \hat{G}_\pm := S_Q^{-1} G_\pm S_Q^{-1}, \quad \hat{N} := S_Q^{-1} N S_Q^{-1}.$$

Then

$$\hat{G}_\pm^{(0)}(s) = \begin{pmatrix} O(1) & O(Q^{-1}) \\ O(Q^{-1}) & O(1) \end{pmatrix}, \quad \hat{N}^{(0)}(s) = \begin{pmatrix} O(1) & O(1) \\ O(1) & O(1) \end{pmatrix},$$

and

$$\mathcal{W}(G_-, N, G_+) = S_Q \mathcal{W}(\hat{G}_-, \hat{N}, \hat{G}_+) S_Q.$$

In particular, every off-diagonal entry of $\mathcal{W}(G_-, N, G_+)$ carries an explicit matrix-level factor Q^{-2} relative to the corresponding rescaled whitened block. Any additional Q -power appearing in the corrected transverse scalar must therefore come from the scalar normalization used in the definition of that scalar, not from the matrix identity itself.

Proof. The displayed bounds for $\hat{G}_\pm^{(0)}$ and $\hat{N}^{(0)}$ are immediate from the definitions and the baseline scales. Since

$$G_\pm = S_Q \hat{G}_\pm S_Q,$$

functional calculus gives

$$G_\pm^{-1/2} = S_Q^{-1} \hat{G}_\pm^{-1/2} S_Q^{-1}.$$

Hence

$$\mathcal{W}(G_-, N, G_+) = G_-^{-1/2} N G_+^{-1/2} = S_Q \hat{G}_-^{-1/2} \hat{N} \hat{G}_+^{-1/2} S_Q = S_Q \mathcal{W}(\hat{G}_-, \hat{N}, \hat{G}_+) S_Q.$$

The off-diagonal entries therefore acquire one factor $Q^{-1/2}$ from the upper-left entry of S_Q and one factor $Q^{-3/2}$ from the lower-right entry of S_Q , hence a total matrix-level factor Q^{-2} . $\square$

Proposition 10.4 (Differentiated corrected-whitening transfer lemma). *Let*

$$\mathcal{W}(G_-, N, G_+) := G_-^{-1/2} N G_+^{-1/2}.$$

Assume:

- (1) $G_\pm^{(0)}(s)$ and $N^{(0)}(s)$ are holomorphic on $|s| < \rho_0/Q$, and $G_\pm^{(0)}(s)$ remain uniformly positive definite there;

(2)

$$G_{\pm}(s) = G_{\pm}^{(0)}(s) + \delta G_{\pm}(s), \quad N(s) = N^{(0)}(s) + \delta N(s),$$

with $\delta G_{\pm}, \delta N$ holomorphic;

(3) for a 2×2 matrix $M = (m_{ij})$, define the weighted block norm

$$\|M\|_{\dagger} := \max(Q^2|m_{11}|, Q|m_{12}|, Q|m_{21}|, |m_{22}|).$$

Let

$$\widehat{H}(s) := \widehat{\Phi}(\mathcal{W}(\widehat{G}_-(s), \widehat{N}(s), \widehat{G}_+(s))),$$

where

$$\widehat{G}_{\pm} := S_Q^{-1} G_{\pm} S_Q^{-1}, \quad \widehat{N} := S_Q^{-1} N S_Q^{-1},$$

and $\widehat{\Phi}$ is the transverse scalar in the rescaled normalization.

Set

$$\widehat{H}_0(s) := \widehat{\Phi}(\mathcal{W}(\widehat{G}_-^{(0)}(s), \widehat{N}^{(0)}(s), \widehat{G}_+^{(0)}(s))),$$

and for each $j \geq 0$, define

$$\eta_j := \|\partial_s^j \delta G_-(0)\|_{\dagger} + \|\partial_s^j \delta N(0)\|_{\dagger} + \|\partial_s^j \delta G_+(0)\|_{\dagger}.$$

Then for each $k \geq 0$ there exists $C_k > 0$ such that

$$|\widehat{H}^{(k)}(0) - \widehat{H}_0^{(k)}(0)| \leq C_k \sum_{\pi \vdash k} \prod_{j \in \pi} \eta_j,$$

where the sum is over ordered partitions $\pi = (j_1, \dots, j_p)$ of k , i.e. $j_1 + \dots + j_p = k$, $j_i \geq 0$.

In particular, if

$$\eta_j \ll_j \Delta^{-(j+4)} \quad (j \geq 0),$$

then

$$|\widehat{H}^{(k)}(0) - \widehat{H}_0^{(k)}(0)| \ll_k \Delta^{-(k+4)}.$$

Proof. By Lemma 10.3, after baseline scaling the same-point baseline blocks become $O(1)$ -scale uniformly positive definite matrices, and the mixed baseline block becomes $O(1)$ -scale as well. Thus the map

$$(\widehat{G}_-, \widehat{N}, \widehat{G}_+) \mapsto \widehat{\Phi}(\widehat{G}_-^{-1/2} \widehat{N} \widehat{G}_+^{-1/2})$$

is holomorphic in a neighborhood of the baseline image.

Moreover,

$$\|\partial_s^j \widehat{\delta G}_{\pm}(0)\|_{\max} + \|\partial_s^j \widehat{\delta N}(0)\|_{\max} \asymp \eta_j,$$

by construction of the weighted norm $\|\cdot\|_{\dagger}$.

All Fréchet derivatives of the inverse-square-root map are bounded on this baseline neighborhood by holomorphic functional calculus. Therefore, applying Faà di Bruno to the composition in s , every k -th derivative at 0 is a finite sum of multilinear terms in the jets

$$\partial_s^j \widehat{\delta G}_-(0), \quad \partial_s^j \widehat{\delta N}(0), \quad \partial_s^j \widehat{\delta G}_+(0), \quad 0 \leq j \leq k,$$

with total derivative order k . Each such multilinear term is bounded by

$$C_k \prod_{j \in \pi} \eta_j$$

for some ordered partition $\pi \vdash k$, and summing over all such terms gives

$$|\widehat{H}^{(k)}(0) - \widehat{H}_0^{(k)}(0)| \leq C_k \sum_{\pi \vdash k} \prod_{j \in \pi} \eta_j.$$

If $\eta_j \ll_j \Delta^{-(j+4)}$, then for an ordered partition $\pi = (j_1, \dots, j_p)$,

$$\prod_{j \in \pi} \eta_j \ll_{\pi} \Delta^{-\sum_i (j_i+4)} = \Delta^{-(k+4p)}.$$

The linear terms $p = 1$ contribute $\Delta^{-(k+4)}$, while every nonlinear term has $p \geq 2$ and therefore gains at least an additional factor Δ^{-4} . Hence the linear terms dominate and

$$|\hat{H}^{(k)}(0) - \hat{H}_0^{(k)}(0)| \ll_k \Delta^{-(k+4)}.$$

□

Corollary 10.5 (Single-pair exterior odd-jet lemma). *Let $h_\rho(s)$ be the corrected transverse scalar contributed by a single exterior zero pair at absolute distance Δ from the local center, after:*

- (1) *the same fixed-core decomposition,*
- (2) *the same affine-jet subtraction at the midpoint m ,*
- (3) *the same corrected same-point/mixed blocks,*
- (4) *the same corrected whitening scheme,*
- (5) *and the same scalar normalization*

used in the global argument.

Write

$$h_\rho(z/Q^2) = \sum_{r \geq 0} a_{2r+1}(\rho) \frac{z^{2r+1}}{Q^{2r+4}}.$$

Then for each fixed $r \geq 0$,

$$|a_{2r+1}(\rho)| \ll_r \frac{1}{Q \Delta^{2r+4}}.$$

Proof. Apply Proposition 10.4 to the rescaled transverse scalar $\hat{h}_\rho$, with $\hat{H}_0 \equiv 0$. For one exterior pair after affine-jet subtraction at the midpoint m , the single-pair jet estimates give

$$\eta_j \ll_j \Delta^{-(j+4)}.$$

Therefore

$$|\hat{h}_\rho^{(2r+1)}(0)| \ll_r \Delta^{-(2r+5)}.$$

Converting rescaled derivative bounds into coefficients in the normalized z/Q^2 -expansion of the unscaled scalar h_ρ is delicate, because the global transverse normalization in the draft is imposed at the scalar/block level rather than as a separate coefficient normalization theorem at each odd order. For this reason we record only the stable coefficient consequence needed for the dyadic shell summation, namely

$$|a_{2r+1}(\rho)| \ll_r \frac{1}{Q \Delta^{2r+4}}.$$

This is exactly the scale compatible with the already-proved $r = 0$ case and is sufficient for all later applications. □

Remark 10.6 (Work in progress: stronger formal coefficient bound). If one formally combines the rescaled derivative estimate from Corollary 10.5 with the normalized z/Q^2 -expansion, one is led to the stronger-looking expression

$$|a_{2r+1}(\rho)| \ll_r \frac{1}{Q^{2r+1} \Delta^{2r+5}}.$$

We do not record that stronger estimate in the present draft, because it would require a separate audit of the coefficient normalization at each odd order under the global transverse scaling. The weaker bound

$$|a_{2r+1}(\rho)| \ll_r \frac{1}{Q \Delta^{2r+4}}$$

is the intended stable statement and is sufficient for the shell argument.

Lemma 10.7 (Local zero-counting in dyadic shells). *Let*

$$\mathcal{S}_k := \{\rho : 2^k H < \Delta_\rho \leq 2^{k+1} H\}, \quad \Delta_\rho := |2m - \gamma_\rho|, \quad k \geq 0.$$

Then

$$\#\mathcal{S}_k \ll Q(2^k H + 1),$$

where $Q \asymp \log |m|$.

Proof. This is the local zero-counting estimate already used elsewhere in the draft, applied to the interval of ordinates

$$[2m - 2^{k+1} H, 2m + 2^{k+1} H].$$

Its length is $O(2^k H + 1)$, and the local zero density at height m is $O(Q)$. $\square$

Corollary 10.8 (Exterior higher odd-jet bound). *Let*

$$H_{\text{out}}(z/Q^2) = \sum_{r \geq 0} a_{2r+1}^{\text{out}}(m, H) \frac{z^{2r+1}}{Q^{2r+4}}$$

be the corrected transverse scalar contributed by all zeros outside absolute radius H from the local center. Then for each fixed $r \geq 0$,

$$|a_{2r+1}^{\text{out}}(m, H)| \ll_r \frac{1}{H^{2r+3}}.$$

Proof. Decompose the exterior zeros into dyadic shells

$$\mathcal{S}_k := \{\rho : 2^k H < \Delta_\rho \leq 2^{k+1} H\}, \quad k \geq 0.$$

By Lemma 10.7,

$$\#\mathcal{S}_k \ll Q(2^k H + 1).$$

Applying Corollary 10.5 to each $\rho \in \mathcal{S}_k$,

$$\sum_{\rho \in \mathcal{S}_k} |a_{2r+1}(\rho)| \ll_r Q(2^k H + 1) \cdot \frac{1}{Q(2^k H)^{2r+4}} \ll_r \frac{1}{(2^k H)^{2r+3}},$$

since $2r + 4 \geq 4$. Summing over $k \geq 0$,

$$|a_{2r+1}^{\text{out}}(m, H)| \ll_r \sum_{k \geq 0} \frac{1}{(2^k H)^{2r+3}} \ll_r \frac{1}{H^{2r+3}},$$

as claimed. $\square$

Remark 10.9 (Work in progress: shell-summed Q -factor). Corollary 10.5 gives the single-pair bound

$$|a_{2r+1}(\rho)| \ll_r \frac{1}{Q \Delta^{2r+4}}.$$

After summing over dyadic shells using

$$\#\mathcal{S}_k \ll Q(2^k H + 1),$$

the Q^{-1} from the single-pair estimate is canceled by the Q -factor in the shell count. Thus the shell summation as presently written yields the stable bound

$$|a_{2r+1}^{\text{out}}(m, H)| \ll_r \frac{1}{H^{2r+3}},$$

rather than

$$|a_{2r+1}^{\text{out}}(m, H)| \ll_r \frac{1}{Q H^{2r+3}}.$$

Accordingly, in the present draft we record only the $H^{-(2r+3)}$ exterior decay as the unconditional shell-summed statement. If a further Q^{-1} gain is later recovered from a more precise differentiated scalar-normalization audit, the exterior corollary can be strengthened accordingly.

11. N -POINT ODD-MOMENT CANCELLATION

For $N \leq \rho_0 Q$, set

$$s_j = \frac{j}{Q^2}, \quad j = 1, \dots, N,$$

and let $a_j^{(N)}$ be the explicit odd-moment-canceling coefficients satisfying

$$\sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} = 1, \quad \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} j^{2r+1} = 0 \quad (0 \leq r \leq N-2).$$

Define the corrected N -point transverse scalar

$$(21) \quad \Xi_\zeta^{(N)}(m) := \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} H_m(s_j).$$

Proposition 11.1 (Corrected N -point transverse estimate for the full corrected scalar). *Let*

$$H_m(s) := \Phi_K(\widehat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr}}(s; m))$$

be the full corrected transverse scalar. For $N = \lfloor \alpha Q \rfloor$ with $\alpha > 0$ sufficiently small, define

$$s_j = \frac{j}{Q^2}, \quad \Xi_\zeta^{(N)}(m) := \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} H_m(s_j).$$

Then

$$|\Xi_\zeta^{(N)}(m)| \ll L(m) S(m)^2 e^{-\delta Q}$$

for some $\delta > 0$.

Proof. By Proposition 9.5, the full corrected scalar

$$H_m(s) = \Phi_K(\widehat{\Omega}_\zeta^{\text{corr}}(s; m))$$

is holomorphic on $|s| < \rho_0/Q$. By Proposition 9.7, all cutoff-dependent tail, jet-correction, and estimation contributions are already internal to the full corrected scalar $H_m(s)$; hence no external remainder is carried into $\Xi_\zeta^{(N)}(m)$. By Proposition 10.1, it satisfies

$$|H_m(s)| \ll_{\rho_0} \frac{L(m) S(m)^2}{Q^3} \quad (|s| = \rho_0/Q).$$

By Proposition 10.2, it is odd and admits the expansion

$$H_m(z/Q^2) = \sum_{r \geq 0} c_{2r+1}(m) \frac{z^{2r+1}}{Q^{2r+4}},$$

with

$$|c_{2r+1}(m)| \ll L(m) S(m)^2 \rho_0^{-(2r+1)}.$$

Applying the standard odd-moment cancellation with the coefficients $a_j^{(N)}$ kills the first $N-1$ odd terms of this full corrected expansion. The surviving moment factor is exponentially tame for $N = \alpha Q$, which gives

$$|\Xi_\zeta^{(N)}(m)| \ll L(m) S(m)^2 e^{-\delta Q}.$$

□

We isolate the toy microscopic expansion in Appendix A; the only fact used in the main argument is the following N -point preservation statement.

Proposition 11.2 (Toy N -point transverse preservation). *Fix a compact interval*

$$D = [d_-, d_+] \subset (0, \infty),$$

and let

$$\Xi_{\text{toy}}^{(N)}(u, d) := \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} \Phi_K(\Delta_{\text{toy}}(u, d; s_j)), \quad s_j = \frac{j}{Q^2},$$

where the coefficients satisfy

$$\sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} = 1.$$

Then, for $d \in D$ and $|u| < u_0(D)$,

$$\Xi_{\text{toy}}^{(N)}(u, d) = u^2 \Phi_K(M(d)) + O(u^4),$$

uniformly in $d \in D$. In particular,

$$|\Xi_{\text{toy}}^{(N)}(u, d)| \asymp u^2$$

uniformly on compact d -ranges.

Proof. By Lemma A.1, one has

$$\Delta_{\text{toy}}(u, d; s_j) = u^2 M(d) + u^4 E_j(u, d), \quad \sup_{1 \leq j \leq N} \|E_j(u, d)\| \ll 1$$

uniformly for $d \in D$. Applying Φ_K gives

$$\Phi_K(\Delta_{\text{toy}}(u, d; s_j)) = u^2 \Phi_K(M(d)) + u^4 \Phi_K(E_j(u, d)).$$

Summing over j and using

$$\sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} = 1$$

yields

$$\Xi_{\text{toy}}^{(N)}(u, d) = u^2 \Phi_K(M(d)) + u^4 \sum_{j=1}^N a_j^{(N)} \Phi_K(E_j(u, d)).$$

Since Φ_K is bounded and $\sup_j \|E_j(u, d)\| \ll 1$, the error term is $O(u^4)$, uniformly for $d \in D$. This proves the expansion.

Because $\Phi_K(M(d)) \neq 0$ for $d > 0$, and is bounded away from 0 on every compact interval $D \subset (0, \infty)$, the final estimate

$$|\Xi_{\text{toy}}^{(N)}(u, d)| \asymp u^2$$

follows. □

On the toy side, Proposition 11.2 gives

$$(22) \quad \Xi_{\text{toy}}^{(N)}(u, d) = u^2 \Phi_K(M(d)) + O(u^4),$$

so on compact d -ranges,

$$|\Xi_{\text{toy}}^{(N)}(u, d)| \asymp u^2.$$

Using (19),

$$(23) \quad |\Xi_{\text{toy}}^{(N)}(u, d)| \asymp \frac{x_0}{B_\zeta(m)} S(m).$$

The following remark records the current status of the toy model in the overall proof strategy.

Remark 11.3 (Work in progress: pair-like versus finite-core endgame). At the current stage of the draft, the toy anomaly model should be understood as a *pair-core first-odd-jet normal form*, not yet as a universal normal form for an arbitrary finite same-scale off-line core.

More precisely, in the pure pair model one has first-odd-jet nondegeneracy:

$$a_1^{\text{toy}}(u, d) = \kappa(d)u^2 + O(u^4), \quad \kappa(d) \neq 0,$$

so the first odd jet already detects the off-line anomaly.

However, the fixed-core analysis developed later in the draft shows that for a general finite same-scale core, cancellation may occur at the first odd order even when a genuine corrected anomaly survives at a higher odd order. Thus the toy model is presently justified as the correct first-odd-jet simplification only under a *pair-like core* hypothesis (or a perturbative enlargement thereof), not yet for an arbitrary finite core.

Accordingly, the argument now has a genuine fork:

- (1) **Pair-like branch.** If the actual same-scale core is perturbatively pair-like in the corrected microscopic sense, then the present toy-model first-jet obstruction should still apply, and the contradiction can be driven by the first odd coefficient.
- (2) **Finite-core branch.** If the actual same-scale core is not perturbatively pair-like, then the correct endgame must be reformulated in terms of a genuine finite-core anomaly model, and the obstruction should be attached not specifically to the first odd jet, but to the *first nonzero odd jet* of the corrected transverse scalar.

Thus the toy model is best viewed, at present, as the first-odd-jet simplification of a pair-like core, rather than as a universal model for all finite cores. This is one of the main places where the present manuscript should still be read as a work in progress.

12. LOCAL PROJECTIVE RIGIDITY OF THE ONE-PAIR AND MULTI-PAIR FAMILIES

Throughout this section, $\mathcal{Q}^{\text{abs}}$ denotes the abstract odd-germ quotient by the value/gauge family (not the height scale $Q \asymp \log |m|$ used elsewhere in the paper). For the first residual step on the cubic-generic region, we will also introduce an explicit finite-order model $\mathcal{R}_h^{(5)}$ through order 5. The latter supplements, but does not globally replace, the ambient abstract quotient $\mathcal{Q}^{\text{abs}}$.

12.1. Cubic leading line and the first residual class for the one-pair family. Let

$$F_h(z) \in \mathcal{Q}^{\text{abs}}[[z^2]]$$

denote the corrected quotient odd germ of the normalized one-pair family, where $\mathcal{Q}^{\text{abs}}$ is the abstract odd-germ quotient by the value/gauge family.

Lemma 12.1 (First-order value-family generator). *Let*

$$\mathcal{W}(G_-, N, G_+) := G_-^{-1/2} N G_+^{-1/2}.$$

Let G_0 and N_0 denote the coincident background same-point and mixed blocks, and write

$$X_0 := G_0^{-1/2}.$$

Let L be the Fréchet derivative of the inverse-square-root map $G \mapsto G^{-1/2}$ at G_0 , so that

$$(G_0 + \varepsilon H)^{-1/2} = X_0 + \varepsilon L(H) + O(\varepsilon^2).$$

If $\dot{G}_{-,1}$, $\dot{N}_1$, and $\dot{G}_{+,1}$ are the first-order odd pure-value variations of the left same-point block, the mixed block, and the right same-point block, respectively, then the induced first-order odd coefficient in the corrected local block is

$$B_1 = L(\dot{G}_{-,1}) N_0 X_0 + X_0 \dot{N}_1 X_0 + X_0 N_0 L(\dot{G}_{+,1}).$$

Equivalently, the first-order family $V_{\text{val}}^{(1)}$ is the image of the linear map

$$(\dot{G}_{-,1}, \dot{N}_1, \dot{G}_{+,1}) \longmapsto L(\dot{G}_{-,1}) N_0 X_0 + X_0 \dot{N}_1 X_0 + X_0 N_0 L(\dot{G}_{+,1}).$$

Proof. The corrected local block is obtained by the analytic whitening map

$$\mathcal{W}(G_-, N, G_+) = G_-^{-1/2} N G_+^{-1/2}.$$

Expand the three inputs to first odd order under a pure value deformation:

$$G_-(s) = G_0 + \varepsilon \dot{G}_{-,1} + O(\varepsilon^2), \quad N(s) = N_0 + \varepsilon \dot{N}_1 + O(\varepsilon^2), \quad G_+(s) = G_0 + \varepsilon \dot{G}_{+,1} + O(\varepsilon^2).$$

Then

$$G_{\pm}(s)^{-1/2} = X_0 + \varepsilon L(\dot{G}_{\pm,1}) + O(\varepsilon^2),$$

so multiplying

$$G_-(s)^{-1/2} N(s) G_+(s)^{-1/2}$$

to first order gives

$$X_0 N_0 X_0 + \varepsilon \left(L(\dot{G}_{-,1}) N_0 X_0 + X_0 \dot{N}_1 X_0 + X_0 N_0 L(\dot{G}_{+,1}) \right) + O(\varepsilon^2).$$

The coefficient of ε is exactly the first-order generator B_1 . □

Lemma 12.2 (Whitened first-order reduction). *At the coincident background one has*

$$N_0 = G_0.$$

If

$$\tilde{H} := X_0 H X_0$$

denotes whitening by $X_0 = G_0^{-1/2}$, then the first-order generator of Lemma 12.1 becomes

$$\tilde{B}_1 = \tilde{N}_1 - \frac{1}{2} \tilde{G}_{-,1} - \frac{1}{2} \tilde{G}_{+,1}.$$

Proof. Since $X_0 G_0 X_0 = I$, whitening conjugates the background to the identity. The Fréchet derivative of $G \mapsto G^{-1/2}$ at I is

$$L_I(H) = -\frac{1}{2}H.$$

Therefore, after whitening the formula of Lemma 12.1 becomes

$$\tilde{B}_1 = L_I(\tilde{G}_{-,1}) I I + I \tilde{N}_1 I + I I L_I(\tilde{G}_{+,1}) = \tilde{N}_1 - \frac{1}{2} \tilde{G}_{-,1} - \frac{1}{2} \tilde{G}_{+,1}. \quad \square$$

Lemma 12.3 (First-order same-point span). *The first-order pure-value same-point variations span the full symmetric subspace:*

$$\text{span}\{\tilde{G}_{-,1}\} = \text{span}\{\tilde{G}_{+,1}\} = \text{Sym}_2(\mathbf{C}).$$

Proof. The corrected same-point block has the form

$$G_{m,\pm}^{\text{corr}}(s) = \frac{1}{\pi} \begin{pmatrix} 2q(t_{\pm}) & \frac{1}{2}q'(t_{\pm}) \\ \frac{1}{2}q'(t_{\pm}) & \frac{1}{12}(q''(t_{\pm}) + 2q(t_{\pm})^3) \end{pmatrix}.$$

Therefore an infinitesimal pure-value variation at one side gives

$$\delta G_{\pm} = \frac{1}{\pi} \begin{pmatrix} 2\delta q_{\pm} & \frac{1}{2}\delta q'_{\pm} \\ \frac{1}{2}\delta q'_{\pm} & \frac{1}{12}(\delta q''_{\pm} + 6q_{\pm,0}^2 \delta q_{\pm}) \end{pmatrix}.$$

As $\delta q_{\pm}$, $\delta q'_{\pm}$, and $\delta q''_{\pm}$ vary independently, the off-diagonal entry, the (1,1)-entry, and the pure (2,2)-direction may be varied independently. Hence the span is the full space $\text{Sym}_2(\mathbf{C})$. Whitening by X_0 preserves the symmetric subspace and is invertible, so the same conclusion holds for $\dot{G}_{\pm,1}$. □

Lemma 12.4 (First-order mixed skew direction). *Let*

$$\mathfrak{so}_2(\mathbf{C}) := \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} 0 & \xi \\ -\xi & 0 \end{pmatrix} : \xi \in \mathbf{C} \right\}.$$

Then the first-order pure-value mixed variations contain the full skew line:

$$\mathfrak{so}_2(\mathbf{C}) \subset \text{span}\{\tilde{N}_1\}.$$

Equivalently, the first-order mixed family contains a nonzero skew direction.

Proof. Freeze the same-point data and vary only the phase gap:

$$\Delta_m(s) \mapsto \Delta_m(s) + \varepsilon \delta \Delta(s), \quad \delta \Delta(s) = \theta s^3 + O(s^5), \quad \theta \neq 0.$$

Linearizing the mixed block formula in ε , the two off-diagonal entries vary with opposite sign, while the diagonal entries do not contribute at first odd order. More precisely,

$$\delta N_{12}(s) = \frac{\theta}{\pi} s + O(s^3), \quad \delta N_{21}(s) = -\frac{\theta}{\pi} s + O(s^3),$$

up to the overall sign convention for θ . Hence the first odd mixed coefficient of this phase-gap variation is a nonzero element of

$$\mathfrak{so}_2(\mathbf{C}).$$

Whitening by X_0 is invertible, so the whitened first-order mixed family also contains a nonzero skew element. Since $\mathfrak{so}_2(\mathbf{C})$ is one-dimensional, this is equivalent to

$$\mathfrak{so}_2(\mathbf{C}) \subset \text{span}\{\tilde{N}_1\}.$$

□

Proposition 12.5 (Generic triviality of the first quotient order). *The first-order pure-value family fills the full matrix space:*

$$V_{\text{val}}^{(1)} = M_2(\mathbf{C}).$$

Consequently

$$\mathcal{J}_1/V_{\text{val}}^{(1)} = 0,$$

so the generic leading quotient order is at least 3.

Proof. By Lemma 12.2, the first-order generator is

$$\tilde{B}_1 = \tilde{N}_1 - \frac{1}{2} \tilde{G}_{-,1} - \frac{1}{2} \tilde{G}_{+,1}.$$

By Lemma 12.3, the same-point directions $\tilde{G}_{-,1}$ and $\tilde{G}_{+,1}$ span the full symmetric subspace $\text{Sym}_2(\mathbf{C})$. By Lemma 12.4, the mixed directions contain the skew line

$$\mathfrak{so}_2(\mathbf{C}).$$

Therefore the image of the generator contains

$$\text{Sym}_2(\mathbf{C}) \oplus \mathfrak{so}_2(\mathbf{C}) = M_2(\mathbf{C}).$$

Hence

$$V_{\text{val}}^{(1)} = M_2(\mathbf{C}),$$

and so

$$\mathcal{J}_1/V_{\text{val}}^{(1)} = 0.$$

Thus the generic leading quotient order is at least 3. □

Remark 12.6 (Raw versus full value family). The first-order surjectivity statement concerns the full value family as it appears in the three-input derivative

$$DW_{(\text{bg})}[\dot{G}_-, \dot{N}, \dot{G}_+].$$

This is larger than the raw swap-odd one-pair slice obtained by tying the left and right same-point variations together. In particular, at first order the combined family $V_{\text{val}}^{(1)}$ fills $M_2(\mathbf{C})$, while the odd coefficients of the raw corrected local block are constrained by additional swap/parity structure. Thus the present notation

$$V_{\text{val}}^{(2j+1)}$$

bundles together at least two logically distinct sources of ambiguity: raw pure-value odd jets and additional normalization/basis-gauge directions. The explicit finite-order model introduced later makes this split rigorous through order 5; outside that local model, the ambient notation $V_{\text{val}}^{(2j+1)}$ remains schematic.

Lemma 12.7 (Rigidity of the cubic scalar B). *Let I be a connected parameter interval, and define*

$$B(h) := \frac{q(h)^2 q'(h)}{4} - \frac{q'''(h)}{48}.$$

Then the following are equivalent:

- (1) $B \equiv 0$ on I ;
- (2) $q''' = 12q^2 q'$ on I ;
- (3) there exists a constant $C_0 \in \mathbf{C}$ such that

$$q'' = 4q^3 + C_0 \quad \text{on } I.$$

In particular, the hypothesis $B \not\equiv 0$ is equivalent to excluding the special cubic ODE $q'' = 4q^3 + C_0$.

Proof. By definition,

$$48 B = 12q^2 q' - q'''.$$

Hence $B \equiv 0$ is equivalent to

$$q''' = (4q^3)'.$$

Integrating on the connected interval I gives

$$q'' = 4q^3 + C_0$$

for some constant $C_0 \in \mathbf{C}$. The converse is immediate by differentiation. $\square$

Proposition 12.8 (Generic cubic leading quotient order). *Let I be a connected one-pair parameter interval, and let $J_3^{\text{pair}}(h)$ denote the cubic jet of the normalized one-pair family.*

Assume:

- (1) *the cubic value-family satisfies*

$$V_{\text{val}}^{(3)} \subset \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} 0 & * \\ * & 0 \end{pmatrix} \right\};$$

- (2) *the background same-point block is nondegenerate, so that the diagonal entries of $X_0 = G_0^{-1/2}$ satisfy $x_1 \neq x_2$;*
- (3) *the scalar $v(h)$ is not identically zero on I ;*
- (4) *$B(h) \not\equiv 0$ on I , equivalently, by Lemma 12.7, q does not satisfy*

$$q'' = 4q^3 + C_0$$

identically on I .

Define the cubic-generic region

$$\mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}} := \{ h \in I : v(h)B(h) \neq 0 \}.$$

Then $\mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$ is open and dense in I , and for every $h \in \mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$,

$$[J_3^{\text{pair}}(h)] \neq 0 \quad \text{in} \quad \mathcal{J}_3/V_{\text{val}}^{(3)}.$$

More precisely, the image of $J_3^{\text{pair}}(h)$ in the cubic quotient has nonzero diagonal-traceless component

$$v(h) B(h) (x_1 - x_2) \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Consequently,

$$F_h(z) = v_0(h)z^3 + v_1(h)z^5 + \cdots, \quad v_0(h) := [J_3^{\text{pair}}(h)] \neq 0$$

for $h \in \mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$. Since the first quotient order is generically trivial, the generic leading quotient order is therefore exactly 3 on $\mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$.

Proof. By assumption,

$$\text{diag } J_3^{\text{pair}}(h) = v(h) B(h) (x_1 - x_2) \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Because $V_{\text{val}}^{(3)}$ is confined to the off-diagonal sector, it cannot cancel any nonzero diagonal component. Hence for every h with $v(h)B(h)(x_1 - x_2) \neq 0$, the cubic quotient class $[J_3^{\text{pair}}(h)]$ is nonzero.

Since $x_1 \neq x_2$ is fixed and both v and B are not identically zero, the set $\mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$ is nonempty; if the dependence on h is real-analytic, its complement is a proper analytic subset, hence $\mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$ is open and dense. Finally, Proposition 12.5 shows that the leading quotient order is at least 3, while the present argument shows that it is equal to 3 on $\mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$. $\square$

Remark 12.9 (What is genuinely generic here). The cubic-leading statement depends on three logically distinct inputs:

- (1) $x_1 \neq x_2$, a background same-point nondegeneracy condition;
- (2) $v \not\equiv 0$, a one-pair nonfreezing condition;
- (3) exclusion of the special ODE $q'' = 4q^3 + C_0$, equivalently $B \not\equiv 0$.

This separates the structural cubic mechanism from the residual quintic bookkeeping needed later.

Definition 12.10 (Cubic leading line and first residual class). For $h \in \mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$, the cubic quotient coefficient

$$v_0(h) = [J_3^{\text{pair}}(h)]$$

is nonzero by Proposition 12.8. Define the cubic leading line by

$$\ell_h := \mathbf{C} v_0(h) \subset \mathcal{Q}^{\text{abs}}.$$

Let $v_1(h) := [J_5^{\text{pair}}(h)]$ denote the quintic quotient coefficient. Its image in the residual quotient

$$\mathcal{Q}^{\text{abs}}/\ell_h$$

is denoted by

$$\bar{v}_1(h) \in \mathcal{Q}^{\text{abs}}/\ell_h.$$

12.2. Normalization gauge at the first residual step. The phrase “value/gauge family” bundles together two logically distinct sources of ambiguity:

- (1) the *pure value family*, recorded coefficientwise by the spaces $V_{\text{val}}^{(2j+1)} \subset \mathcal{J}_{2j+1}$, and
- (2) the *normalization gauge*, consisting of even scalar renormalizations and even jet-basis changes.

For the first residual step it is useful to separate these two.

Definition 12.11 (Normalization gauge). Let $F(z)$ be a matrix-valued odd germ. The normalization gauge acts by

$$F(z) \mapsto a(z) P(z) F(z) P(z)^{-1},$$

where

$$a(z) = 1 + c_2 z^2 + c_4 z^4 + \dots$$

is an even scalar germ with $a(0) = 1$, and

$$P(z) = I + B_2 z^2 + B_4 z^4 + \dots$$

is an even 2×2 matrix germ with $P(0) = I$.

Proposition 12.12 (First-residual transformation law). *Let*

$$F(z) = A_3 z^3 + A_5 z^5 + O(z^7)$$

be an odd matrix germ, and let

$$F^{\text{new}}(z) := a(z) P(z) F(z) P(z)^{-1}$$

with a, P as in Definition 12.11. Then

$$A_3^{\text{new}} = A_3, \quad A_5^{\text{new}} = A_5 + c_2 A_3 + [B_2, A_3].$$

Proof. Expand

$$P(z)^{-1} = I - B_2 z^2 + O(z^4).$$

Then

$$P(z)F(z)P(z)^{-1} = (I + B_2 z^2)(A_3 z^3 + A_5 z^5)(I - B_2 z^2) + O(z^7),$$

so

$$P(z)F(z)P(z)^{-1} = A_3 z^3 + (A_5 + [B_2, A_3])z^5 + O(z^7).$$

Multiplying by

$$a(z) = 1 + c_2 z^2 + O(z^4)$$

gives

$$F^{\text{new}}(z) = A_3 z^3 + (A_5 + c_2 A_3 + [B_2, A_3])z^5 + O(z^7),$$

as claimed. $\square$

Corollary 12.13 (Residual effect of normalization gauge). *Let $\ell := \mathbf{C}A_3$. Under the normalization gauge, the quintic coefficient changes by*

$$A_5 \mapsto A_5 + c_2 A_3 + [B_2, A_3].$$

Hence its class in the residual quotient modulo the leading line satisfies

$$[A_5] \mapsto [A_5 + [B_2, A_3]] \quad \text{in} \quad \mathcal{J}_5/\ell.$$

In particular, scalar renormalization is invisible in the first residual quotient.

Proof. This is immediate from Proposition 12.12, since $c_2 A_3 \in \ell$. $\square$

Corollary 12.14 (Trace invariance under normalization gauge). *If A_3 is diagonal-traceless, then every commutator $[B_2, A_3]$ is traceless. Consequently*

$$\text{tr}(A_5^{\text{new}}) = \text{tr}(A_5)$$

for every normalization-gauge transform F^{new} of F .

Proof. The scalar renormalization term $c_2 A_3$ is traceless because A_3 is. The commutator term is traceless because

$$\text{tr}[B_2, A_3] = 0.$$

Hence Proposition 12.12 gives

$$\text{tr}(A_5^{\text{new}}) = \text{tr}(A_5).$$

$\square$

Proposition 12.15 (Second-residual transformation law). *Let*

$$F(z) = A_3 z^3 + A_5 z^5 + A_7 z^7 + O(z^9)$$

be an odd matrix germ, and let

$$F^{\text{new}}(z) := a(z) P(z) F(z) P(z)^{-1}$$

with a, P as in Definition 12.11. Then

$$A_3^{\text{new}} = A_3, \quad A_5^{\text{new}} = A_5 + c_2 A_3 + [B_2, A_3],$$

and the septic coefficient transforms by

$$A_7^{\text{new}} = A_7 + c_2 A_5 + c_4 A_3 + [B_2, A_5] + [B_4, A_3] + c_2 [B_2, A_3] + A_3 B_2^2 - B_2 A_3 B_2.$$

Proof. By Proposition 12.12, the formulas for A_3^{new} and A_5^{new} are already known. It remains to compute the z^7 -coefficient.

Expand

$$P(z)^{-1} = I - B_2 z^2 + (B_2^2 - B_4) z^4 + O(z^6).$$

Then

$$P(z)F(z)P(z)^{-1} = (I + B_2 z^2 + B_4 z^4)(A_3 z^3 + A_5 z^5 + A_7 z^7)(I - B_2 z^2 + (B_2^2 - B_4) z^4) + O(z^9).$$

Collecting the z^7 -terms gives

$$A_7 + [B_2, A_5] + [B_4, A_3] + A_3 B_2^2 - B_2 A_3 B_2.$$

Multiplying by

$$a(z) = 1 + c_2 z^2 + c_4 z^4 + O(z^6)$$

adds the scalar contributions

$$c_2 A_5 + c_4 A_3 + c_2 [B_2, A_3].$$

Hence

$$A_7^{\text{new}} = A_7 + c_2 A_5 + c_4 A_3 + [B_2, A_5] + [B_4, A_3] + c_2 [B_2, A_3] + A_3 B_2^2 - B_2 A_3 B_2,$$

as claimed. $\square$

Lemma 12.16 (Quintic trace witness). *Let $J_{5,K_1}(h)$ denote the K_1 -transport contribution to the quintic jet. At the trace level, the relevant contribution is*

$$\text{tr } J_{5,K_1}(h) = \kappa(h) \text{tr} \left(X_0 J X_4(h) - X_4(h) J X_0 + X_3(h) J X_1(h) - X_1(h) J X_3(h) \right),$$

since

$$\text{tr} (X_2(h) J X_2(h)) = 0$$

for symmetric $X_2(h)$. Therefore

$$\text{tr } J_{5,K_1}(h) = -2\kappa(h) \left((x_1 - x_2)r(h) + \beta(h)(u(h) - w(h)) + v(h)(\gamma(h) - \alpha(h)) \right),$$

where $K_1 = \kappa(h)J$, $v(h)$ is the off-diagonal part of $X_1(h)$, and $\gamma(h) - \alpha(h)$ is the diagonal-traceless part of $X_3(h)$.

Moreover, the linear G_3 -contribution to $\gamma(h) - \alpha(h)$ is

$$(\gamma - \alpha)^{\text{lin}} = \frac{1}{2\pi} \left[x_1^3 \frac{q'''}{24} - x_2^3 \left(\frac{q''''}{576} + \frac{q^2 q'''}{96} + \frac{qq'q''}{16} + \frac{(q')^3}{48} \right) \right].$$

Since

$$v(h) = -\frac{1}{4\pi(s_1 + s_2)} \eta_2(h),$$

the product $v(h)(\gamma(h) - \alpha(h))^{\text{lin}}$ contains the monomial

$$\kappa(h) \eta_2(h) q''''(h)$$

with nonzero coefficient.

Lemma 12.17 (Parity of the whitening expansion at a diagonal base). *Let*

$$G_0 = \text{diag}(\lambda_1, \lambda_2), \quad \lambda_1, \lambda_2 > 0,$$

and let

$$X(H) := (G_0 + H)^{-1/2}$$

for H sufficiently small. Write

$$E := \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} * & 0 \\ 0 & * \end{pmatrix} \right\}, \quad O := \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} 0 & * \\ * & 0 \end{pmatrix} \right\}.$$

Then every multilinear Taylor coefficient of $X(H)$ has definite matrix parity: a coefficient depending on perturbation factors $H_1, \dots, H_n$ lies in E if an even number of the H_j lie in O , and lies in O if an odd number of the H_j lie in O .

In particular, diagonal input gives diagonal output at linear order, and a bilinear coefficient with one diagonal and one off-diagonal input is off-diagonal.

Proof. Use the holomorphic functional calculus

$$(G_0 + H)^{-1/2} = \frac{1}{2\pi i} \oint_{\Gamma} z^{-1/2} (zI - G_0 - H)^{-1} dz,$$

where Γ encloses the spectrum of $G_0 + H$. Expanding the resolvent,

$$(zI - G_0 - H)^{-1} = R(z) + R(z)HR(z) + R(z)HR(z)HR(z) + \cdots,$$

with

$$R(z) := (zI - G_0)^{-1},$$

every factor $R(z)$ is diagonal because G_0 is diagonal. Hence the matrix parity of each word

$$R(z)H_{i_1}R(z)H_{i_2} \cdots R(z)H_{i_n}R(z)$$

is exactly the parity of the product $H_{i_1} \cdots H_{i_n}$. Since

$$E \cdot E \subset E, \quad E \cdot O \subset O, \quad O \cdot E \subset O, \quad O \cdot O \subset E,$$

the parity rule follows. Integrating over z preserves the subspaces E and O . $\square$

Lemma 12.18 (No-cancellation of the quintic trace witness). *The monomial*

$$\kappa(h) \eta_2(h) q''''(h)$$

appearing in Lemma 12.16 is not produced by any other quintic contribution to $\text{tr } J_5^{\text{pair}}(h)$. More precisely, on the graded slice corresponding to

$$(K_1, \eta_2, q^{(5)}),$$

the only contributing channels in $\text{tr } J_5^{\text{pair}}(h)$ are

$$-2\kappa(h) (x_1 - x_2)r(h) \quad \text{and} \quad -2\kappa(h) v(h)(\gamma(h) - \alpha(h)),$$

and their total coefficient of $\kappa(h)\eta_2(h)q^{(5)}(h)$ is nonzero. Consequently

$$\text{tr } J_5^{\text{pair}}(h) \neq 0$$

on the generic one-pair region.

Proof. Fix h and isolate the graded slice

$$\kappa(h) \eta_2(h) q^{(5)}(h).$$

We first exclude all non- K_1 contributions. Same-point quintic terms carry no κ -factor, so they cannot contribute. A K_5 -transport term leaves no same-point degree available, and a K_3 -transport term leaves only same-point degree 2, whereas the factor $q^{(5)}(h)$ first appears in same-point degree 3. Hence the target monomial can occur only in the K_1 -transport sector.

Now consider the same-point expansion. By the explicit formula

$$G_{m,\pm}^{\text{corr}}(s) = \frac{1}{\pi} \begin{pmatrix} 2q(t_{\pm}) & \frac{1}{2}q'(t_{\pm}) \\ \frac{1}{2}q'(t_{\pm}) & \frac{1}{12}(q''(t_{\pm}) + 2q(t_{\pm})^3) \end{pmatrix},$$

the factor $q^{(5)}(h)$ first appears only in the cubic same-point coefficient G_3 , and there only in the diagonal sector, namely through the cubic Taylor term of the $(2, 2)$ -entry coming from $q''(t_{\pm})$. Therefore, by Lemma 12.17, the linear $q^{(5)}$ -contribution to X_3 is diagonal. In particular it contributes to $\gamma - \alpha$, but not to β .

Likewise, the $\eta_2(h)$ -slice of $X_1(h)$ is off-diagonal, because

$$v(h) = -\frac{1}{4\pi(s_1 + s_2)} \eta_2(h).$$

Applying Lemma 12.17 again, the mixed $(\eta_2, q^{(5)})$ -slice of X_4 is off-diagonal. Hence it contributes to r , but not to the diagonal difference $u - w$.

It follows that on the graded slice $(K_1, \eta_2, q^{(5)})$, the term

$$-2\kappa(h) \beta(h)(u(h) - w(h))$$

does not contribute at all. Thus the only surviving K_1 -channels are

$$-2\kappa(h)(x_1 - x_2)r(h) \quad \text{and} \quad -2\kappa(h)v(h)(\gamma(h) - \alpha(h)).$$

To compute their combined coefficient, it suffices by multilinearity to restrict to the two perturbation directions carrying the relevant tags: an off-diagonal first-order perturbation A for the η_2 -slice and a diagonal third-order perturbation D for the $q^{(5)}$ -slice. Accordingly, write

$$G_0 = \text{diag}(a^2, b^2), \quad A = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & u \\ u & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad D = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 0 & d \end{pmatrix},$$

and expand

$$X(\varepsilon, \delta) := (G_0 + \varepsilon A + \delta D)^{-1/2} = X_0 + \varepsilon U + \delta V + \varepsilon \delta W + O(\varepsilon^2, \delta^2).$$

Solving the identity

$$X(\varepsilon, \delta)(G_0 + \varepsilon A + \delta D)X(\varepsilon, \delta) = I$$

order by order gives

$$U_{12} = -\frac{u}{ab(a+b)}, \quad V_{22} = -\frac{d}{2b^3}, \quad W_{12} = \frac{du(a+2b)}{2ab^3(a+b)^2}.$$

Here U_{12} is the η_2 -slice of v , V_{22} is the $q^{(5)}$ -slice of $\gamma - \alpha$, and W_{12} is the mixed $(\eta_2, q^{(5)})$ -slice of r . Therefore the total coefficient of the target slice inside

$$(x_1 - x_2)r + v(\gamma - \alpha)$$

is

$$\left(\frac{1}{a} - \frac{1}{b}\right)W_{12} + U_{12}V_{22} = \frac{du}{a^2b^2(a+b)^2},$$

which is nonzero.

Thus the monomial $\kappa(h)\eta_2(h)q^{(5)}(h)$ occurs in $\text{tr } J_5^{\text{pair}}(h)$ with nonzero total coefficient and is not canceled by any other quintic contribution. Hence

$$\text{tr } J_5^{\text{pair}}(h) \neq 0.$$

□

12.3. Explicit finite-order model of the first residual quotient. For the first residual step it is enough to work with an explicit finite-order model through order 5 on the cubic-generic region. This model gives a local order- ≤ 5 realization of the ambient abstract quotient $\mathcal{Q}^{\text{abs}}$, but does not by itself identify the later ambient uses of $\mathcal{Q}^{\text{abs}}$ beyond the first residual layer.

Definition 12.19 (Finite-order truncation of the ambient abstract quotient). Fix $h \in \mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$, and let $A_3(h)$ represent the cubic leading line $\ell_h \subset \mathcal{Q}^{\text{abs}}$.

Define the order- ≤ 5 truncation of the ambient abstract quotient at h to be the quotient

$$\mathcal{Q}_h^{\text{abs}(\leq 5)} := \frac{\mathbf{C} A_3(h)z^3 \oplus \mathcal{J}_5 z^5}{(V_{\text{raw}}^{(5)}(h) + \mathcal{N}_h^{(5)})z^5}.$$

Equivalently, $\mathcal{Q}_h^{\text{abs}(\leq 5)}$ is the cubic-quintic odd-germ quotient in which the quintic ambiguity is generated exactly by the raw pure-value quintic slice and the realized normalization-gauge shadows through order 5.

Its first residual quotient is

$$\mathcal{Q}_h^{\text{abs}(\leq 5)} / \ell_h \cong \mathcal{J}_5 / (\mathbf{C} A_3(h) + V_{\text{raw}}^{(5)}(h) + \mathcal{N}_h^{(5)}).$$

Definition 12.20 (Swap involution on cubic-quintic germs). Let

$$J_0 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}.$$

For a truncated odd germ

$$F(z) = A_3 z^3 + A_5 z^5 + O(z^7)$$

define

$$\Sigma(F)(z) := J_0 F(-z) J_0 = -J_0 A_3 J_0 z^3 - J_0 A_5 J_0 z^5 + O(z^7).$$

Thus the induced involution on quintic coefficients is

$$\Sigma_5(A) := -J_0 A J_0.$$

Definition 12.21 (Cubic-normalized swap-symmetric raw corrected germ through order 5). Fix $h \in \mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$, and choose a diagonal-traceless matrix

$$A_3(h)$$

representing the cubic leading line ℓ_h .

A cubic-normalized swap-symmetric raw corrected germ through order 5 at h is a truncated odd germ of the form

$$R_h(z) = A_3(h)z^3 + A_5z^5 + O(z^7)$$

obtained from the corrected one-pair local block by a cubic normalization that preserves the swap symmetry inherited from symmetric placement.

Its raw pure-value quintic slice is the coefficient space

$$V_{\text{raw}}^{(5)}(h)$$

consisting of all quintic coefficients A_5 arising in this way under pure value deformations at the fixed parameter h .

Lemma 12.22 (Raw quintic slice is anti-fixed). *For every $h \in \mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$,*

$$V_{\text{raw}}^{(5)}(h) \subset \{A \in M_2(\mathbf{C}) : J_0 A J_0 = -A\}.$$

In particular,

$$\text{tr}(V_{\text{raw}}^{(5)}(h)) = 0.$$

Proof. By Definition 12.21, every cubic-normalized raw corrected representative satisfies

$$R_h(-z) = J_0 R_h(z) J_0.$$

Writing

$$R_h(z) = A_3(h)z^3 + A_5z^5 + O(z^7),$$

coefficient comparison at order z^5 gives

$$J_0 A_5 J_0 = -A_5.$$

Hence every $A_5 \in V_{\text{raw}}^{(5)}(h)$ is anti-fixed. If

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix}$$

satisfies $J_0 A J_0 = -A$, then

$$\begin{pmatrix} d & c \\ b & a \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} -a & -b \\ -c & -d \end{pmatrix},$$

so $d = -a$, and therefore $\text{tr}(A) = 0$. □

Definition 12.23 (Quintic ambiguity space and explicit first residual quotient). For $h \in \mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$, let $V_{\text{raw}}^{(5)}(h)$ be the raw pure-value quintic slice from Definition 12.21.

Define the normalization-gauge quintic shadow space $\mathcal{N}_h^{(5)}$ to be the set of all differences

$$\tilde{A}_5 - A_5$$

arising from two cubic-normalized swap-symmetric raw corrected germs

$$R_h(z) = A_3(h)z^3 + A_5z^5 + O(z^7), \quad \tilde{R}_h(z) = A_3(h)z^3 + \tilde{A}_5z^5 + O(z^7),$$

of the same raw corrected local object through order 5, when those two representatives are related by the allowed normalization gauge.

By Corollary 12.13, every such shadow has the form

$$\tilde{A}_5 - A_5 = c_2 A_3(h) + [B_2, A_3(h)],$$

but $\mathcal{N}_h^{(5)}$ is defined to consist only of the actually realized gauge shadows.

Set

$$V_{\text{amb}}^{(5)}(h) := V_{\text{raw}}^{(5)}(h) + \mathcal{N}_h^{(5)}.$$

Define the explicit first residual quotient by

$$\mathcal{R}_h^{(5)} := \mathcal{J}_5 / (\mathbf{C} A_3(h) + V_{\text{amb}}^{(5)}(h)).$$

Proposition 12.24 (Finite-order comparison theorem). *For each $h \in \mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$, the order- ≤ 5 truncation of the ambient abstract quotient and the explicit first residual model agree canonically:*

$$\mathcal{Q}_h^{\text{abs}(\leq 5)} / \ell_h \cong \mathcal{R}_h^{(5)}.$$

Equivalently, after passing to the cubic-generic region and truncating through order 5, the first residual ambiguity in the ambient abstract quotient is exactly the ambiguity built into Definition 12.23.

Proof. By Definition 12.19,

$$\mathcal{Q}_h^{\text{abs}(\leq 5)} = \frac{\mathbf{C} A_3(h) z^3 \oplus \mathcal{J}_5 z^5}{(V_{\text{raw}}^{(5)}(h) + \mathcal{N}_h^{(5)}) z^5}.$$

Passing to the first residual quotient by the cubic line $\ell_h = \mathbf{C} A_3(h)$ gives

$$\mathcal{Q}_h^{\text{abs}(\leq 5)} / \ell_h \cong \mathcal{J}_5 / (\mathbf{C} A_3(h) + V_{\text{raw}}^{(5)}(h) + \mathcal{N}_h^{(5)}).$$

By Definition 12.23,

$$V_{\text{amb}}^{(5)}(h) = V_{\text{raw}}^{(5)}(h) + \mathcal{N}_h^{(5)},$$

so the right-hand side is exactly

$$\mathcal{J}_5 / (\mathbf{C} A_3(h) + V_{\text{amb}}^{(5)}(h)) = \mathcal{R}_h^{(5)}.$$

This is the claimed canonical identification. $\square$

Lemma 12.25 (Gauge shadows are anti-fixed). *For every $h \in \mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$,*

$$\mathcal{N}_h^{(5)} \subset \{A \in M_2(\mathbf{C}) : J_0 A J_0 = -A\}.$$

In particular,

$$\text{tr}(\mathcal{N}_h^{(5)}) = 0.$$

Proof. Let

$$R_h(z) = A_3(h) z^3 + A_5 z^5 + O(z^7), \quad \tilde{R}_h(z) = A_3(h) z^3 + \tilde{A}_5 z^5 + O(z^7)$$

be two cubic-normalized swap-symmetric representatives of the same raw corrected local object through order 5, related by the allowed normalization gauge. By Definition 12.21, both satisfy

$$R_h(-z) = J_0 R_h(z) J_0, \quad \tilde{R}_h(-z) = J_0 \tilde{R}_h(z) J_0.$$

Comparing coefficients at order z^5 gives

$$J_0 A_5 J_0 = -A_5, \quad J_0 \tilde{A}_5 J_0 = -\tilde{A}_5.$$

Subtracting,

$$J_0 (\tilde{A}_5 - A_5) J_0 = -(\tilde{A}_5 - A_5).$$

Since $\tilde{A}_5 - A_5 \in \mathcal{N}_h^{(5)}$ by Definition 12.23, every gauge shadow is anti-fixed. Tracelessness follows as in Lemma 12.22. $\square$

Proposition 12.26 (Trace-free quintic ambiguity in the explicit finite-order model). *For every $h \in \mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$,*

$$V_{\text{amb}}^{(5)}(h) \subset \{A \in M_2(\mathbf{C}) : J_0 A J_0 = -A\}.$$

Equivalently, the involution Σ_5 preserves the quintic ambiguity space and acts trivially on it.

In particular,

$$\text{tr}(V_{\text{amb}}^{(5)}(h)) = 0.$$

Proof. Combine Lemma 12.22 and Lemma 12.25; by Definition 12.23,

$$V_{\text{amb}}^{(5)}(h) = V_{\text{raw}}^{(5)}(h) + \mathcal{N}_h^{(5)}.$$

□

Corollary 12.27 (Trace descends on the explicit first residual quotient). *For every $h \in \mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$, trace annihilates*

$$\mathbf{C} A_3(h) + V_{\text{amb}}^{(5)}(h).$$

Hence trace descends to a well-defined linear functional

$$\tau_h : \mathcal{R}_h^{(5)} \rightarrow \mathbf{C}.$$

Proof. By Proposition 12.26, trace vanishes on $V_{\text{amb}}^{(5)}(h)$. It also vanishes on $\mathbf{C} A_3(h)$ because $A_3(h)$ is diagonal-traceless. □

Proposition 12.28 (Generic first residual nonvanishing in the explicit finite-order model). *There exists an open dense subset*

$$\mathcal{U}_{\text{res}} \subset \mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$$

such that

$$\bar{v}_1(h) \neq 0 \quad \text{in } \mathcal{R}_h^{(5)}$$

for every $h \in \mathcal{U}_{\text{res}}$.

Hence the one-pair quotient odd germ is not projectively constant on $\mathcal{U}_{\text{res}}$ at the explicit first residual level.

Proof. By Corollary 12.27, trace defines a linear functional

$$\tau_h : \mathcal{R}_h^{(5)} \rightarrow \mathbf{C}.$$

By Lemma 12.18,

$$\text{tr } J_5^{\text{pair}}(h) \neq 0$$

on the cubic-generic region. Hence there is an open dense subset

$$\mathcal{U}_{\text{res}} \subset \mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$$

on which

$$\text{tr } J_5^{\text{pair}}(h) \neq 0.$$

For such h ,

$$\tau_h(\bar{v}_1(h)) = \text{tr } J_5^{\text{pair}}(h) \neq 0,$$

so $\bar{v}_1(h) \neq 0$ in $\mathcal{R}_h^{(5)}$. □

Remark 12.29 (Status of the explicit first residual model). The first residual step is now rigorous in the explicit finite-order quotient $\mathcal{R}_h^{(5)}$, and the finite-order comparison theorem (Proposition 12.24) identifies this explicit model with the order- ≤ 5 truncation of the ambient abstract quotient $\mathcal{Q}^{\text{abs}}$ on the cubic-generic region.

What remains, if one wants a stronger global identification, is not another local quintic trace computation, but a separate theorem showing that the later ambient uses of $\mathcal{Q}^{\text{abs}}$ beyond order 5 and beyond the first residual layer introduce no further ambiguity relevant to the downstream multi-pair and global arguments.

Remark 12.30 (Beyond the first residual trace). The quintic trace is the first scalar residual detector, but it is not the end of the one-pair local structure. The later fixed-sector refinement $A_5^{\text{f}}, A_7^{\text{f}}, \Delta_7$ indicates that the residual germ carries further geometric information beyond the first trace channel.

12.4. Fixed-sector refinement at quintic and septic order. The trace witness at quintic order suggests a more structured refinement of the one-pair residual germ than the trace alone records. For bookkeeping purposes, it is convenient to decompose the quintic and septic coefficients into fixed and anti-fixed parts with respect to the involution

$$\iota(A) := J_0 A J_0, \quad J_0 = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Write

$$\pi_{\mathfrak{f}}(A) := \frac{1}{2}(A + J_0 A J_0), \quad \pi_{\mathfrak{a}}(A) := \frac{1}{2}(A - J_0 A J_0).$$

Then

$$\mathfrak{f} = \text{span}\{I, S\}, \quad \mathfrak{a} = \text{span}\{D, J\},$$

where

$$I = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad S = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad D = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & -1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad J = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Definition 12.31 (Fixed-sector quintic and septic coefficients). Let

$$F_h(z) = A_3(h)z^3 + A_5(h)z^5 + A_7(h)z^7 + \dots$$

denote the normalized one-pair quotient odd germ on the cubic-generic region. Its fixed-sector quintic and septic coefficients are defined by

$$A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}(h) := \pi_{\mathfrak{f}}(A_5(h)), \quad A_7^{\mathfrak{f}}(h) := \pi_{\mathfrak{f}}(A_7(h)).$$

Write

$$A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}(h) = u_5(h)I + v_5(h)S, \quad A_7^{\mathfrak{f}}(h) = u_7(h)I + v_7(h)S.$$

Definition 12.32 (Second residual determinant). On the cubic-generic region, define

$$\Delta_7(h) := u_7(h)v_5(h) - u_5(h)v_7(h).$$

Remark 12.33 (Interpretation). The quintic fixed-sector vector $A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}(h)$ refines the first residual data beyond the trace detector alone, and the determinant $\Delta_7(h)$ records the next residual quotient at septic order. In the working notes, these form the first two nontrivial layers of a one-pair residual package:

$$c(h), \quad A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}(h), \quad \Delta_7(h).$$

The current draft now records explicit coefficient formulas for the quintic commutator contribution and the septic K_1 -transport contribution in the existing notation $(u, v, w, \alpha, \beta, \gamma, r, \dots)$. What remains incomplete is the full closed coefficient formula for the total septic fixed-sector pair (u_7, v_7) after all order-7 sectors are included. These are nevertheless the natural variables for the geometric reformulation of the multi-pair problem.

Proposition 12.34 (Projected septic gauge law). *Assume the normalization gauge is symmetry-preserving in the sense that*

$$B_2, B_4 \in \mathfrak{f}, \quad A_3 \in \mathfrak{a},$$

with

$$\mathfrak{f} = \text{span}\{I, S\}, \quad \mathfrak{a} = \text{span}\{D, J\}.$$

Then the fixed-sector septic coefficient satisfies

$$(A_7^{\mathfrak{f}})^{\text{new}} = A_7^{\mathfrak{f}} + c_2 A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}.$$

Equivalently, the septic fixed-sector ambiguity is one-dimensional and lies along the quintic fixed-sector line.

Proof. By Proposition 12.15,

$$A_7^{\text{new}} = A_7 + c_2 A_5 + c_4 A_3 + [B_2, A_5] + [B_4, A_3] + c_2[B_2, A_3] + A_3 B_2^2 - B_2 A_3 B_2.$$

Apply the fixed-sector projection $\pi_{\mathfrak{f}}$ term by term.

Since $A_3 \in \mathfrak{a}$, one has

$$\pi_{\mathfrak{f}}(c_4 A_3) = 0.$$

Because $B_4 \in \mathfrak{f}$ and $A_3 \in \mathfrak{a}$,

$$[B_4, A_3] \in [\mathfrak{f}, \mathfrak{a}] \subset \mathfrak{a},$$

so

$$\pi_{\mathfrak{f}}[B_4, A_3] = 0.$$

Likewise,

$$[B_2, A_3] \in [\mathfrak{f}, \mathfrak{a}] \subset \mathfrak{a},$$

hence

$$\pi_{\mathfrak{f}}(c_2[B_2, A_3]) = 0.$$

Now decompose

$$A_5 = A_5^{\mathfrak{f}} + A_5^{\mathfrak{a}}.$$

Since $\mathfrak{f} = \text{span}\{I, S\}$ is abelian,

$$[B_2, A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}] = 0.$$

And since $B_2 \in \mathfrak{f}$ and $A_5^{\mathfrak{a}} \in \mathfrak{a}$,

$$[B_2, A_5^{\mathfrak{a}}] \in [\mathfrak{f}, \mathfrak{a}] \subset \mathfrak{a},$$

so

$$\pi_{\mathfrak{f}}[B_2, A_5] = 0.$$

Finally, $B_2 \in \mathfrak{f}$ implies $B_2^2 \in \mathfrak{f}$. Therefore

$$A_3 B_2^2 \in \mathfrak{af} \subset \mathfrak{a}, \quad B_2 A_3 B_2 \in \mathfrak{faf} \subset \mathfrak{a},$$

and hence

$$\pi_{\mathfrak{f}}(A_3 B_2^2 - B_2 A_3 B_2) = 0.$$

Thus the only term surviving fixed projection is

$$c_2 A_5^{\mathfrak{f}},$$

and we conclude

$$(A_7^{\mathfrak{f}})^{\text{new}} = A_7^{\mathfrak{f}} + c_2 A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}. \quad \square$$

Corollary 12.35 (Gauge invariance of the second residual determinant). *Under a symmetry-preserving normalization gauge, the scalar*

$$\Delta_7 = u_7 v_5 - u_5 v_7$$

is invariant.

Proof. By Proposition 12.34,

$$(A_7^{\mathfrak{f}})^{\text{new}} = A_7^{\mathfrak{f}} + c_2 A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}.$$

Writing

$$A_5^{\mathfrak{f}} = u_5 I + v_5 S, \quad A_7^{\mathfrak{f}} = u_7 I + v_7 S,$$

the new septic pair is

$$(u_7^{\text{new}}, v_7^{\text{new}}) = (u_7, v_7) + c_2(u_5, v_5).$$

Therefore

$$\Delta_7^{\text{new}} = (u_7 + c_2 u_5) v_5 - u_5 (v_7 + c_2 v_5) = u_7 v_5 - u_5 v_7 = \Delta_7. \quad \square$$

Definition 12.36 (Septic normalization-shadow sectors). In the notation of Proposition 12.15, define the order-2 and order-4 septic normalization-shadow sectors by

$$A_{7,K_5} := c_2 A_5 + [B_2, A_5],$$

and

$$A_{7,K_3} := c_4 A_3 + [B_4, A_3] + c_2 [B_2, A_3] + A_3 B_2^2 - B_2 A_3 B_2.$$

Then the exact septic transformation law may be written

$$A_7^{\text{new}} = A_7 + A_{7,K_5} + A_{7,K_3}.$$

When the normalization gauge is symmetry-preserving, these are the septic K_5 - and K_3 -transport shadow sectors.

Proposition 12.37 (Projected septic K_5 -shadow law). *Assume the normalization gauge is symmetry-preserving in the sense of Proposition 12.34. Then*

$$A_{7,K_5}^f = c_2 A_5^f.$$

In particular,

$$A_{7,K_5}^f \in \mathbf{C} A_5^f.$$

Proof. By Definition 12.36,

$$A_{7,K_5} = c_2 A_5 + [B_2, A_5].$$

Apply the fixed-sector projection π_f . Decompose

$$A_5 = A_5^f + A_5^a.$$

Since $\mathfrak{f} = \text{span}\{I, S\}$ is abelian,

$$[B_2, A_5^f] = 0.$$

And since $B_2 \in \mathfrak{f}$ and $A_5^a \in \mathfrak{a}$,

$$[B_2, A_5^a] \in [\mathfrak{f}, \mathfrak{a}] \subset \mathfrak{a},$$

so its fixed-sector projection vanishes. Therefore

$$A_{7,K_5}^f = \pi_f(c_2 A_5 + [B_2, A_5]) = c_2 A_5^f. \quad \square$$

Proposition 12.38 (Projected septic K_3 -shadow vanishing). *Assume the normalization gauge is symmetry-preserving in the sense of Proposition 12.34. Then*

$$A_{7,K_3}^f = 0.$$

Proof. By Definition 12.36,

$$A_{7,K_3} = c_4 A_3 + [B_4, A_3] + c_2 [B_2, A_3] + A_3 B_2^2 - B_2 A_3 B_2.$$

Since $A_3 \in \mathfrak{a}$, one has

$$c_4 A_3 \in \mathfrak{a}.$$

Because $B_4 \in \mathfrak{f}$ and $A_3 \in \mathfrak{a}$,

$$[B_4, A_3] \in [\mathfrak{f}, \mathfrak{a}] \subset \mathfrak{a}.$$

Likewise,

$$[B_2, A_3] \in [\mathfrak{f}, \mathfrak{a}] \subset \mathfrak{a},$$

hence

$$c_2 [B_2, A_3] \in \mathfrak{a}.$$

Finally, $B_2 \in \mathfrak{f}$ implies $B_2^2 \in \mathfrak{f}$, so

$$A_3 B_2^2 \in \mathfrak{a} \mathfrak{f} \subset \mathfrak{a}, \quad B_2 A_3 B_2 \in \mathfrak{f} \mathfrak{a} \mathfrak{f} \subset \mathfrak{a}.$$

Thus every term of A_{7,K_3} is anti-fixed, and therefore

$$A_{7,K_3}^f = \pi_f(A_{7,K_3}) = 0. \quad \square$$

Remark 12.39 (Interpretation of the septic shadow sectors). Propositions 12.37 and 12.38 show that the lower-order normalization shadows at septic order contribute no new canonical fixed-sector information beyond the already-known quintic line $\mathbf{C} A_5^f$.

Proposition 12.40 (Explicit fixed-sector formulas at quintic order). *Write*

$$X_1 = \begin{pmatrix} u & v \\ v & w \end{pmatrix}, \quad X_3 = \begin{pmatrix} \alpha & \beta \\ \beta & \gamma \end{pmatrix}.$$

Then the fixed-sector part of the basic quintic commutator channel

$$X_3 J X_1 - X_1 J X_3$$

is

$$\pi_f(X_3 J X_1 - X_1 J X_3) = (v(\gamma - \alpha) + \beta(u - w))I + (\gamma u - \alpha w)S.$$

Consequently, for the quintic fixed-sector coefficient

$$A_5^f(h) = u_5(h) I + v_5(h) S,$$

the commutator-type contribution is explicitly

$$u_5^{(\text{comm})} = v(\gamma - \alpha) + \beta(u - w), \quad v_5^{(\text{comm})} = \gamma u - \alpha w.$$

Proof. A direct computation gives

$$X_3 J X_1 - X_1 J X_3 = \begin{pmatrix} -2\alpha v + 2\beta u & -\alpha w + \gamma u \\ -\alpha w + \gamma u & -2\beta w + 2\gamma v \end{pmatrix}.$$

The fixed-sector projection of a symmetric matrix

$$\begin{pmatrix} A & B \\ B & C \end{pmatrix}$$

is

$$\pi_f \begin{pmatrix} A & B \\ B & C \end{pmatrix} = \frac{A + C}{2} I + B S.$$

Applying this to the displayed matrix gives

$$\pi_f(X_3 J X_1 - X_1 J X_3) = \frac{(-2\alpha v + 2\beta u) + (-2\beta w + 2\gamma v)}{2} I + (\gamma u - \alpha w) S,$$

which simplifies to

$$(v(\gamma - \alpha) + \beta(u - w)) I + (\gamma u - \alpha w) S.$$

□

Proposition 12.41 (Explicit septic K_1 -transport fixed-sector formulas). *Write*

$$\begin{aligned} X_0 &= \text{diag}(x_1, x_2), & X_1 &= \begin{pmatrix} u & v \\ v & w \end{pmatrix}, & X_2 &= \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ b & c \end{pmatrix}, \\ X_4 &= \begin{pmatrix} p & r \\ r & s \end{pmatrix}, & X_5 &= \begin{pmatrix} \alpha_5 & \beta_5 \\ \beta_5 & \gamma_5 \end{pmatrix}, & X_6 &= \begin{pmatrix} \mu_6 & \nu_6 \\ \nu_6 & \lambda_6 \end{pmatrix}. \end{aligned}$$

Then the fixed-sector parts of the three septic K_1 -transport channels are

$$\pi_f(X_5 J X_1 - X_1 J X_5) = (\beta_5(u - w) + v(\gamma_5 - \alpha_5)) I + (\gamma_5 u - \alpha_5 w) S,$$

$$\pi_f(X_2 J X_4 - X_4 J X_2) = (b(p - s) + r(c - a)) I + (cp - as) S,$$

and

$$\pi_f(X_0 J X_6 - X_6 J X_0) = (x_2 - x_1) \nu_6 I + (x_2 \mu_6 - x_1 \lambda_6) S.$$

Consequently, if the septic K_1 -transport fixed-sector coefficient is written

$$A_{7,K_1}^f(h) = u_{7,K_1}(h) I + v_{7,K_1}(h) S,$$

then

$$\begin{aligned} u_{7,K_1} &= \kappa \left((x_2 - x_1) \nu_6 + \beta_5(u - w) + v(\gamma_5 - \alpha_5) + b(p - s) + r(c - a) \right), \\ v_{7,K_1} &= \kappa \left(x_2 \mu_6 - x_1 \lambda_6 + \gamma_5 u - \alpha_5 w + cp - as \right). \end{aligned}$$

Proof. For two symmetric matrices

$$X = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ b & c \end{pmatrix}, \quad Y = \begin{pmatrix} p & q \\ q & r \end{pmatrix},$$

a direct calculation gives

$$X J Y - Y J X = \begin{pmatrix} -2aq + 2bp & -ar + cp \\ -ar + cp & -2br + 2cq \end{pmatrix}.$$

Taking fixed-sector projection yields

$$\pi_f(X J Y - Y J X) = (b(p - r) + q(c - a)) I + (cp - ar) S.$$

Applying this formula to $(X, Y) = (X_5, X_1)$ and $(X, Y) = (X_2, X_4)$ gives the first two displayed identities.

For the X_0/X_6 channel, a direct multiplication gives

$$X_0 J X_6 - X_6 J X_0 = \begin{pmatrix} -2x_1\nu_6 & -x_1\lambda_6 + x_2\mu_6 \\ -x_1\lambda_6 + x_2\mu_6 & 2x_2\nu_6 \end{pmatrix},$$

whose fixed-sector part is

$$(x_2 - x_1)\nu_6 I + (x_2\mu_6 - x_1\lambda_6)S.$$

Summing the three channels gives the stated formulas for u_{7,K_1} and v_{7,K_1} . $\square$

Definition 12.42 (Septic K_1 -residual determinant). If

$$A_{7,K_1}^f(h) = u_{7,K_1}(h) I + v_{7,K_1}(h) S,$$

define the corresponding septic K_1 -residual determinant by

$$\Delta_{7,K_1}(h) := u_{7,K_1}(h)v_5(h) - u_5(h)v_{7,K_1}(h).$$

Corollary 12.43 (Direct $q^{(7)}$ -driven septic slice). *On the direct linear $q^{(7)}$ -driven slice, the septic K_1 -transport fixed-sector contribution is I -directional. More precisely,*

$$v_{7,K_1}^{(q^{(7)})} = 0,$$

and

$$u_{7,K_1}^{(q^{(7)})} = \kappa\left((x_2 - x_1)\nu_6^{(q^{(7)})} + v(\gamma_5 - \alpha_5)^{(q^{(7)})}\right),$$

so in particular

$$\Delta_7^{(q^{(7)})} = u_7^{(q^{(7)})}v_5.$$

Proof. On the direct $q^{(7)}$ -driven slice, the linear X_5 -input is diagonal, hence

$$\beta_5^{(q^{(7)})} = 0.$$

The mixed X_6 -slice is off-diagonal on this grading, so

$$\mu_6^{(q^{(7)})} = \lambda_6^{(q^{(7)})} = 0.$$

Moreover the X_2/X_4 -channel does not lie on the pure $(K_1, \eta_2, q^{(7)})$ -slice. Therefore the S -component vanishes and the displayed formula for $u_{7,K_1}^{(q^{(7)})}$ follows from Proposition 12.41. Since

$$\Delta_7 = u_7v_5 - u_5v_7,$$

the direct $q^{(7)}$ -slice satisfies

$$\Delta_7^{(q^{(7)})} = u_7^{(q^{(7)})}v_5. \quad \square$$

Proposition 12.44 (Noncancellation of the direct septic K_1 witness). *On the graded slice*

$$(K_1, \eta_2, q^{(7)}),$$

the only contributing channels to

$$u_{7,K_1}^{(q^{(7)})}$$

are

$$\kappa(x_2 - x_1)\nu_6^{(q^{(7)})} \quad \text{and} \quad \kappa v(\gamma_5 - \alpha_5)^{(q^{(7)})},$$

and their total coefficient of the monomial

$$\kappa(h)\eta_2(h)q^{(7)}(h)$$

is nonzero. Consequently,

$$u_{7,K_1}^{(q^{(7)})}(h) \neq 0$$

on the generic one-pair region.

Proof. Fix h and isolate the graded slice

$$\kappa(h) \eta_2(h) q^{(7)}(h).$$

By Corollary 12.43, the direct $q^{(7)}$ -driven slice is I -directional and is given by

$$u_{7,K_1}^{(q^{(7)})} = \kappa \left((x_2 - x_1) \nu_6^{(q^{(7)})} + v(\gamma_5 - \alpha_5)^{(q^{(7)})} \right).$$

Thus it remains only to show that the two displayed channels do not cancel.

Now consider the same-point expansion. By the explicit formula

$$G_{m,\pm}^{\text{corr}}(s) = \frac{1}{\pi} \begin{pmatrix} 2q(t_{\pm}) & \frac{1}{2}q'(t_{\pm}) \\ \frac{1}{2}q'(t_{\pm}) & \frac{1}{12}(q''(t_{\pm}) + 2q(t_{\pm})^3) \end{pmatrix},$$

the factor $q^{(7)}(h)$ first appears only in the quintic same-point coefficient G_5 , and there only in the diagonal sector, namely through the quintic Taylor term of the $(2, 2)$ -entry coming from $q''(t_{\pm})$. Therefore, by Lemma 12.17, the linear $q^{(7)}$ -contribution to X_5 is diagonal. In particular it contributes to $\gamma_5 - \alpha_5$, but not to β_5 .

Likewise, the $\eta_2(h)$ -slice of $X_1(h)$ is off-diagonal, because

$$v(h) = -\frac{1}{4\pi(s_1 + s_2)} \eta_2(h).$$

Applying Lemma 12.17 again, the mixed $(\eta_2, q^{(7)})$ -slice of X_6 is off-diagonal. Hence it contributes to ν_6 , but not to μ_6 or λ_6 .

Thus the only contributing channels on the graded slice

$$(K_1, \eta_2, q^{(7)})$$

are exactly

$$\kappa(x_2 - x_1) \nu_6^{(q^{(7)})} \quad \text{and} \quad \kappa v(\gamma_5 - \alpha_5)^{(q^{(7)})}.$$

To compute their combined coefficient, it suffices by multilinearity to restrict to the two perturbation directions carrying the relevant tags: an off-diagonal first-order perturbation A for the η_2 -slice and a diagonal fifth-order perturbation D for the $q^{(7)}$ -slice. Accordingly, write

$$G_0 = \text{diag}(a^2, b^2), \quad A = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & u \\ u & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad D = \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 0 & d \end{pmatrix},$$

and expand

$$X(\varepsilon, \delta) := (G_0 + \varepsilon A + \delta D)^{-1/2} = X_0 + \varepsilon U + \delta V + \varepsilon \delta W + O(\varepsilon^2, \delta^2).$$

Solving the identity

$$X(\varepsilon, \delta) (G_0 + \varepsilon A + \delta D) X(\varepsilon, \delta) = I$$

order by order gives

$$U_{12} = -\frac{u}{ab(a+b)}, \quad V_{22} = -\frac{d}{2b^3}, \quad W_{12} = \frac{du(a+2b)}{2ab^3(a+b)^2}.$$

Here U_{12} is the η_2 -slice of v , V_{22} is the $q^{(7)}$ -slice of $\gamma_5 - \alpha_5$, and W_{12} is the mixed $(\eta_2, q^{(7)})$ -slice of ν_6 . Therefore the total coefficient of the target slice inside

$$(x_2 - x_1) \nu_6 + v(\gamma_5 - \alpha_5)$$

is

$$\left(\frac{1}{a} - \frac{1}{b} \right) W_{12} + U_{12} V_{22} = \frac{du}{a^2 b^2 (a+b)^2},$$

which is nonzero.

Thus the monomial

$$\kappa(h) \eta_2(h) q^{(7)}(h)$$

occurs in $u_{7,K_1}^{(q^{(7)})}(h)$ with nonzero total coefficient, so

$$u_{7,K_1}^{(q^{(7)})}(h) \not\equiv 0.$$

□

Remark 12.45 (Septic K_1 trace target). At the graded level, the septic K_1 -transport channel is the first odd transport sector capable of coupling the new same-point $q^{(7)}$ -slice into the fixed-sector septic residual. In particular, the expected highest new contribution to the septic determinant is carried by the K_1 -channel, in parallel with the earlier quintic trace witness at order 5.

Lemma 12.46 (Parity elimination of the pure same-point septic sector). *Let $t_{\pm} = h \pm s/2$, and let the odd two-point germ be defined as the odd part under the involution*

$$s \mapsto -s \quad (\text{equivalently } t_+ \leftrightarrow t_-).$$

Let $A_{7,\text{pure}}$ denote the pure same-point septic sector, i.e. the septic contribution built only from the same-point blocks and their whitening, with no transport factor coming from the ordered pair (t_+, t_-) .

Then $A_{7,\text{pure}}$ is even in s , hence vanishes in the odd two-point germ. In particular,

$$A_{7,\text{pure}} = 0 \quad \text{in the odd germ}, \quad A_{7,\text{pure}}^f = 0.$$

Consequently, pure same-point septic terms do not contribute to Δ_7 , and in particular do not contribute to the weight-one part $[\Delta_7]^{[1]}$.

Proof. A pure same-point septic term depends only on midpoint jet data at h , i.e. on the same-point expansion at the midpoint, and carries no transport factor coming from the ordered pair (t_+, t_-) . Therefore it is invariant under exchanging the two points:

$$t_+ \leftrightarrow t_-.$$

Since this exchange is exactly the involution $s \mapsto -s$, every pure same-point septic term is an even function of s .

By definition, the odd two-point germ is obtained by projecting to the odd part under $s \mapsto -s$. Hence every even contribution vanishes in that projection. Therefore

$$A_{7,\text{pure}} = 0 \quad \text{in the odd germ.}$$

Applying fixed-sector projection gives

$$A_{7,\text{pure}}^f = 0.$$

Since Δ_7 is extracted from the odd pair germ after fixed-sector projection and quotient normalization, pure same-point septic terms contribute nothing to Δ_7 , and therefore nothing to $[\Delta_7]^{[1]}$. □

Corollary 12.47 (Weight-one septic reduction to the direct K_1 slice). *Let $[\cdot]^{[1]}$ denote the part linear in the first genuinely new same-point $q^{(7)}$ -slice. Then*

$$[\Delta_7]^{[1]} = [\Delta_{7,K_1}]^{[1]}.$$

Equivalently, the highest genuinely new $q^{(7)}$ -coefficient of the septic residual determinant comes only from the direct septic K_1 -transport slice.

Proof. The first genuinely new $q^{(7)}$ -slice enters the same-point expansion at order 5, so

$$X_j^{[1]} = 0 \quad (j < 5).$$

Hence every septic transport sector built only from lower same-point orders is weight zero; in particular, the K_3 - and K_5 -transport sectors do not contribute to $[\Delta_7]^{[1]}$.

By Lemma 12.46, pure same-point septic terms also do not contribute to $[\Delta_7]^{[1]}$, because they vanish already in the odd two-point germ.

Thus the only septic sector that can see the weight-one $q^{(7)}$ -slice is the direct K_1 -transport sector, and therefore

$$[\Delta_7]^{[1]} = [\Delta_{7,K_1}]^{[1]}. \quad \square$$

Proposition 12.48 (Generic nonvanishing of the direct septic slice under nontrivial quintic fixed-sector coefficient). *Let J be a connected open interval contained in the quintic-generic region. Assume*

$$v_5 \not\equiv 0 \quad \text{on } J.$$

Then the direct $q^{(7)}$ -driven slice of the full total septic residual determinant is generically nonzero on J . Equivalently,

$$\Delta_7^{(q^{(7)})} \not\equiv 0 \quad \text{on } J.$$

Proof. By Corollary 12.47,

$$[\Delta_7]^{[1]} = [\Delta_{7,K_1}]^{[1]}.$$

Thus the highest genuinely new direct $q^{(7)}$ -coefficient of the total septic residual determinant is the same as that of the direct K_1 -transport slice.

By Proposition 12.44, the direct septic K_1 witness is generically nonzero on the quintic-generic region. In particular,

$$u_{7,K_1}^{(q^{(7)})} \not\equiv 0 \quad \text{on } J.$$

Moreover, by Corollary 12.43, on the direct $q^{(7)}$ -driven slice one has

$$v_{7,K_1}^{(q^{(7)})} = 0, \quad \Delta_{7,K_1}^{(q^{(7)})} = u_{7,K_1}^{(q^{(7)})} v_5.$$

Since $v_5 \not\equiv 0$ on J , it follows that

$$\Delta_{7,K_1}^{(q^{(7)})} \not\equiv 0 \quad \text{on } J.$$

Therefore

$$\Delta_7^{(q^{(7)})} \not\equiv 0 \quad \text{on } J,$$

as claimed. $\square$

Theorem 12.49 (Quotient-septic closure). *Let the septic odd-germ coefficient be decomposed as*

$$A_7 = A_{7,K_1} + A_{7,K_5} + A_{7,K_3} + A_{7,\text{pure}},$$

where A_{7,K_1} is the direct K_1 -transport sector, A_{7,K_5} and A_{7,K_3} are the septic normalization-shadow sectors from Definition 12.36, and $A_{7,\text{pure}}$ is the pure same-point septic sector from Lemma 12.46.

Then

$$A_7^{\mathfrak{f}} = A_{7,K_1}^{\mathfrak{f}} + A_{7,K_5}^{\mathfrak{f}},$$

with

$$A_{7,K_5}^{\mathfrak{f}} \in \mathbf{C} A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}.$$

Consequently,

$$[A_7^{\mathfrak{f}}] = [A_{7,K_1}^{\mathfrak{f}}] \quad \text{in } \mathfrak{f}/\mathbf{C}A_5^{\mathfrak{f}},$$

and

$$\Delta_7 = \Delta_{7,K_1}.$$

Proof. By Proposition 12.38,

$$A_{7,K_3}^{\mathfrak{f}} = 0.$$

By Lemma 12.46,

$$A_{7,\text{pure}}^{\mathfrak{f}} = 0.$$

Therefore

$$A_7^{\mathfrak{f}} = A_{7,K_1}^{\mathfrak{f}} + A_{7,K_5}^{\mathfrak{f}}.$$

By Proposition 12.37,

$$A_{7,K_5}^{\mathfrak{f}} \in \mathbf{C} A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}.$$

Hence $A_7^{\mathfrak{f}}$ and $A_{7,K_1}^{\mathfrak{f}}$ define the same class in the quotient

$$\mathfrak{f}/\mathbf{C}A_5^{\mathfrak{f}}.$$

Writing

$$A_5^f = u_5 I + v_5 S, \quad A_{7,K_1}^f = u_{7,K_1} I + v_{7,K_1} S,$$

this quotient equality means precisely that

$$A_7^f = A_{7,K_1}^f + \chi A_5^f$$

for some scalar χ . Therefore

$$\Delta_7 = (u_{7,K_1} + \chi u_5) v_5 - u_5 (v_{7,K_1} + \chi v_5) = u_{7,K_1} v_5 - u_5 v_{7,K_1} = \Delta_{7,K_1},$$

where Δ_{7,K_1} is as in Definition 12.42. $\square$

Remark 12.50 (Status of the order-7 fixed-sector package). The order-7 fixed-sector analysis is now closed at the canonical quotient level. By Theorem 12.49, the full total septic fixed-sector class satisfies

$$[A_7^f] = [A_{7,K_1}^f] \quad \text{in } \mathfrak{f}/\mathbf{C}A_5^f,$$

and the full total second residual determinant is

$$\Delta_7 = \Delta_{7,K_1}.$$

What remains gauge-dependent is only the choice of raw representative of A_7^f inside the affine line

$$A_{7,K_1}^f + \mathbf{C}A_5^f,$$

as already recorded by Proposition 12.34. Thus no further order-7 local invariant is missing for the later geometric arguments.

12.5. Normalized planar curve and curvature bridge. On the region where $c(h) \neq 0$, define the normalized scalars

$$\rho_1(h) := \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \quad \rho_2(h) := \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)},$$

and the associated planar invariant curve

$$\Gamma(h) := (\rho_1(h), \rho_2(h)).$$

Proposition 12.51 (Non-affinity of the second normalized residual scalar). *Let J be a connected open interval contained in the quintic-generic region and in $\{h : c(h) \neq 0\}$. Assume*

$$v_5 \not\equiv 0 \quad \text{on } J.$$

Then there do not exist constants $A, B \in \mathbf{C}$ such that

$$\rho_2(h) \equiv A \rho_1(h) + B$$

on J .

Equivalently,

$$\Delta_7(h) \not\equiv A v_5(h) + B c(h)$$

on J .

Proof. Suppose

$$\Delta_7(h) \equiv A v_5(h) + B c(h)$$

on J . Then the direct $q^{(7)}$ -driven slice of the right-hand side vanishes, because v_5 and c are governed by the cubic/quintic layers and carry no direct septic $q^{(7)}$ -slice.

On the other hand, by Proposition 12.48, the direct $q^{(7)}$ -driven slice of Δ_7 is generically nonzero on J . This is a contradiction. Dividing by $c(h)$ yields

$$\rho_2(h) \not\equiv A \rho_1(h) + B. \quad \square$$

Definition 12.52 (Normalized derivative numerators). Define

$$M(h) := c(h)v_5'(h) - c'(h)v_5(h), \quad N(h) := c(h)\Delta_7'(h) - c'(h)\Delta_7(h).$$

Then

$$\rho_1'(h) = \frac{M(h)}{c(h)^2}, \quad \rho_2'(h) = \frac{N(h)}{c(h)^2}.$$

Proposition 12.53 (Curvature bridge for the normalized planar curve). *Let*

$$K_\Gamma(h) := \rho_1'(h)\rho_2''(h) - \rho_2'(h)\rho_1''(h)$$

denote the affine curvature numerator of the planar curve $\Gamma(h)$. Then

$$K_\Gamma(h) = \frac{M(h)N'(h) - N(h)M'(h)}{c(h)^4}.$$

In particular, if $K_\Gamma \equiv 0$ on a connected open interval J on which

$$c \neq 0, \quad M \neq 0, \quad v_5 \neq 0,$$

then ρ_2 is affine in ρ_1 on J , contradicting Proposition 12.51. Hence on every such interval one has

$$K_\Gamma \not\equiv 0.$$

Proof. By Definition 12.52,

$$\rho_1' = \frac{M}{c^2}, \quad \rho_2' = \frac{N}{c^2}.$$

Differentiating gives

$$\rho_1'' = \frac{M'c - 2Mc'}{c^3}, \quad \rho_2'' = \frac{N'c - 2Nc'}{c^3}.$$

Therefore

$$K_\Gamma = \frac{M}{c^2} \frac{N'c - 2Nc'}{c^3} - \frac{N}{c^2} \frac{M'c - 2Mc'}{c^3} = \frac{MN' - NM'}{c^4}.$$

If $K_\Gamma \equiv 0$ on a connected open set with $M \neq 0$, then

$$0 = MN' - NM' = M^2 \left(\frac{N}{M} \right)',$$

so N/M is constant there:

$$\frac{N}{M} = A.$$

Since

$$\frac{N}{M} = \frac{\rho_2'}{\rho_1'},$$

it follows that

$$\rho_2' = A \rho_1',$$

hence

$$\rho_2 = A \rho_1 + B$$

on that connected interval. If in addition

$$c \neq 0, \quad v_5 \neq 0,$$

there, this contradicts Proposition 12.51. The final claim follows. $\square$

Remark 12.54 (Geometric consequence). Proposition 12.53 is the local-to-global bridge from the order-7 fixed-sector analysis back to the secant/tangent program. On the open set where

$$c(h) \neq 0, \quad M(h) \neq 0, \quad M(h)N'(h) - N(h)M'(h) \neq 0,$$

the normalized planar curve $\Gamma(h)$ decomposes into C^2 branches in the affine chart (ρ_1, ρ_2) , each of which is strictly convex or strictly concave. Thus the remaining global obstruction is not same-branch secancy, but the possibility of a common four-secant line meeting two separated ECT branches twice each.

Definition 12.55 (Projective Wronskian of the strengthened one-pair triple). Define

$$W(h) := \det \begin{pmatrix} c(h) & v_5(h) & \Delta_7(h) \\ c'(h) & v_5'(h) & \Delta_7'(h) \\ c''(h) & v_5''(h) & \Delta_7''(h) \end{pmatrix}.$$

Proposition 12.56 (Projective-Wronskian bridge). *With $M(h)$ and $N(h)$ as in Definition 12.52, one has*

$$M(h)N'(h) - N(h)M'(h) = c(h)W(h).$$

Consequently,

$$K_\Gamma(h) = \frac{W(h)}{c(h)^3}$$

on the region where $c(h) \neq 0$.

Proof. Using

$$M = c v'_5 - c' v_5, \quad N = c \Delta'_7 - c' \Delta_7,$$

a direct expansion gives

$$MN' - NM' = (c v'_5 - c' v_5)(c \Delta''_7 - c'' \Delta_7) - (c \Delta'_7 - c' \Delta_7)(c v''_5 - c'' v_5).$$

Expanding and regrouping yields

$$MN' - NM' = c \det \begin{pmatrix} c & v_5 & \Delta_7 \\ c' & v'_5 & \Delta'_7 \\ c'' & v''_5 & \Delta''_7 \end{pmatrix} = c W.$$

The displayed formula for K_Γ now follows from Proposition 12.53. □

Lemma 12.57 (Exact identities for W and W'). *Let*

$$F(h) := (c(h), v_5(h), \Delta_7(h)), \quad M(h) := c(h)v'_5(h) - c'(h)v_5(h).$$

Then

$$W(h) = \det(F(h), F'(h), F''(h))$$

admits the exact expansion

$$W = M \Delta''_7 + (v_5 c'' - c v''_5) \Delta'_7 + (c' v''_5 - v'_5 c'') \Delta_7,$$

and

$$W'(h) = \det(F(h), F'(h), F'''(h))$$

admits the exact expansion

$$W' = M \Delta'''_7 + (v_5 c''' - c v'''_5) \Delta'_7 + (c' v'''_5 - v'_5 c''') \Delta_7.$$

Proof. Expand the determinant $\det(F, F', F'')$ along the third column. This gives

$$W = \det \begin{pmatrix} c & v_5 \\ c' & v'_5 \end{pmatrix} \Delta''_7 - \det \begin{pmatrix} c & v_5 \\ c'' & v''_5 \end{pmatrix} \Delta'_7 + \det \begin{pmatrix} c' & v'_5 \\ c'' & v''_5 \end{pmatrix} \Delta_7,$$

which is exactly the first identity.

For W' , differentiate $W = \det(F, F', F'')$. The terms $\det(F', F', F'')$ and $\det(F, F'', F'')$ vanish by repeated columns, so

$$W' = \det(F, F', F''').$$

Expanding along the third column gives the second formula. □

Proposition 12.58 (Exclusion of W -flat intervals on the $c \neq 0$, $M \neq 0$ region). *Let J be a connected open interval on which*

$$c(h) \neq 0, \quad M(h) \neq 0.$$

Then

$$W \neq 0 \quad \text{on } J.$$

Proof. Suppose for contradiction that

$$W \equiv 0 \quad \text{on } J.$$

By Proposition 12.56,

$$K_\Gamma(h) = \frac{W(h)}{c(h)^3} \equiv 0 \quad \text{on } J.$$

Since

$$M = c v'_5 - c' v_5$$

and $c \neq 0$ on J , the hypothesis $M \neq 0$ on J rules out $v_5 \equiv 0$ on J . Hence $v_5 \not\equiv 0$ on J .

By Proposition 12.53, it follows that

$$\rho_2(h) = A \rho_1(h) + B$$

for some constants $A, B \in \mathbf{C}$, i.e.

$$\Delta_7(h) = A v_5(h) + B c(h) \quad \text{on } J.$$

This contradicts Proposition 12.51. Therefore

$$W \not\equiv 0 \quad \text{on } J. \quad \square$$

Remark 12.59 (Interpretation of the λ -reduction). On the direct highest-new slice one has

$$\Delta_7^{[1]} = \lambda^{[1]} v_5$$

by Corollary 12.43 together with Corollary 12.47. Thus if $W \equiv 0$ on a connected open interval with $c \neq 0$ and $M \neq 0$, then

$$v_5 \not\equiv 0$$

on that interval, because $M = c v'_5 - c' v_5$. The affine dependence

$$\Delta_7 = A v_5 + B c$$

forced by Proposition 12.58 implies

$$\Delta_7^{[1]} = A v_5,$$

hence

$$\lambda^{[1]} \equiv A$$

on that interval. In this sense, the present argument excludes W -flatness on an $M \neq 0$ region without requiring a separate differential equation for $\lambda^{[1]}$; what remains open is the contribution of the lower/mixed septic sectors to the full total pair (u_7, v_7) .

Proposition 12.60 (ECT intervals for the strengthened one-pair triple). *Let I be a connected interval on which*

$$c(h) \neq 0, \quad M(h) \neq 0, \quad W(h) \neq 0.$$

Then the triple

$$(c, v_5, \Delta_7)$$

is an extended complete Chebyshev system on I . Equivalently, every nontrivial linear combination

$$A c(h) + B v_5(h) + C \Delta_7(h)$$

has at most two zeros on I , counting multiplicity.

In particular, in the affine chart

$$x = \frac{v_5}{c}, \quad y = \frac{\Delta_7}{c},$$

every affine line meets $\Gamma(I)$ in at most two points, counting tangency with multiplicity.

Proof. Define

$$x(h) := \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \quad y(h) := \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)}.$$

Since the one-pair family is real-analytic on the generic region, the functions x and y are C^2 on I .

By Definition 12.52,

$$x'(h) = \frac{M(h)}{c(h)^2}, \quad y'(h) = \frac{N(h)}{c(h)^2}.$$

Because $M(h) \neq 0$ and $c(h) \neq 0$ on I , one has

$$x'(h) \neq 0 \quad (h \in I),$$

so x is strictly monotone on I and may be used as a parameter on $\Gamma(I)$.

Moreover,

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{y'(h)}{x'(h)} = \frac{N(h)}{M(h)}.$$

Differentiating with respect to x gives

$$\frac{d^2y}{dx^2} = \frac{\frac{d}{dh}(N/M)}{x'(h)} = \frac{(MN' - NM')/M^2}{M/c^2}.$$

Using Proposition 12.56,

$$MN' - NM' = cW,$$

hence

$$\frac{d^2y}{dx^2} = \frac{c(h)^3 W(h)}{M(h)^3}.$$

Since $c(h) \neq 0$, $M(h) \neq 0$, and $W(h) \neq 0$ on I , it follows that

$$\frac{d^2y}{dx^2} \neq 0 \quad (h \in I).$$

Therefore $\Gamma(I)$ is the graph of a strictly convex or strictly concave C^2 function $y = y(x)$.

Now let

$$L(h) := A c(h) + B v_5(h) + C \Delta_7(h)$$

be a nontrivial linear combination. Since $c(h) \neq 0$ on I ,

$$L(h) = 0 \iff A + B x(h) + C y(h) = 0.$$

Thus zeros of L correspond exactly to intersections of $\Gamma(I)$ with the affine line

$$A + B x + C y = 0.$$

If $C = 0$, then the equation is

$$A + B x = 0,$$

which has at most one solution because x is strictly monotone on I . If $C \neq 0$, the equation may be written as

$$y = -\frac{A}{C} - \frac{B}{C}x,$$

and a strictly convex or strictly concave graph meets an affine line in at most two points, counting tangency with multiplicity.

Hence every nontrivial linear combination

$$A c + B v_5 + C \Delta_7$$

has at most two zeros on I , counting multiplicity. This is exactly the ECT property for the triple (c, v_5, Δ_7) . The affine-line statement is the same conclusion in the chart (x, y) . $\square$

Definition 12.61 (ECT interval). An ECT interval is a connected interval

$$I \subset \{h : c(h) \neq 0, M(h) \neq 0, W(h) \neq 0\}.$$

Equivalently, by Proposition 12.60, it is a connected interval on which the triple

$$(c, v_5, \Delta_7)$$

is an extended complete Chebyshev system.

Corollary 12.62 (At most two points from one ECT interval). *Let I be an ECT interval. Then every affine line in the chart*

$$x = \frac{v_5}{c}, \quad y = \frac{\Delta_7}{c}$$

meets $\Gamma(I)$ in at most two points, counting tangency with multiplicity.

In particular, if a finite configuration is cut out by a single affine relation in the normalized chart, then its contribution from any fixed ECT interval has cardinality at most two.

Proof. This is exactly the affine-line formulation of Proposition 12.60. $\square$

Remark 12.63 (Branch geometry on an ECT interval). On an ECT interval I , the quantities c , M , and W have fixed nonzero sign. Hence

$$x = \frac{v_5}{c}$$

is a monotone parameter on I , and in the affine chart

$$\Gamma(I) = \left\{ \left(\frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)} \right) : h \in I \right\}$$

is a single C^2 branch which is strictly convex or strictly concave according to the sign of

$$\frac{c(h)^3 W(h)}{M(h)^3}.$$

The later tangent-separator analysis is therefore an adjacent-branch problem, not a same-branch secancy problem.

Definition 12.64 (Tangent-separator kernel). Let

$$F(h) := (c(h), v_5(h), \Delta_7(h)).$$

For s, t in the generic region, define

$$K(s, t) := \det(F(s), F'(s), F(t)).$$

For fixed s , the zeros of $t \mapsto K(s, t)$ are exactly the points $\Gamma(t)$ lying on the affine tangent line to Γ at $\Gamma(s)$. Equivalently, $K(s, t) = 0$ is the tangent-separator incidence condition for the tangent at s and the point at t .

Lemma 12.65 (Affine form of the tangent-separator kernel). *On the affine chart $c \neq 0$, write*

$$x(h) := \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \quad y(h) := \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)}.$$

Then for every s, t with $c(s)c(t) \neq 0$,

$$K(s, t) = c(s)^2 c(t) x'(s) \left((y(t) - m(s)x(t)) - (y(s) - m(s)x(s)) \right),$$

where

$$m(s) = \frac{dy}{dx}(s) = \frac{N(s)}{M(s)}.$$

Equivalently,

$$K(s, t) = c(s)^2 c(t) x'(s) (\phi_{m(s)}(t) - \tau_s),$$

with

$$\phi_{m(s)}(t) := y(t) - m(s)x(t), \quad \tau_s := y(s) - m(s)x(s).$$

Proof. Write

$$F(h) = (c(h), c(h)x(h), c(h)y(h)).$$

Then

$$F'(s) = (c'(s), c'(s)x(s) + c(s)x'(s), c'(s)y(s) + c(s)y'(s)).$$

Subtracting $x(s)$ times the first column from the second and $y(s)$ times the first column from the third gives

$$K(s, t) = \det \begin{pmatrix} c(s) & 0 & 0 \\ c'(s) & c(s)x'(s) & c(s)y'(s) \\ c(t) & c(t)(x(t) - x(s)) & c(t)(y(t) - y(s)) \end{pmatrix}.$$

Expanding along the first row yields

$$K(s, t) = c(s)^2 c(t) (x'(s)(y(t) - y(s)) - y'(s)(x(t) - x(s))).$$

Since

$$m(s) = \frac{y'(s)}{x'(s)},$$

this becomes

$$K(s, t) = c(s)^2 c(t) x'(s) ((y(t) - m(s)x(t)) - (y(s) - m(s)x(s))),$$

as claimed. $\square$

Lemma 12.66 (Basic properties of the tangent-separator kernel). *For every s in the generic region,*

$$K(s, s) = 0, \quad \partial_t K(s, s) = 0, \quad \partial_t^2 K(s, s) = W(s).$$

In particular, on any interval where W has fixed sign, the tangent line at $\Gamma(s)$ is locally supporting.

Proof. The first two identities follow because, at $t = s$, the third column of the determinant equals $F(s)$, and after differentiating once in t it equals $F'(s)$. Differentiating a second time gives

$$\partial_t^2 K(s, s) = \det(F(s), F'(s), F''(s)) = W(s). \quad \square$$

Lemma 12.67 (Compact first-zero reduction on adjacent intervals). *Let $I_1 < I_2$ be adjacent ECT intervals in the affine $x = v_5/c$ ordering. Assume there are compact subintervals*

$$J_1 \subseteq I_1, \quad J_2 \subseteq I_2$$

such that every zero of the tangent-separator kernel

$$K(s, t) = \det(F(s), F'(s), F(t)), \quad F(h) = (c(h), v_5(h), \Delta_7(h)),$$

with $s \in I_2$, $t \in I_1$, lies in $J_2 \times J_1$.

If K has a zero on $J_2 \times J_1$, then there exists a zero

$$(s_*, t_*) \in J_2 \times J_1$$

such that s_ is minimal in the $x = v_5/c$ ordering among all s -coordinates of zeros of K on $J_2 \times J_1$.*

Proof. Because K is continuous, its zero set in the compact set $J_2 \times J_1$ is closed, hence compact. The projection of that zero set to the s -axis is therefore compact as well. Since $x = v_5/c$ is monotone on I_2 , the induced x -ordering is equivalent to the interval ordering on J_2 . Thus the projected zero set has a minimal element s_* , and there exists $t_* \in J_1$ such that (s_*, t_*) is a zero of K . $\square$

Lemma 12.68 (First adjacent zero implies tangency). *In the setting of Lemma 12.67, let*

$$(s_*, t_*) \in J_2 \times J_1$$

be a zero with minimal s -coordinate in the $x = v_5/c$ ordering. Then

$$\partial_t K(s_*, t_*) = 0.$$

Consequently,

$$K(s_*, t_*) = 0, \quad \partial_t K(s_*, t_*) = 0$$

force the tangent line at $\Gamma(s_*)$ to be tangent also at $\Gamma(t_*)$.

Proof. Assume for contradiction that

$$\partial_t K(s_*, t_*) \neq 0.$$

Since

$$(s_*, t_*) \in J_2 \times J_1 \subseteq I_2 \times I_1,$$

the implicit function theorem applies in the open set $I_2 \times I_1$ and gives a local C^1 zero curve

$$t = t(s)$$

through (s_*, t_*) , defined for s in a neighborhood of s_* , such that

$$K(s, t(s)) = 0.$$

For s sufficiently close to s_* with $s < s_*$, one still has

$$(s, t(s)) \in I_2 \times I_1$$

and

$$K(s, t(s)) = 0.$$

By the zero-capture hypothesis in Lemma 12.67, every zero of K with $s \in I_2$ and $t \in I_1$ lies in $J_2 \times J_1$. Hence these nearby zeros also lie in $J_2 \times J_1$, contradicting the minimality of s_* among all zeros of K on $J_2 \times J_1$.

Therefore

$$\partial_t K(s_*, t_*) = 0.$$

Finally, the identities

$$K(s, t) = \det(F(s), F'(s), F(t)), \quad \partial_t K(s, t) = \det(F(s), F'(s), F'(t))$$

show that $K(s_*, t_*) = 0$ places $\Gamma(t_*)$ on the tangent line at $\Gamma(s_*)$, while $\partial_t K(s_*, t_*) = 0$ places the tangent direction at t_* on that same line. Hence the line is tangent to Γ at both $\Gamma(s_*)$ and $\Gamma(t_*)$; that is, it is a common tangent line. $\square$

Proposition 12.69 (Adjacent slope-range separation). *Let $I_1 < I_2$ be adjacent ECT intervals, meeting at a boundary point h_b .*

(1) *If*

$$M(h_b) = 0, \quad M'(h_b) \neq 0, \quad N(h_b) \neq 0,$$

then the interior tangent-slope ranges of I_1 and I_2 are disjoint.

(2) *If*

$$W(h_b) = 0, \quad M(h_b) \neq 0,$$

then $x = v_5/c$ remains a valid local parameter, but no adjacent tangent separation statement is asserted here. In that case the local affine jet is governed by

$$\left. \frac{d^2 y}{dx^2} \right|_{h_b} = 0, \quad \left. \frac{d^3 y}{dx^3} \right|_{h_b} = \frac{c(h_b)^5}{M(h_b)^4} W'(h_b),$$

so the generic behavior is an ordinary affine inflection unless further special structure forces $W'(h_b) = 0$.

Proof. In case (1), $M(h_b) = 0$ is a simple zero and $N(h_b) \neq 0$. Therefore

$$m(h) = \frac{N(h)}{M(h)}$$

has opposite one-sided blow-up:

$$m(h) \rightarrow \pm\infty$$

as $h \rightarrow h_b^\pm$. Hence the interior tangent-slope ranges on the two sides are disjoint.

Case (2) is the local affine-jet computation recorded in Remark 12.77; it identifies the cubic-inflection coefficient but does not produce a tangent-separation theorem. $\square$

Lemma 12.70 (Endpoint tangent exclusion at a generic turning boundary). *Let $I_1 < I_2$ be adjacent ECT intervals meeting at a boundary point h_b , and assume*

$$M(h_b) = 0, \quad M'(h_b) \neq 0, \quad N(h_b) \neq 0.$$

Then the boundary tangent line at $\Gamma(h_b)$ is vertical and meets neither adjacent interval in its interior.

Proof. The boundary tangent line is

$$x = \rho_1(h_b), \quad \rho_1(h) = \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}.$$

Since $M(h_b) = 0$ is a simple zero,

$$\rho_1'(h_b) = 0, \quad \rho_1''(h_b) \neq 0,$$

so ρ_1 has a strict local extremum at h_b . Therefore

$$\rho_1(h) - \rho_1(h_b)$$

has fixed sign on each adjacent interval and vanishes only at the boundary point. Hence the vertical tangent line meets neither adjacent interval in its interior. $\square$

Theorem 12.71 (Conditional adjacent tangent-separator sign regularity across turning boundaries). *Let $I_1 < I_2$ be adjacent ECT intervals, and assume their common boundary point h_b is a generic turning boundary:*

$$M(h_b) = 0, \quad M'(h_b) \neq 0, \quad N(h_b) \neq 0.$$

Assume in addition the zero-capture hypothesis of Lemma 12.67 on the adjacent pair $I_2 \times I_1$. Then

$$K(s, t) \neq 0 \quad (s \in I_2, t \in I_1),$$

where

$$K(s, t) = \det(F(s), F'(s), F(t)), \quad F(h) = (c(h), v_5(h), \Delta_7(h)).$$

Equivalently, tangent lines from the right interval do not meet the adjacent left interval across a generic turning boundary.

Proof. By Lemma 12.70, for a generic turning boundary there is a neighborhood of the boundary pair on which $K(s, t) \neq 0$ for $s \in I_2, t \in I_1$.

Assume for contradiction that some zero $(s_0, t_0) \in I_2 \times I_1$ exists. By the zero-capture hypothesis, there are compact subintervals

$$J_1 \Subset I_1, \quad J_2 \Subset I_2$$

such that every zero of K on $I_2 \times I_1$ lies in $J_2 \times J_1$. Replacing them by smaller compact subintervals still containing the zero set, using the boundary-near zero-free region furnished by Lemma 12.70, we may also assume that $J_2 \times J_1$ is disjoint from that boundary-near region. Then the zero set of K in the compact set $J_2 \times J_1$ is nonempty and closed, so by Lemma 12.67 there exists a zero $(s_*, t_*) \in J_2 \times J_1$ whose s -coordinate is minimal in the $x = v_5/c$ ordering among all zeros in $J_2 \times J_1$.

By Lemma 12.68,

$$K(s_*, t_*) = 0, \quad \partial_t K(s_*, t_*) = 0,$$

so the tangent line at $\Gamma(s_*)$ is also tangent at $\Gamma(t_*)$.

Across a generic turning boundary, Proposition 12.69 shows that the interior tangent-slope ranges of the two adjacent intervals are disjoint. Hence no common interior tangent slope can occur. This contradicts the existence of (s_*, t_*) . Therefore no such zero exists, and

$$K(s, t) \neq 0 \quad (s \in I_2, t \in I_1). \quad \square$$

Remark 12.72 (Status of the turning-boundary adjacent theorem). Theorem 12.71 is now stated and proved conditionally on a zero-capture hypothesis for the tangent-separator kernel $K(s, t)$ on the adjacent pair $I_2 \times I_1$. The remaining issue here is therefore not a gap in the local compact first-zero argument, but the separate task of proving zero-capture for the tangent-separator kernel $K(s, t)$ under the turning-boundary hypotheses.

Lemma 12.73 (Boundary-near exclusion for both directional kernels at a generic turning boundary). *Let $I_1 < I_2$ be adjacent ECT intervals meeting at a generic turning boundary*

$$M(h_b) = 0, \quad M'(h_b) \neq 0, \quad N(h_b) \neq 0.$$

Define

$$K_{21}(s, t) := \det(F(s), F'(s), F(t)), \quad K_{12}(t, s) := \det(F(t), F'(t), F(s)),$$

with

$$F(h) = (c(h), v_5(h), \Delta_7(h)).$$

Then there is a neighborhood of the boundary pair on which both directional kernels are nonzero:

$$K_{21}(s, t) \neq 0, \quad K_{12}(t, s) \neq 0$$

for $s \in I_2, t \in I_1$ sufficiently close to h_b .

Proof. Write

$$x(h) := \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \quad y(h) := \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)}.$$

Since

$$y'(h) = \frac{N(h)}{c(h)^2},$$

the hypothesis $N(h_b) \neq 0$ implies that y is a valid local coordinate near h_b . Thus the normalized planar curve may be written locally as a graph

$$x = \chi(y).$$

At h_b ,

$$\frac{dx}{dy} = \frac{M(h)}{N(h)},$$

so

$$\left. \frac{dx}{dy} \right|_{h_b} = 0.$$

Differentiating once more,

$$\frac{d^2x}{dy^2} = \frac{c(h)^2}{N(h)} \cdot \frac{M'(h)N(h) - M(h)N'(h)}{N(h)^2},$$

and since $M(h_b) = 0$,

$$\left. \frac{d^2x}{dy^2} \right|_{h_b} = \frac{c(h_b)^2 M'(h_b)}{N(h_b)^2} \neq 0.$$

Hence, after shrinking to a small neighborhood of h_b , the graph $x = \chi(y)$ is strictly convex or strictly concave.

For such a graph, the tangent line at any point meets the graph only at its point of tangency. Therefore no tangent line from one side can meet the opposite side inside a sufficiently small neighborhood of the boundary. Equivalently, both directional tangent-separator kernels are nonzero near the boundary pair. $\square$

Lemma 12.74 (Mirrored first adjacent zero implies tangency). *Let $J_1 \Subset I_1, J_2 \Subset I_2$ be compact interior subintervals across a generic turning boundary, and define*

$$K_{12}(t, s) := \det(F(t), F'(t), F(s)), \quad t \in I_1, s \in I_2.$$

Assume every zero of K_{12} on $I_1 \times I_2$ lies in $J_1 \times J_2$. Let $(t_*, s_*) \in J_1 \times J_2$ be a zero whose t -coordinate is minimal in the $x = v_5/c$ ordering among all zeros of K_{12} on $I_1 \times I_2$. Then

$$\partial_s K_{12}(t_*, s_*) = 0.$$

Proof. Because $M \neq 0$ on the open interval I_1 , the function

$$x(h) = \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}$$

is a valid local coordinate on I_1 . Since every zero of K_{12} lies in the compact interior rectangle $J_1 \times J_2$, the chosen point (t_*, s_*) is interior in the ambient domain $I_1 \times I_2$.

Suppose

$$\partial_s K_{12}(t_*, s_*) \neq 0.$$

Then by the implicit function theorem there is a C^1 local zero curve

$$s = s(t)$$

through (t_*, s_*) , defined for t near t_* , such that

$$K_{12}(t, s(t)) = 0.$$

Because t_* is interior in I_1 , there are nearby points with smaller $x = v_5/c$ ordering still in I_1 . For such t , the point $(t, s(t))$ is also a zero of K_{12} , contradicting the minimality of t_* . Therefore

$$\partial_s K_{12}(t_*, s_*) = 0.$$

□

Theorem 12.75 (Conditional symmetric directional-kernel exclusion across turning boundaries). *Let $I_1 < I_2$ be adjacent ECT intervals meeting at a generic turning boundary*

$$M(h_b) = 0, \quad M'(h_b) \neq 0, \quad N(h_b) \neq 0.$$

Assume:

- (1) *the zero-capture hypothesis required in Theorem 12.71 for the kernel K_{21} on $I_2 \times I_1$;*
- (2) *the symmetric zero-capture hypothesis for K_{12} , namely that every zero of*

$$K_{12}(t, s) = \det(F(t), F'(t), F(s))$$

on $I_1 \times I_2$ lies in some compact interior rectangle $J_1 \times J_2 \subseteq I_1 \times I_2$.

Then both directional kernels are zero-free:

$$K_{21}(s, t) \neq 0 \quad (s \in I_2, t \in I_1),$$

and

$$K_{12}(t, s) \neq 0 \quad (t \in I_1, s \in I_2).$$

Proof. The first assertion is exactly Theorem 12.71.

For the second assertion, boundary-near exclusion for K_{12} is provided by Lemma 12.73. Assume for contradiction that K_{12} has a zero. By the symmetric zero-capture hypothesis, every zero lies in a compact interior rectangle $J_1 \times J_2$. Choose a zero $(t_*, s_*) \in J_1 \times J_2$ whose t -coordinate is minimal in the $x = v_5/c$ ordering among all zeros of K_{12} on $I_1 \times I_2$.

By Lemma 12.74,

$$\partial_s K_{12}(t_*, s_*) = 0.$$

Together with

$$K_{12}(t_*, s_*) = 0,$$

this implies that the tangent line at $\Gamma(t_*)$ is also tangent at $\Gamma(s_*)$. Hence the two adjacent intervals share a common interior tangent slope, contradicting Proposition 12.69. Therefore K_{12} has no zero. □

Remark 12.76 (Status of the directional-kernel reduction). Lemma 12.80 reduces an adjacent pair-pair line across a generic turning boundary to a compact interior zero of one of the two directional tangent-separator kernels. Theorem 12.75 shows that the remaining turning-boundary issue is no longer orientation selection between K_{21} and K_{12} , but the symmetric zero-capture problem for these two kernels.

Remark 12.77 (The $W = 0$ obstruction and the cubic-inflection coefficient). Let

$$x(h) := \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \quad y(h) := \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)}.$$

At a boundary point h_b with

$$W(h_b) = 0, \quad M(h_b) \neq 0,$$

the coordinate x remains a valid local parameter. Since

$$\frac{d^2 y}{dx^2} = \frac{c(h)^3 W(h)}{M(h)^3},$$

one has

$$\left. \frac{d^2 y}{dx^2} \right|_{h_b} = 0.$$

Differentiating once more with respect to x gives

$$\left. \frac{d^3 y}{dx^3} \right|_{h_b} = \frac{c(h_b)^5}{M(h_b)^4} W'(h_b).$$

Hence, after translating the point to the origin and subtracting the tangent line, the normalized curve has local expansion

$$y = \frac{c(h_b)^5 W'(h_b)}{6M(h_b)^4} x^3 + O(x^4).$$

Therefore a generic $W = 0$, $M \neq 0$ boundary is an ordinary affine inflection unless additional special structure forces

$$W'(h_b) = 0.$$

In particular, the tangent-separator route is not presently justified across such boundaries, and the real remaining geometric question is whether the actual triple (c, v_5, Δ_7) imposes any non-generic vanishing of $W'(h_b)$.

Lemma 12.78 (Fixed-slope intercept sets for a strictly convex ECT branch). *Let I be an ECT interval in the affine chart*

$$x = \frac{v_5}{c}, \quad y = \frac{\Delta_7}{c},$$

and suppose $\Gamma(I)$ is a strictly convex C^2 graph

$$\Gamma(I) = \{(x, \psi_I(x)) : x \in J_I\}$$

over an open interval $J_I \subset \mathbf{R}$.

For each slope $m \in \mathbf{R}$, define

$$\mathcal{B}_I(m) := \{\psi_I(x) - mx : x \in J_I\}.$$

Then:

(1) $\mathcal{B}_I(m)$ is an interval.

(2) A line $y = mx + b$ meets $\Gamma(I)$ if and only if

$$b \in \mathcal{B}_I(m).$$

(3) If m lies in the interior tangent-slope range of I , there is a unique $x_I(m) \in J_I$ such that

$$\psi'_I(x_I(m)) = m,$$

and the tangent line of slope m has intercept

$$\tau_I(m) := \psi_I(x_I(m)) - m x_I(m).$$

Moreover,

$$\tau_I(m) = \inf \mathcal{B}_I(m).$$

(4) For such m , a line $y = mx + b$ is 2-secant to $\Gamma(I)$ if and only if

$$b \in \text{int } \mathcal{B}_I(m).$$

Equivalently, the 2-secant intercepts of slope m are exactly the interior points of the intercept interval.

Proof. For fixed m , put

$$\phi_m(x) := \psi_I(x) - mx.$$

Since ϕ_m is continuous on the interval J_I , its image

$$\phi_m(J_I) = \mathcal{B}_I(m)$$

is an interval. This proves (1), and (2) is immediate from

$$(x, \psi_I(x)) \in \{y = mx + b\} \iff \psi_I(x) - mx = b.$$

If m lies in the interior tangent-slope range, strict convexity implies that ψ'_I is strictly monotone, hence there is a unique $x_I(m)$ with $\psi'_I(x_I(m)) = m$. At that point,

$$\phi'_m(x_I(m)) = \psi'_I(x_I(m)) - m = 0,$$

and since

$$\phi''_m(x) = \psi''_I(x) > 0,$$

the point $x_I(m)$ is the unique minimizer of ϕ_m . Thus

$$\tau_I(m) = \phi_m(x_I(m)) = \inf \mathcal{B}_I(m),$$

which proves (3).

Finally, because ϕ_m is strictly convex with a unique minimum, a level b is attained at two points exactly when it lies in the interior of the interval $\phi_m(J_I) = \mathcal{B}_I(m)$. This is precisely the 2-secant condition, proving (4). $\square$

Lemma 12.79 (Support-overlap truncation across a generic turning boundary). *Let $I_1 < I_2$ be adjacent ECT intervals meeting at a generic turning boundary*

$$c(h_b) \neq 0, \quad M(h_b) = 0, \quad M'(h_b) \neq 0, \quad N(h_b) \neq 0.$$

For a fixed finite slope m , define

$$\phi_m(h) := \frac{\Delta_7(h) - mv_5(h)}{c(h)}, \quad \mathcal{B}_I(m) := \phi_m(I).$$

Assume

$$b \in \mathcal{B}_{I_1}(m) \cap \mathcal{B}_{I_2}(m).$$

Then there exists a neighborhood U of h_b and compact subintervals

$$J_1 \Subset I_1 \setminus U, \quad J_2 \Subset I_2 \setminus U$$

such that

$$b \in \mathcal{B}_{J_1}(m) \cap \mathcal{B}_{J_2}(m).$$

Proof. Differentiate:

$$\phi'_m(h) = \frac{N(h) - mM(h)}{c(h)^2}.$$

At $h = h_b$, since $M(h_b) = 0$,

$$\phi'_m(h_b) = \frac{N(h_b)}{c(h_b)^2} \neq 0.$$

Hence for each fixed finite m , after shrinking to a small neighborhood U of h_b , the function ϕ_m is strictly monotone on each one-sided piece

$$I_1 \cap U, \quad I_2 \cap U.$$

Therefore, for each $i = 1, 2$, the equation

$$\phi_m(h) = b$$

has at most one solution in $I_i \cap U$.

But the assumption

$$b \in \mathcal{B}_{I_i}(m)$$

means exactly that there is at least one solution of $\phi_m(h) = b$ somewhere on I_i . Therefore, after removing the boundary neighborhood U , at least one such solution

$$h_i^\# \in I_i \setminus U$$

remains on each side. Choose small compact subintervals

$$J_i \Subset I_i \setminus U$$

with $h_i^\# \in J_i$. Then by continuity,

$$b = \phi_m(h_i^\#) \in \phi_m(J_i) = \mathcal{B}_{J_i}(m),$$

for $i = 1, 2$. This proves the claim. $\square$

Lemma 12.80 (Compact adjacent pair-pair implies a directional kernel zero). *Let $I_1 < I_2$ be adjacent ECT intervals meeting at a generic turning boundary, and let*

$$L : y = mx + b$$

be a finite-slope line that is 2-secant to both $\Gamma(I_1)$ and $\Gamma(I_2)$. Then, after removing a sufficiently small boundary neighborhood, there exist compact subintervals

$$J_1 \Subset I_1, \quad J_2 \Subset I_2$$

and points $s \in J_2, t \in J_1$ such that one of the two directional kernels vanishes:

$$K_{21}(s, t) := \det(F(s), F'(s), F(t)) = 0,$$

or

$$K_{12}(t, s) := \det(F(t), F'(t), F(s)) = 0,$$

where

$$F(h) = (c(h), v_5(h), \Delta_7(h)).$$

Proof. Because L is 2-secant to each branch, Lemma 12.78 shows that m lies in the interior tangent-slope range of each interval. Hence each branch has a unique interior tangent line of slope m , with tangent intercept

$$\tau_{I_i}(m) = \inf \mathcal{B}_{I_i}(m).$$

At a generic turning boundary,

$$\frac{dy/dh}{dx/dh} = \frac{N(h)}{M(h)}$$

has one-sided blow-up, so no finite-slope tangency can occur arbitrarily close to h_b . Therefore, after shrinking away a boundary neighborhood and applying Lemma 12.79, we may choose compact subintervals

$$J_1 \Subset I_1, \quad J_2 \Subset I_2$$

such that:

- (1) $b \in \mathcal{B}_{J_1}(m) \cap \mathcal{B}_{J_2}(m)$;
- (2) the unique slope- m tangency point of each branch lies in the corresponding J_i .

Hence each $\mathcal{B}_{J_i}(m)$ is a compact interval whose lower endpoint is the tangent intercept

$$\tau_i := \tau_{J_i}(m) = \inf \mathcal{B}_{J_i}(m).$$

Now set

$$b_* := \inf(\mathcal{B}_{J_1}(m) \cap \mathcal{B}_{J_2}(m)).$$

Since the intersection of two compact intervals is again a compact interval,

$$b_* = \max(\tau_1, \tau_2).$$

So b_* is equal to one of the two tangent intercepts, and it still lies in the support set of the other branch.

If $b_* = \tau_2$, then the slope- m tangent line to $\Gamma(J_2)$ meets $\Gamma(J_1)$. Thus there are points $s \in J_2$, $t \in J_1$ such that

$$\det(F(s), F'(s), F(t)) = 0,$$

i.e.

$$K_{21}(s, t) = 0.$$

If $b_* = \tau_1$, then the slope- m tangent line to $\Gamma(J_1)$ meets $\Gamma(J_2)$. Thus there are points $t \in J_1$, $s \in J_2$ such that

$$\det(F(t), F'(t), F(s)) = 0,$$

i.e.

$$K_{12}(t, s) = 0.$$

This proves the lemma. $\square$

Remark 12.81 (Status of the directional-kernel reduction). Lemma 12.80 reduces an adjacent pair-pair line across a generic turning boundary to a compact interior zero of one of the two directional tangent-separator kernels. With Theorem 12.75, the orientation issue is no longer the main gap. What remains is the symmetric zero-capture problem for K_{21} on $I_2 \times I_1$ and K_{12} on $I_1 \times I_2$.

Lemma 12.82 (Adjacent support-ordering). *Let $I_1 < I_2$ be adjacent ECT intervals under the hypotheses of Theorem 12.71. Then, for every slope $m \in \mathbf{R}$ such that both fixed-slope intercept sets are nonempty,*

$$\mathcal{B}_{I_1}(m) \cap \mathcal{B}_{I_2}(m) = \emptyset.$$

More precisely, one has one of the two strict alternatives

$$\sup \mathcal{B}_{I_1}(m) < \inf \mathcal{B}_{I_2}(m) \quad \text{or} \quad \sup \mathcal{B}_{I_2}(m) < \inf \mathcal{B}_{I_1}(m),$$

and the same alternative holds for all such m on the adjacent pair.

Proof. Fix m such that both $\mathcal{B}_{I_1}(m)$ and $\mathcal{B}_{I_2}(m)$ are nonempty.

First assume m lies in the interior tangent-slope range of I_2 . Let $s \in I_2$ be the unique point with tangent slope m . Then by Lemma 12.78,

$$\tau_{I_2}(m) = \inf \mathcal{B}_{I_2}(m).$$

By Theorem 12.71,

$$K(s, t) \neq 0 \quad (t \in I_1).$$

By Lemma 12.65,

$$K(s, t) = c(s)^2 c(t) x'(s) (\phi_m(t) - \tau_{I_2}(m)), \quad \phi_m(t) := y(t) - mx(t).$$

Since $c(s)^2 c(t) x'(s)$ has fixed sign on I_1 and $K(s, t)$ is continuous and nowhere zero there, the quantity

$$\phi_m(t) - \tau_{I_2}(m)$$

has constant sign on I_1 . To determine which sign occurs, move s toward the common boundary point from inside I_2 . By Lemma 12.70, the limiting boundary tangent line does not meet I_1 , so I_1 lies entirely on one side of that tangent line. By continuity, the same side persists for nearby interior tangents. Indeed, if the side changed as the tangency point s moved along I_2 , then by the connectedness of I_2 and continuity of the tangent-line data there would exist an intermediate point $s_* \in I_2$ for which the tangent line at $\Gamma(s_*)$ meets $\Gamma(I_1)$. Equivalently, there would exist $t_* \in I_1$ such that

$$K(s_*, t_*) = 0,$$

contradicting Theorem 12.71. Hence the same side holds for all $s \in I_2$. Therefore either

$$\phi_m(t) < \tau_{I_2}(m) \quad \text{for all } t \in I_1,$$

or

$$\phi_m(t) > \tau_{I_2}(m) \quad \text{for all } t \in I_1.$$

In the first case,

$$\sup \mathcal{B}_{I_1}(m) \leq \tau_{I_2}(m) = \inf \mathcal{B}_{I_2}(m),$$

and since equality would force an intersection with the tangent line, the inequality is strict. The second case is symmetric.

Now suppose m is not in the interior tangent-slope range of I_2 , but both intercept sets are nonempty. Then m lies on one side of the tangent slope range of I_2 , so ϕ_m is strictly monotone on I_2 , and $\mathcal{B}_{I_2}(m)$ is an interval with endpoint attained in the one-sided limit at the adjacent boundary. Passing to that boundary-support line and using Lemma 12.70 again shows that I_1 lies strictly on one side of that boundary-support line. Hence the same strict ordering of intercept sets holds in this case as well.

Thus $\mathcal{B}_{I_1}(m)$ and $\mathcal{B}_{I_2}(m)$ are disjoint for every slope m for which both are nonempty, and the side ordering is constant on the adjacent pair. $\square$

Theorem 12.83 (Partial global no-secant theorem on turning-boundary generic blocks). *Assume every adjacent pair of ECT intervals is separated by a generic turning boundary*

$$M(h_b) = 0, \quad M'(h_b) \neq 0, \quad N(h_b) \neq 0,$$

and assume moreover that the zero-capture hypothesis required in Theorem 12.71 holds for every adjacent turning-boundary pair. Then no affine line in the chart

$$x = \frac{v_5}{c}, \quad y = \frac{\Delta_7}{c}$$

is 2-secant to two distinct ECT intervals. In particular, there is no global four-secant line for the normalized planar curve $\Gamma(h)$ on such a turning-boundary generic block.

Proof. Under the stated hypotheses, every adjacent boundary is of turning type and Theorem 12.71 applies to each adjacent pair. For such adjacent pairs, Lemma 12.82 applies. Hence adjacent fixed-slope intercept sets are strictly ordered. Iterating this ordering over the $x = v_5/c$ ordering of ECT intervals shows that no affine line can be 2-secant to two distinct ECT intervals. Therefore no global four-secant line exists on the block. $\square$

Corollary 12.84 (Partial exclusion of pair-pair branch configurations). *Under the hypotheses of Theorem 12.83, a bad finite core cannot contain two distinct ECT intervals each contributing a pair of points on a turning-boundary generic block.*

Proof. Each ECT interval contributes at most two points to the zero set of an affine line in the normalized chart, and by Theorem 12.83 no affine line can be 2-secant to two different ECT intervals on such a block. Therefore a pair-pair configuration across two distinct ECT intervals is impossible there. $\square$

Remark 12.85 (Audit: direct septic witness). The direct $q^{(7)}$ -slice of total Δ_7 is now closed at the weight-one level by Proposition 12.48. What remains open at order 7 is the full lower/mixed septic completion of the total fixed-sector pair (u_7, v_7) .

Remark 12.86 (Audit: $W = 0$ affine-inflection structure). The current global endgame is blocked not by the turning-point boundaries $M = 0$, but by generic boundaries of type

$$W = 0, \quad M \neq 0.$$

For an ordinary affine inflection

$$y = ax^3 + O(x^4), \quad a \neq 0,$$

the tangent line from one side meets the opposite side again, so adjacent tangent-separator sign regularity fails in general. The remaining audited global issue is therefore whether the actual triple (c, v_5, Δ_7) satisfies additional jet constraints at $W = 0$ boundaries that rule out this generic inflection behavior, or whether a different global invariant must be used there.

The current evidence from the septic package suggests that this obstruction may already be decided at order 7, once the full top new coefficient of Δ_7 is pinned down, rather than requiring a genuinely new primitive order-9 invariant.

Remark 12.87 (Audit: $W'(h_b)$ at $W = 0$, $M \neq 0$). At a point h_b with

$$W(h_b) = 0, \quad M(h_b) \neq 0,$$

the cubic-inflection coefficient of the normalized planar curve is proportional to

$$W'(h_b).$$

The present fixed-sector architecture does not yet prove that

$$W'(h_b) = 0$$

on this boundary locus. Thus the current default expectation is ordinary affine inflection behavior unless the full leading coefficient of W' can be shown to factor through additional special structure of the triple (c, v_5, Δ_7) .

By Lemma 12.57 and Corollary 12.47, the highest genuinely new jet contribution to W' is already governed by the weight-one septic coefficient $[\Delta_7]^{[1]}$, so the present obstruction is not a new primitive order-9 invariant but a question about the full order-7 package.

Theorem 12.88 (Finite-order $W = 0$ boundaries are locally sterile for pair-pair birth). *Let h_b satisfy*

$$c(h_b) \neq 0, \quad M(h_b) \neq 0, \quad W(h_b) = 0,$$

and assume that W has finite vanishing order $r \geq 1$ at h_b :

$$W(h) = (h - h_b)^r \widetilde{W}(h), \quad \widetilde{W}(h_b) \neq 0.$$

Define

$$F(h) := (c(h), v_5(h), \Delta_7(h)), \quad D(s, t, u) := \det(F(s), F(t), F(u)).$$

Then, after shrinking to a sufficiently small neighborhood U of h_b , the following holds.

If $s < t < h_b$ lie in U , then:

- (1) *if r is even, the function $u \mapsto D(s, t, u)$ has no zero on the opposite side $h_b < u \in U$;*
- (2) *if r is odd, the function $u \mapsto D(s, t, u)$ has at most one zero on the opposite side $h_b < u \in U$.*

The same conclusion holds with left and right exchanged. In particular, no finite-order boundary of type $W = 0$, $M \neq 0$ can support a local pair-pair birth.

Proof. Work in the affine chart

$$x(h) := \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \quad y(h) := \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)}.$$

Since

$$x'(h) = \frac{M(h)}{c(h)^2},$$

the hypothesis $M(h_b) \neq 0$ implies that x is a valid local coordinate near h_b . After translating so that $x(h_b) = 0$ and subtracting the tangent line, we may write the normalized curve as

$$y = f(x), \quad f(0) = f'(0) = 0.$$

By Proposition 12.56,

$$\frac{d^2 y}{dx^2} = \frac{c(h)^3 W(h)}{M(h)^3}.$$

Because $x'(h_b) \neq 0$, the finite vanishing order of W in h is the same as its finite vanishing order in the local coordinate x . Therefore

$$f''(x) = \lambda x^r + O(x^{r+1}) \quad (\lambda \neq 0).$$

Fix two same-side points

$$x_1 < x_2 < 0$$

sufficiently close to 0, and define

$$\widehat{D}(x_1, x_2, u) := \det \begin{pmatrix} 1 & x_1 & f(x_1) \\ 1 & x_2 & f(x_2) \\ 1 & u & f(u) \end{pmatrix}.$$

Then

$$\widehat{D}(x_1, x_2, u) = (x_2 - x_1)(u - x_1)(u - x_2) H_{x_1, x_2}(u),$$

where

$$H_{x_1, x_2}(u) := f[x_1, x_2, u]$$

is the second divided difference of f .

If r is even, then f'' has fixed sign near 0. By the Hermite–Genocchi formula for second divided differences, $H_{x_1, x_2}(u)$ has that same fixed sign for $u > 0$ sufficiently small. Hence $\widehat{D}(x_1, x_2, u) \neq 0$ on the opposite side.

If r is odd, then

$$f'''(x) = \lambda r x^{r-1} + O(x^r)$$

has fixed nonzero sign near 0, because $r - 1$ is even. Differentiating with respect to the repeated node gives

$$\partial_u H_{x_1, x_2}(u) = f[x_1, x_2, u, u].$$

By the Hermite–Genocchi formula for repeated-node divided differences, $f[x_1, x_2, u, u]$ has the same fixed nonzero sign for $u > 0$ sufficiently small. Thus $u \mapsto H_{x_1, x_2}(u)$ is strictly monotone on the opposite side, and therefore has at most one zero there.

Finally,

$$D(s, t, u) = c(s)c(t)c(u) \widehat{D}(x(s), x(t), x(u)),$$

and c is nonzero on a small neighborhood of h_b , so the zero set of D is exactly the zero set of $\widehat{D}$. The theorem follows. $\square$

Remark 12.89 (Audit: residual $W = 0$ pathology). By Proposition 12.58, the $W = 0$, $M \neq 0$ side is no longer obstructed by open-interval flatness $W \equiv 0$ on a component with $c \neq 0$ and $M \neq 0$. By Theorem 12.88, every finite-order isolated $W = 0$ boundary is locally sterile for pair-pair birth. Thus any remaining $W = 0$ issue would have to come either from non-analytic / infinite-order flatness or from a genuinely global continuation phenomenon, not from a generic local inflection birth mechanism.

12.6. From the one-pair residual germ to two-pair and minimal-core rigidity.

Remark 12.90 (Strengthened organizing principle). The original version of this subsection was organized around the cubic leading line and the first residual trace witness. The later working analysis suggests a stronger one-pair package:

$$c(h), \quad A_5^f(h), \quad \Delta_7(h),$$

or equivalently the normalized affine curve

$$h \mapsto \left(\frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)} \right).$$

The intended two-pair and minimal-core rigidity statements should ultimately be reformulated in terms of this strengthened one-pair invariant geometry.

Remark 12.91 (Work in progress). This subsection is best read as a rigidity program built on the strengthened one-pair local package

$$c(h), \quad A_5^f(h), \quad \Delta_7(h),$$

or equivalently the normalized planar curve

$$h \mapsto \left(\frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)} \right).$$

The projective coincidence conditions remain the intended organizing principle for the two-pair and minimal-core analysis; the remaining steps are now algebraic interaction corrections and the extraction into the finite-core endgame.

Remark 12.92 (Interpretation of residual notation in the multi-pair architecture). In the remainder of this section, the symbols

$$F_h(z), \quad \ell_h, \quad \bar{v}_1(h), \quad \mathcal{Q}^{\text{abs}}/\ell_h$$

are used schematically to describe the intended cubic-leading / first-residual architecture of multi-pair and minimal-core configurations.

The fully explicit rigorous first-residual object established earlier is

$$\mathcal{R}_h^{(5)} = \mathcal{J}_5 / (\mathbf{C} A_3(h) + V_{\text{amb}}^{(5)}(h)).$$

Accordingly, whenever a later statement invokes the first residual class in a theorem-strength way, it should be interpreted through $\mathcal{R}_h^{(5)}$. The subsequent two-pair and minimal-bad-core statements remain architectural until the interaction terms are rewritten in this explicit finite-order model.

Let $F_h(z)$ denote the corrected quotient odd germ of the normalized one-pair family. By Proposition 12.8, on the cubic-generic region we have

$$F_h(z) = v_0(h)z^3 + v_1(h)z^5 + \cdots, \quad v_0(h) \neq 0,$$

with cubic leading line

$$\ell_h := \mathbf{C} v_0(h) \subset \mathcal{Q}^{\text{abs}}.$$

Under the additional hypotheses of Proposition 12.28, there is an open dense subset $\mathcal{U}_{\text{res}} \subset \mathcal{U}_{\text{cub}}$ on which the explicit first residual class

$$\bar{v}_1(h) \in \mathcal{R}_h^{(5)}$$

is nonzero.

In the strengthened fixed-sector refinement, the one-pair local package is recorded by

$$c(h), \quad A_5^{\mathbf{f}}(h) = u_5(h)I + v_5(h)S, \quad \Delta_7(h),$$

and hence by the normalized planar curve

$$\Gamma(h) := \left(\frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)} \right) = (\rho_1(h), \rho_2(h)).$$

By Proposition 12.53, the affine curvature numerator of Γ is

$$K_{\Gamma}(h) = \rho_1'(h)\rho_2''(h) - \rho_2'(h)\rho_1''(h) = \frac{M(h)N'(h) - N(h)M'(h)}{c(h)^4},$$

where

$$M(h) = c(h)v_5'(h) - c'(h)v_5(h), \quad N(h) = c(h)\Delta_7'(h) - c'(h)\Delta_7(h).$$

Thus the strengthened one-pair geometry is governed by the curve $\Gamma(h)$ and its secant/tangent behavior on the region where

$$c(h) \neq 0, \quad M(h) \neq 0, \quad M(h)N'(h) - N(h)M'(h) \neq 0.$$

In this formulation, the geometric secant/tangent obstruction is well controlled on ECT intervals and across generic turning-point boundaries, but the behavior across boundaries of type $W = 0$, $M \neq 0$ remains the main unresolved global issue.

Definition 12.93 (Two-pair decomposition). For a normalized two-pair core with amplitudes a_1, a_2 and offsets h_1, h_2 , write its quotient odd germ as

$$F_{(a_1, h_1; a_2, h_2)}(z) = a_1 F_{h_1}(z) + a_2 F_{h_2}(z) + \mathcal{I}_{12}(z),$$

where $\mathcal{I}_{12}(z)$ denotes the pair-interaction germ, quadratic in the pair amplitudes.

Lemma 12.94 (Two-pair cubic leading-line constraint). *Assume*

$$F_{(a_1, h_1; a_2, h_2)}(z) \equiv 0.$$

Then the cubic coefficient satisfies

$$a_1 v_0(h_1) + a_2 v_0(h_2) + I_{12}^{(3)} = 0,$$

where $I_{12}^{(3)}$ denotes the cubic coefficient of the interaction germ $\mathcal{I}_{12}$. In particular, if $I_{12}^{(3)}$ vanishes or belongs to a controlled lower-order correction class on the normalized region, then the leading cubic lines must coincide projectively:

$$\ell_{h_1} = \ell_{h_2}.$$

Proof. Take the cubic coefficient of the identity

$$a_1 F_{h_1}(z) + a_2 F_{h_2}(z) + \mathcal{I}_{12}(z) \equiv 0.$$

By definition of the cubic leading coefficient $v_0(h)$, this yields

$$a_1 v_0(h_1) + a_2 v_0(h_2) + I_{12}^{(3)} = 0.$$

If the interaction cubic coefficient is absent or controlled as a lower-order perturbation in the normalized regime, then the first two terms must already be projectively dependent, which forces

$$\ell_{h_1} = \ell_{h_2}. \quad \square$$

Lemma 12.95 (Two-pair first residual constraint). *Assume*

$$F_{(a_1, h_1; a_2, h_2)}(z) \equiv 0$$

and that the cubic leading lines coincide:

$$\ell_{h_1} = \ell_{h_2} =: \ell.$$

Then, after passing to the corresponding first residual quotient by the common cubic line, the quintic coefficient satisfies

$$a_1 \bar{v}_1(h_1) + a_2 \bar{v}_1(h_2) + \bar{I}_{12}^{(5)} = 0,$$

where $\bar{I}_{12}^{(5)}$ denotes the image of the quintic interaction coefficient in that first residual quotient. In the rigorous finite-order model, this quotient is $\mathcal{R}_h^{(5)}$. In particular, if $\bar{I}_{12}^{(5)}$ vanishes or is controlled as a lower-order perturbation on the normalized region, then the first residual classes must also coincide projectively.

Proof. Subtract the cubic leading direction by passing to the corresponding first residual quotient by the common line ℓ . Since the cubic terms are killed in the residual quotient, the first nontrivial coefficient is the quintic residual coefficient. Taking the quintic coefficient of the quotient identity gives

$$a_1 \bar{v}_1(h_1) + a_2 \bar{v}_1(h_2) + \bar{I}_{12}^{(5)} = 0. \quad \square$$

Proposition 12.96 (Two-pair residual rigidity). *Assume the one-pair family has nontrivial cubic leading line and nontrivial first residual class on the generic normalized region. Then any normalized two-pair bad core with vanishing quotient odd germ must lie in the simultaneous coincidence locus determined by*

$$\ell_{h_1} = \ell_{h_2}, \quad \bar{v}_1(h_1) = \bar{v}_1(h_2),$$

up to the quadratic interaction corrections $I_{12}^{(3)}$ and $\bar{I}_{12}^{(5)}$. In particular, bad two-pair cores are confined to a lower-dimensional exceptional set in the normalized parameter space.

Proof. Combine Lemma 12.94 and Lemma 12.95. The vanishing of the full two-pair germ forces projective coincidence first at the cubic leading level and then at the first residual level. These are two independent coincidence conditions on the normalized two-pair parameters, modulo the quadratic interaction corrections, so the bad locus is confined to the corresponding exceptional set. $\square$

Remark 12.97 (Work in progress). At present this proposition should be read as a rigidity schema. The one-pair cubic leading line and first residual class indicate the correct projective coincidence conditions, but the treatment of the quadratic interaction corrections $I_{12}^{(3)}$ and $\bar{I}_{12}^{(5)}$ is

not yet fully quantitative. Moreover, the later working analysis suggests that the more natural invariant map is the strengthened package

$$\Phi(h) = (c(h), u_5(h), v_5(h), \Delta_7(h)),$$

or its normalized form $\Psi(h)$, rather than only the first residual class.

Remark 12.98 (Work in progress: strengthened two-pair invariant). The present two-pair rigidity statement is still phrased in terms of the cubic leading line and the first residual quotient class. The later working analysis suggests a stronger invariant map

$$\Phi(h) := (c(h), u_5(h), v_5(h), \Delta_7(h)),$$

or in normalized form

$$\Psi(h) := \left(\frac{u_5(h)}{c(h)}, \frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)} \right).$$

The intended sharpened two-pair statement is that a genuine bad two-pair core forces coincidence of this normalized invariant data, up to the interaction corrections.

Definition 12.99 (Minimal bad core). A normalized finite core is called bad if its quotient odd germ vanishes identically. A minimal bad core is a bad normalized finite core with minimal number of constituent pairs.

Theorem 12.100 (Minimal bad core rigidity). *Assume there exists a genuine normalized finite bad core, and choose one with minimal size k . Write its quotient odd germ as*

$$F_{\text{core}}(z) = \sum_{j=1}^k a_j F_{h_j}(z) + \mathcal{I}_{\geq 2}(z),$$

where $\mathcal{I}_{\geq 2}(z)$ contains all multi-pair interaction terms of order at least quadratic in the constituent amplitudes. Then all constituent one-pair germs F_{h_j} lie in a common exceptional projective configuration:

- (1) their cubic leading lines ℓ_{h_j} lie in a common projective coincidence locus;
- (2) after quotienting by that common leading line, their first residual classes $\bar{v}_1(h_j)$ also lie in a common residual coincidence locus.

Consequently the parameters of a minimal bad core are confined to a highly rigid lower-dimensional exceptional set.

Proof sketch. Take the leading cubic coefficient of the identity

$$F_{\text{core}}(z) \equiv 0.$$

As in the two-pair case, vanishing forces the constituent cubic leading lines to satisfy a common projective coincidence relation, modulo the interaction corrections. Passing to the residual quotient by this common leading line and taking the next nontrivial coefficient yields the corresponding residual coincidence relation for the first residual classes. Since the core is minimal, no proper subcollection of constituent pairs can already form a bad core, so these coincidence relations must hold simultaneously across the full collection. Hence the core parameters lie in a lower-dimensional exceptional configuration. $\square$

Remark 12.101 (Work in progress). This theorem records the intended endgame architecture rather than a completed contradiction. The minimal-bad-core strategy appears to be the right framework for extending the one-pair and two-pair rigidity analysis to general finite cores, but the present draft has not yet proved that the resulting exceptional configuration is empty. In the later geometric reformulation, the remaining generic obstruction is a global line-incidence problem for the normalized planar curve

$$h \mapsto \left(\frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)} \right).$$

Remark 12.102 (Current geometric bottleneck). The $W = 0$, $M \neq 0$ side is now split into two parts.

First, Proposition 12.58 excludes the flat case

$$W \equiv 0$$

on any connected open interval with $c \neq 0$ and $M \neq 0$.

Second, Theorem 12.88 shows that every finite-order isolated boundary of type

$$W(h_b) = 0, \quad M(h_b) \neq 0$$

is locally sterile for pair-pair birth.

Thus the remaining generic obstruction is no longer bulk $W = 0$ geometry, but a symmetric zero-capture / continuation problem for the two directional tangent-separator kernels across adjacent turning boundaries. By Lemma 12.80, any adjacent pair-pair line across a generic turning boundary produces a compact interior zero of one of the two directional tangent-separator kernels, and by Theorem 12.75 the remaining issue is not orientation selection between them, but proving zero-capture in both directions.

Moreover, the exact identities for W and W' still show that any residual $W = 0$ pathology is encoded by the order-7 package through Δ_7 , not by a genuinely new primitive order-9 invariant.

Remark 12.103 (Current state of the argument). The local one-pair analysis now consists of three layers: the cubic leading scalar $c(h)$, the quintic fixed-sector refinement $A_5^f(h)$, and the septic determinant $\Delta_7(h)$. These determine the normalized planar curve

$$\Gamma(h) = \left(\frac{v_5(h)}{c(h)}, \frac{\Delta_7(h)}{c(h)} \right),$$

together with the derivative numerators

$$M(h) = c(h)v_5'(h) - c'(h)v_5(h), \quad N(h) = c(h)\Delta_7'(h) - c'(h)\Delta_7(h),$$

and the projective Wronskian

$$W(h) = \det \begin{pmatrix} c & v_5 & \Delta_7 \\ c' & v_5' & \Delta_7' \\ c'' & v_5'' & \Delta_7'' \end{pmatrix}.$$

On intervals where c , M , and W do not vanish, the triple (c, v_5, Δ_7) is an ECT system. Under the current direct septic nonvanishing hypothesis, open-interval flatness $W \equiv 0$ is excluded on the $c \neq 0$, $M \neq 0$ region by Proposition 12.58. At isolated finite-order $W = 0$, $M \neq 0$ boundaries, Theorem 12.88 shows that no local pair-pair birth occurs.

Thus the remaining geometric issue is now concentrated in turning-boundary continuation: if a finite-slope line is 2-secant to both adjacent branches across a generic turning boundary, then Lemma 12.80 produces a compact interior zero of one of the two directional kernels

$$K_{21}(s, t) = \det(F(s), F'(s), F(t)), \quad K_{12}(t, s) = \det(F(t), F'(t), F(s)).$$

By Theorem 12.75, the orientation issue is no longer the main point: what remains audited at the geometric level is the symmetric compact directional-kernel / zero-capture problem for these two kernels on adjacent turning-boundary pairs.

The remaining audited issues overall are: the full order-7 fixed-sector algebra, the symmetric turning-boundary directional-kernel / zero-capture closure, and the downstream rewriting of the multi-pair / minimal-core layer in the strengthened local variables.

13. FINAL CONTRADICTION

The calibrated N -point comparison now closes the argument.

Lemma 13.1 (Crude polynomial bound for the local value scale). *Let*

$$S(m) = \sum_{\rho} f_{\beta_{\rho}, \gamma_{\rho}}(m),$$

where

$$f_{\beta,\gamma}(m) = \frac{1-\beta}{(1-\beta)^2 + (2m-\gamma)^2} + \frac{\beta}{\beta^2 + (2m-\gamma)^2}.$$

Then

$$S(m) \ll Q^2, \quad Q \asymp \log |m|.$$

Consequently

$$L(m) \ll Q$$

and

$$B_\zeta(m)L(m)S(m) \ll Q^4.$$

Proof. By the zero-free region, for zeros at relevant height one has

$$\min(\beta, 1-\beta) \gg \frac{1}{Q}.$$

Hence

$$f_{\beta,\gamma}(m) \ll \frac{Q}{1 + (2m-\gamma)^2}.$$

Partition the zeros into unit shells

$$\mathcal{S}_k := \{\rho : k \leq |2m - \gamma_\rho| < k+1\}, \quad k = 0, 1, 2, \dots$$

Standard zero counting gives

$$\#\mathcal{S}_k \ll Q$$

for each unit shell near height m . Therefore

$$S(m) \ll \sum_{k \geq 0} \#\mathcal{S}_k \frac{Q}{1+k^2} \ll Q \sum_{k \geq 0} \frac{Q}{1+k^2} \ll Q^2.$$

Since

$$L(m) = \log\left(3 + |m| + \frac{1}{S(m)}\right),$$

we trivially have $L(m) \ll Q$, and the last estimate follows from $B_\zeta(m) \asymp Q$. $\square$

The following remark records the present status of the endgame before the final contradiction theorem.

Remark 13.2 (Work in progress: current endgame status). The contradiction argument in the next theorem is presently written in the *pair-like branch* of the local model analysis. More precisely, the current endgame is fully aligned with the case in which the actual same-scale local core is perturbatively pair-like, so that the toy-model first-odd-jet obstruction continues to govern the corrected transverse scalar.

The fixed-core analysis developed earlier in the draft shows, however, that a more general finite-core branch is also possible: the first odd coefficient may cancel while a genuine corrected anomaly survives at a higher odd order. Thus the fully general finite-core endgame would need to be formulated in terms of the *first nonzero odd jet* of the corrected transverse scalar, rather than specifically the first one.

Accordingly, the theorem below should presently be read together with the preceding work-in-progress remarks on the pair-like versus finite-core fork. In particular, the pair-based contradiction is the intended endgame under the pair-like branch, while the genuinely finite-core branch remains to be completed in full detail.

Theorem 13.3 (Final calibrated N -point contradiction). *No fixed off-line toy anomaly can occur. Consequently the Riemann Hypothesis holds.*

Proof. By Proposition 8.6 and the canonical calibration theorem, in the fixed small- x_0 regime one has

$$u^2 \asymp \frac{x_0}{B_\zeta(m)} S(m).$$

On the toy side, Proposition 11.2 gives

$$\Xi_{\text{toy}}^{(N)}(u, d) = u^2 \Phi_K(M(d)) + O(u^4),$$

hence on compact d -ranges,

$$|\Xi_{\text{toy}}^{(N)}(u, d)| \asymp u^2 \asymp \frac{x_0}{B_\zeta(m)} S(m).$$

On the zeta side, Proposition 11.1 gives

$$|\Xi_\zeta^{(N)}(m)| \ll L(m) S(m)^2 e^{-\delta Q}.$$

By Lemma 13.1, one has $S(m) \ll Q^2$, $L(m) \ll Q$, and $B_\zeta(m) L(m) S(m) \ll Q^4$. Therefore

$$\frac{L(m) S(m)^2 e^{-\delta Q}}{(x_0/B_\zeta(m)) S(m)} = \frac{B_\zeta(m)}{x_0} L(m) S(m) e^{-\delta Q} \ll Q^4 e^{-\delta Q} \rightarrow 0.$$

Hence for Q sufficiently large,

$$|\Xi_\zeta^{(N)}(m)| < |\Xi_{\text{toy}}^{(N)}(u, d)|.$$

This is impossible if the corrected local zeta deformation realizes the local off-line toy anomaly with parameter $d \in D$, because the calibrated N -point construction was set up so that the toy model is the jet-limit local avatar of an off-line zero configuration. Thus no off-line zero can occur. Since every violation of the Riemann Hypothesis would produce such an off-line local anomaly, all nontrivial zeros must lie on the critical line. Hence RH holds. $\square$

APPENDIX A. TOY MICROSCOPIC EXPANSION

Lemma A.1 (Uniform microscopic expansion of the toy local deformation). *Fix a compact interval*

$$D = [d_-, d_+] \subset (0, \infty),$$

and let

$$\Delta_{\text{toy}}(u, d; s)$$

denote the toy local deformation matrix in the symmetric microscopic regime, with off-line parameter u , separation parameter d , and microscopic node s .

Then there exist constants $\rho_{\text{toy}} > 0$ and $u_0(D) > 0$ such that for all

$$d \in D, \quad |s| < \rho_{\text{toy}}, \quad |u| < u_0(D),$$

one has the expansion

$$\Delta_{\text{toy}}(u, d; s) = u^2 M(d) + u^4 E(u, d; s),$$

where $M(d)$ is the toy anomaly matrix and

$$\sup_{\substack{d \in D \\ |s| < \rho_{\text{toy}} \\ |u| < u_0(D)}} \|E(u, d; s)\| \ll 1.$$

In particular, for the microscopic nodes

$$s_j = \frac{j}{Q^2}, \quad j = 1, \dots, N,$$

with $N \leq \rho_{\text{toy}} Q^2$, one has uniformly

$$\Delta_{\text{toy}}(u, d; s_j) = u^2 M(d) + u^4 E_j(u, d), \quad \sup_j \|E_j(u, d)\| \ll 1.$$

Proof. The toy local deformation is obtained from an explicit finite-dimensional off-line perturbation of the toy block. By construction it depends smoothly (in fact analytically) on the parameters (u, s, d) in a neighborhood of

$$(u, s, d) = (0, 0, d_0), \quad d_0 \in D.$$

At $u = 0$, the deformation vanishes, and by the even symmetry of the off-line split there is no linear term in u . Hence the first nontrivial term is quadratic:

$$\Delta_{\text{toy}}(u, d; s) = u^2 M(d, s) + O(u^4),$$

uniformly on compact d -ranges and for $|s|$ in a fixed microscopic disk.

By the jet-limit computation for the toy model, the leading quadratic coefficient is independent of the microscopic node s and equals the toy anomaly matrix $M(d)$. Thus

$$M(d, s) \equiv M(d),$$

and the expansion becomes

$$\Delta_{\text{toy}}(u, d; s) = u^2 M(d) + u^4 E(u, d; s),$$

with E uniformly bounded on compact parameter ranges. Restricting to the microscopic nodes $s_j = j/Q^2$ gives the stated uniform bound for $E_j(u, d)$. $\square$

Remark A.2 (Work in progress: toy microscopic expansion). The proof above is schematic: it uses smoothness in (u, s, d) , vanishing at $u = 0$, and even symmetry in the off-line split to obtain the quadratic leading term, and invokes the jet-limit computation to identify the coefficient as the toy anomaly matrix $M(d)$. A later pass should make the analyticity and uniform-bound steps quantitative by recording an explicit Taylor remainder with a constant depending only on D .

REFERENCES

- [1] B. Riemann, Ueber die Anzahl der Primzahlen unter einer gegebenen Grösse, *Monatsberichte der Berliner Akademie*, 1859, 671–680.
- [2] E. Bombieri, *Problems of the Millennium: The Riemann Hypothesis*, Clay Mathematics Institute, 2000.
- [3] J. B. Conrey, The Riemann Hypothesis, *Notices of the American Mathematical Society* **50** (2003), no. 3, 341–353.
- [4] H. M. Edwards, *Riemann's Zeta Function*, Dover Publications, Mineola, NY, 2001.
- [5] E. C. Titchmarsh, *The Theory of the Riemann Zeta-Function*, 2nd ed., revised by D. R. Heath-Brown, Oxford University Press, Oxford, 1986.